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THIS IS A PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FOR INFORMATION PURPOSES ONLY AND IS NOT A PROSPECTUS ANNOUNCEMENT AND DOES NOT CONSTITUTE AN INVITATION OR OFFER TO ACQUIRE, PURCHASE OR SUBSCRIBE TO SECURITIES. NOT FOR RELEASE, PUBLICATION OR DISTRIBUTION DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY OUTSIDE INDIA. INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF EQUITY SHARES OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE BSE LIMITED ("BSE") AND THE NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("NSE" AND TOGETHER WITH BSE, THE "STOCK EXCHANGES") IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS").

JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED

(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus, and the Abridged Prospectus)

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Jio Platforms Limited was incorporated on November 15, 2019, at Ahmedabad, Gujarat, as a public company limited by shares under the Companies Act, 2013, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Registration Centre. For further details, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 249 of the red herring prospectus dated October 14, 2026 ("**RHP**").

Corporate Identity Number: U72900GJ2019PLC110816
Registered Office: Office-101, Saffron, Nr. Centre Point, Panchwati 5 Rasta, Ambawadi, Ahmedabad 380 006, Gujarat, India
Corporate Office: TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park, Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli, Navi Mumbai 400 701, Maharashtra, India
Contact Person(s): Ms. Savithri Parekh, Company Secretary and Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran, Compliance Officer
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com; **Tel:** +91 22 7967 0000; **Website:** www.jio.com

OUR PROMOTER: RELIANCE INDUSTRIES LIMITED

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO 270,000,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ("THE COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SECURITIES PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("ISSUE PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (THE "ISSUE"). THE ISSUE INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES ("EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION") AND A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE RIL SHAREHOLDERS ("RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION"). THE ISSUE LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION AND THE RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET ISSUE". THE ISSUE AND THE NET ISSUE SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY, RESPECTIVELY. THE COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLMs, IS OFFERING A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT")

PRICE BAND: ₹ 1,065 TO ₹ 1,119 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 106.50 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 111.90 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH THEREAFTER

THE PRICE TO EARNING RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EARNINGS PER SHARE ("EPS") FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 31.71 TIMES, AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 33.31 TIMES, AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 22.35 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

BID/ISSUE OPENS TODAY

BID/ISSUE CLOSES ON[(1)]: FRIDAY, OCTOBER 23, 2026

(1) UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.

Jio Platforms Limited, is a technology platform, built on proprietary digital technology and pan-India digital connectivity as its foundational layer, driving digital transformation in India. Our Material Subsidiary, Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited, served 533.3 million customers in India as of June 30, 2026.

THE ISSUE IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE IS THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET ISSUE | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET ISSUE | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET ISSUE

EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION
RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION

The details of the Fresh Issue and the post Issue market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

ISSUE SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹ 1,065 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹ 1,119 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)
Fresh Issue	270,000,000	287,282.94^	270,000,000	301,876.48^
Post Issue Market Capitalisation	**9,209,030,830**	**9,807,617.83**	**9,209,030,830**	**10,304,905.50**

^ Considers the impact of Employee Discount of ₹ 54 per Equity Share

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE ISSUE, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE ISSUE AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRE-ISSUE AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED OCTOBER 14, 2026, AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE ISSUE ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendations of the Committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated October 14, 2026, the above Price Band is justified based on quantitative factors /KPIs disclosed in the 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP vis-à-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary issuances / secondary transactions as disclosed in 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP and provided below in the advertisement and other relevant factors.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to the section titled "Risk Factors" section on page 30 of the RHP.

1. **Risk relating to telecommunication license and spectrum:** The unified licence for providing telecom services held by Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited ("RJIL") across circles in India is due for renewal in October 2033. Further, the spectrum held by RJIL is valid for a period of 20 years with the majority of the spectrum expiring between 2041 and 2042. Any inability to maintain or renew such licences or to successfully bid for any spectrum required for our operations, could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.

Continued on next page...

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2. **Dependence on Reliance Industries Limited, Reliance Retail Limited and other Reliance Group entities:** The Company and its subsidiaries have entered into various non-exclusive agreements with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited, a subsidiary of the Promoter and other Reliance Group entities for certain key aspects of the business. Disruption of these arrangements could significantly impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides an overview of our significant transactions with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited and Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited, for the periods/Fiscals indicated.

Particulars	Parent[1]/ fellow subsidiary / joint venture of the Parent	Three months ended June 30,		Fiscal		
		2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
		(in ₹ million, unless otherwise indicated)				
Purchase of Property, Plant and Equipment and Other Intangible Assets	Parent[1] (A)	19,440	14,237	39,040	37,099	62,246
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (B = A/U)	46.46%	11.82%	11.42%	8.38%	11.63%
	Reliance Retail Limited (C)	750	2,352	5,867	14,720	9,458
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (D = C/ U)	1.79%	1.95%	1.72%	3.33%	1.77%
	Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited (E)	414	192	5,339	5,190	1,107
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (F = E/ U)	0.99%	0.16%	1.56%	1.17%	0.21%
Revenue from Operations	Parent[1] (G)	9,322	7,972	36,442	35,997	35,449
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (H = G/ V)	2.38%	2.28%	2.48%	2.81%	3.24%
	Reliance Retail Limited (I)	3,001	4,279	16,374	10,416	7,244
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (J = I/ V)	0.77%	1.22%	1.11%	0.81%	0.66%
Revenue Received in Advance[2]	Reliance Retail Limited	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587
Professional Fees	Parent[1] (K)	5,797	7,520	26,254	29,614	23,364
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (L = K/ W)	1.95%	2.88%	2.40%	3.14%	2.87%
	Reliance Retail Limited (M)	1,082	3,232	7,671	6,730	4,601
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (N = M/ W)	0.36%	1.24%	0.70%	0.71%	0.57%
Network Operating Expenses	Parent[1] (O)	3,131	4,312	18,761	15,807	15,388
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (P = O/ W)	1.05%	1.65%	1.71%	1.68%	1.89%
Selling and Distribution Expenses	Parent[1] (Q)	-	-	-	6,299	9,449
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (R = Q/ W)	-	-	-	0.67%	1.16%
	Reliance Retail Limited (S)	10,527	11,858	43,551	35,158	30,008
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (T = S/ W)	3.54%	4.54%	3.98%	3.73%	3.69%
Cash Capex[3] (U)		41,838	120,481	341,843	442,680	535,096
Revenue from Operations (V)		391,729	350,323	1,468,853	1,282,184	1,095,581
Total Expenses (W)		297,708	261,350	1,094,060	942,057	813,674

Notes:

[1] *Parent, in this table, means the Promoter.*

[2] *Recharge vouchers sold to Reliance Retail Limited are accounted as 'Advance against services' which is disclosed as a related party transaction under the head 'Revenue received in advance'. When Reliance Retail Limited or its distributor/ sub-distributor further sells the vouchers to our customers by way of recharge to the digital connectivity services, RJIL recognises such transfer as 'Deferred revenue' and thereafter, based on the type of tariff plan, it is accounted as operating revenues in the profit & loss account. In light of the above, revenue received in advance has not been presented as a percentage of revenue from operations.*

[3] *Cash Capex refers to the cash outflow towards expenditure for property, plant and equipment, spectrum and other intangible assets less proceeds from disposal of property, plant and equipment and other intangible assets.*

3. **Dependency on Reliance Retail Limited for distribution of prepaid connectivity services:** RJIL has a master distribution agreement and a master collection agreement with RRL. RRL is the sole distributor of our pre-paid connectivity services. Our revenue from pre-paid connectivity services constituted 76.37%, 77.88%, 77.08%, 78.57% and 79.35% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations for the three months period ended June 30, 2026, June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any disruption in this relationship or distribution channel could adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides the details of the Revenue Received in Advance attributed to the above arrangement with RRL:

Particulars	Three months ended / As of June 30		Fiscal / As of March 31		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
	(in ₹ millions)				
Revenue Received in Advance	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587

4. **Dependency on RJIL that contributes significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT and KPIs relating to digital connectivity services:** RJIL contributed significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT in periods / Fiscals as indicated below:

Fiscals / period	RJIL's revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations	RJIL's EBITDA (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated EBITDA	RJIL's profit after tax (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated PAT
Three months ended June 30, 2026	342,121	87.34%	195,904	93.89%	71,669	92.31%
Three months ended June 30, 2025	308,821	88.15%	173,013	95.40%	67,110	94.39%
Fiscal 2026	1,288,714	87.74%	723,544	94.88%	281,732	93.76%
Fiscal 2025	1,141,413	89.02%	612,334	95.42%	247,948	94.97%
Fiscal 2024	1,001,194	91.38%	528,784	96.21%	204,656	95.53%

Note: The financial information of RJIL provided above is on a standalone basis.

Any material adverse impact on the business, financial conditions or results of operations of RJIL would have a corresponding material adverse impact on our consolidated business, financial condition and results of operations. Further, while we operate as a technology platform, our key operational indicators ("KPIs") are primarily pertaining to our digital connectivity services provided by RJIL and do not reflect the technology platform specific metrics. Our competitors may perform more favourably on certain operational or financial KPIs, which could affect our competitive position. For details of comparison of the KPIs of our Company with listed peers, see *"Basis for Issue Price - Comparison of KPIs with Listed Industry Peers"* on page 135 of the RHP.

5. **Network, Infrastructure and Service Disruption Risk:** The uninterrupted performance, reliability and availability of our network, passive infrastructure, technology, products and services are critical to our operations and our ability to consistently deliver our digital services. Any disruption to our network, passive infrastructure and technology could impair our ability to ensure consistent performance and deliver uninterrupted customer experience, which could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations, and could lead to increased churn in our customer base.
6. **Risk related to Technology change:** The connectivity industry is subject to rapid and continuous technological change, and our connectivity infrastructure faces the risk of technological obsolescence. If we are unable to respond to changes in technologies, including for instance, more competitive satellite-based broadband services and the evolving demands of our customers, we may face technological obsolescence, which would have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
7. **Risk relating to negative publicity of 'Jio' Brand:** The "Jio" trademark is owned by the Promoter, and we do not control the use of this trademark by other companies in the Reliance Group. Negative publicity arising from actions outside its control, inability to protect intellectual property or infringement claims could have a material adverse impact on our reputation, business, financial condition and results of operations.
8. **Dependency on a limited group of passive infrastructure service providers:** We rely on a limited set of passive infrastructure service providers for our operations. For instance, of the 360,537 Network Towers used by us for our operations, 174,451 Network Towers are owned by Summit Digitel Infrastructure Limited, as of June 30, 2026. Additionally, as of June 30, 2026, we rely on Jio Digital Fibre Private Limited, for substantially all our optic fibre network requirements (approximately 98%), aside from the last mile fibre network which is owned by RJIL. Any disruption in the availability of these passive infrastructure assets could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
9. **Cybersecurity, Data Privacy and Information Security Risk:** Our systems, platforms, network infrastructure, and the services provided by our Promoter and third-party technology partners are exposed to cybersecurity threats, security breaches, operational disruptions, and other technology-related risks. Any such incident or disruption could impair our operations, compromise data security, increase costs, expose us to regulatory and legal liabilities, and adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition, and reputation.
10. **Artificial Intelligence ("AI") and Machine Learning ("ML") Technologies Related Risk:** We rely on AI and ML technologies across our operations, including for network automation through our proprietary JioBrain platform, customer engagement and service delivery. The deployment of AI and ML technologies across our operations may not yield the desired results. Further, reliance on AI/ML technologies may expose us to inherent risks pertaining to algorithmic bias and model errors leading to inaccurate or biased outputs, which may cause reputational harm and adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations.
11. Our Price/Earning (P/E) ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2026 at the upper end of the price band is 33.31 as compared to the average industry peer group P/E ratio of 22.35, as of October 13, 2026.
12. Weighted Average Return on Average Net Worth for Financial Year ended 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 9.04%. Return on Average Net Worth for the three months ended June 30, 2026, and June 30, 2025 is 2.30% and 2.31% respectively (unannualized).
13. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the RHP:

Period	Weighted average cost of Acquisition (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the weighted average cost of acquisition#	Range of acquisition price per Equity Shares: lowest price - highest price (in ₹)
Last one year / 18 months/ 3 years	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.

#As certified by D T S & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN 142412W/W100595), by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026, (UDIN 26136433YFEPPE7981).

Note: No Equity Shares were transacted in the last one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus.

14. The 19 BRLMs associated with the Issue have handled 160 public issues in the past three years, out of which 46 issues have closed below the issue price on the listing date

Book Running Lead Managers	Total public issues	Issues closed below issue price listing date
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	-	-
Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited*	-	-
BofA Securities India Limited*	-	-
Axis Capital Limited*	2	-
BNP Paribas*	-	-
Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited*	-	-
CLSA India Private Limited*	-	-
DAM Capital Advisors Limited*	8	2
Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited*	-	-
HDFC Bank Limited*	-	-
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	-	-
ICICI Securities Limited*	5	2
IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* *	5	1
Jefferies India Private Limited*	-	-
JM Financial Limited*	3	-
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited*	-	-
SBI Capital Markets Limited*	6	4
UBS Securities India Private Limited*	-	-
360 ONE WAM Limited*	-	-
Common issues handled by the BRLMs	131	37
TOTAL	**160**	**46**

** Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs*

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ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. The Company has not undertaken any pre-IPO placement from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
2. The Promoter and the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of Equity Shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
3. For the pre-Issue and post-Issue equity shareholding of the Promoter, Promoter Group and top 10 public Shareholders, refer to the section titled 'Capital Structure' on page 99 of the RHP.

BASIS FOR ISSUE PRICE

(You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Kotak Mahindra Capital Company)

*(The **"Basis for Issue Price"** section on page no. 126 of the RHP has been updated with the above price band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: https://investmentbank.kotak.com, https://www.morganstanley.com/india, https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia, www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking, www.india.clsa.com, www.damcapital.in, www.goldmansachs.com, www.hdfc.bank.in, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.iiflcapital.com, www.jefferies.com, www.jmfl.com, www.jpmipl.com, www.sbicaps.com, www.ubs.com/indiaoffers and www.360.one for the "Basis for Issue Price" section updated with the above price band)*

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE ISSUE IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors)

Particulars	Time
Bid/ Issue Period (except the Bid/ Issue Closing Date)	
Submission and revision in Bids	Only between 9:00 a.m. and 7:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("IST"))
Bid/ Issue Closing Date*^	
Submission of electronic applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIIs, other than QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors, Eligible Employees Bidding in Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications for bids beyond ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications of QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors where Bid Amount is more than ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/ cancellation of Bids	
Upward revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors categories#	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date
Upward or downward revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIIs, Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.*
 # QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/ withdraw their Bids.

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

Event	Indicative Date
Anchor Investor Bidding	Monday, October 19, 2026
Bid/Issue Opens on	Wednesday, October 21, 2026
Bid/Issue Closes on	Friday, October 23, 2026
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Monday, October 26, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors) / unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Wednesday, October 28, 2026

**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The post Issue BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the ICDR Master Circular, and the SEBI RTA Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.*

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Issue Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Issue Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days in compliance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Issue Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable. However, in case of revision in the Price Band, the Bid Lot shall remain the same.

The Issue is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein not more than 50% of the Net Issue shall be allocated on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**") ("**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("**Anchor Investor Portion**"), and 40% of such Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion ("**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs, including Mutual Funds subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to all QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Non- Institutional Bidders and not less than 35% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("**RIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. One-third of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 200,000 and up to ₹ 1,000,000 and two-thirds of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 1,000,000 provided that under-subscription in either of these two sub-categories of the Non-Institutional Portion may be allocated to Non-Institutional Bidders in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Portion in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion, and Eligible Shareholders Bidding in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Issue Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to participate in the Issue through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders, as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**") or by the Sponsor Bank(s) under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of the respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Issue through the ASBA process. For details, see *"Issue Procedure"* beginning on page 534 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Issue, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Issue. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section *"History and Certain Corporate Matters"* on page 249 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Issue. For further details, please see the section titled *"Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection"* on page 577 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of share capital of our Company and capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹1,900,000,000,000 divided into 10,000,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each and 180,000,000,000 preference shares of face value of ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹89,390,308,300 divided into 8,939,030,830 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For more details of the capital structure of the Company, see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Names of the initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the Number of Equity Shares Subscribed by them: The initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company is Reliance Industries Limited (including one Equity Share each allotted to six individuals as nominees of RIL) (10,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each). For more details of the share capital history of our Company please see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the RHP are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated July 7, 2026. For the purposes of the Issue, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the RHP and the Prospectus has been and shall be delivered to the RoC as applicable, in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" beginning on page 577 of the RHP.

Disclaimer clause of the SEBI: SEBI only gives its observations on the Issue documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Issue or the specified securities stated in the Issue document. The investors are advised to refer to page 488 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

General risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Issue. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Issue have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the RHP. Specific attention of the investors is invited to "**Risk Factors**" beginning on page 30 of the RHP

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS

Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited
1st Floor, 27 BKC, Plot No. C27, 'G' Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East) , Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4336 0000
E-mail: jio.ipo@kotak.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: kmccredressal@kotak.com
Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com
Contact Person: Ganesh Rane
SEBI Registration No.: INM000008704

Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited
Altimus, Level 39 & 40
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6118 1000
E-mail: jpl_ipo@morganstanley.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors_india@morganstanley.com
Website: https://www.morganstanley.com/india
Contact Person: Keyur Thakar/ Hrithik Khanna
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011203

BofA Securities India Limited
Ground Floor, "A" Wing, One BKC, "G" Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6632 8000
E-mail: dg.jpl_ipo@bofa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: dg.india_merchantbanking@bofa.com
Website: https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia
Contact Person: Sahil H. Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011625

Axis Capital Limited
1st Floor, Axis House
P.B. Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4325 2183
E-mail: jio.ipo@axiscap.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaints@axiscap.in
Website: www.axiscapital.co.in
Contact Person: Sanaea Sumondy/ Simran Gadh
SEBI Registration No: INM000012029

BNP Paribas
1, North Avenue Maker Maxity
Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3370 4000
E-mail: LIST.CIB.JioIPO@asia.bnpparibas.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: indiainvestors.care@asia.bnpparibas.com
Website: www.bnpparibas.co.in
Contact Person: Ankur Thacker
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011534

Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited
1202, 12th Floor, First International Financial Center, G Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 098
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6175 9999
E-mail: jio.ipo@citi.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors.cgmib@citi.com
Website: www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking
Contact Person: Naman Kulshreshtha
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010718

CLSA India Private Limited
8/F Dalamal House
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6650 5050
E-mail: jio.ipo@clsa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.helpdesk@clsa.com
Website: www.india.clsa.com
Contact Person: Prachi Chandgothia
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010619

DAM Capital Advisors Limited
Altimus 2202, Level 22
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4202 2500
E-mail: jio.ipo@damcapital.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaint@damcapital.in
Website: www.damcapital.in
Contact Person: Aanchal Wagle/ Jay Shah
SEBI Registration No.: MB/INM000011336

Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited
9th and 10th Floor, Ascent-Worli
Sudam Kalu Ahire Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6616 9000
E-mail: jioipo@gs.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: india-client-support@gs.com
Website: www.goldmansachs.com
Contact Person: Saurav S
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011054

HDFC Bank Limited
Investment Banking Group
Unit no. 701, 702 and 702-A, 7th Floor, Tower 2 and 3
One International Centre, Senapati Bapat Marg, Prabhadevi
Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3395 8233
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@hdfc.bank.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.redressal@hdfcbank.com
Website: www.hdfc.bank.in
Contact Person: Bharti Ranga/ Souradeep Ghosh
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011252

HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited
52/60, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort, Mumbai - 400 001
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6864 1289
E-mail: jplipo@hsbc.co.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorgrievance@hsbc.co.in
Website: www.business.hsbc.co.in
Contact Person: Harsh Thakkar/ Harshit Tayal
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010353

ICICI Securities Limited
Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6807 7100
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@icicisecurities.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com
Website: www.icicisecurities.com
Contact Person: Ramesh Vaswana / Soumavo Sarkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011179

IIFL Capital Services Limited
(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)
24th Floor, One Lodha Place
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai - 400 013
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4646 4728
E-mail: jio.ipo@iiflcap.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: ig.ib@iiflcap.com
Website: www.iiflcapital.com
Contact Person: Gaurav Mittal/ Pawan Kumar Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010940

Jefferies India Private Limited
Level 16, Express Towers
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4356 6000
E-mail: Jio.Platforms.IPO@jefferies.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: jipl.grievance@jefferies.com
Website: www.jefferies.com
Contact Person: Akshat Shah/ Meghna Biju
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011443

JM Financial Limited
7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg
Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6630 3030
E-mail: jpl.ipo@jmfl.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfl.com
Website: www.jmfl.com
Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010361

J.P. Morgan India Private Limited
J.P. Morgan Towers
Off C.S.T Road, Kalina, Santacruz (East),
Mumbai - 400 098 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6157 3000
E-mail: JIO_IPO@jpmorgan.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorsmb.jpmipl@jpmorgan.com
Website: www.jpmipl.com
Contact Person: Shivam Goel/ Rishank Chheda
SEBI Registration No.: INM000002970

SBI Capital Markets Limited
1501, 15th Floor, A & B Wing, G Block,
Parinee Crescenzo, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4006 9807
E-mail: jio.ipo@sbicaps.com
Website: www.sbicaps.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.relations@sbicaps.com
Contact Person: Krithika Shetty/ Prashant Patankar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000003531

UBS Securities India Private Limited
Unit 2901, Level 29, Altimus,
Dr. GM Gokhale Marg /
Pandurang Budhkar Road,
Worli, Mumbai - 400 018, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6155 6000
E-mail: OL-jioipo@ubs.com
Website: www.ubs.com/indiaoffers
Investor Grievance E-mail: igbmindia@ubs.com
Contact Person: Vidhit Patni
SEBI Registration No.: INM000013101

360 ONE WAM Limited
360 ONE Centre, Kamala City
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West),
Mumbai - 400 013 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4031 7000
Email: jioplatforms.ipo@360.one
Investor Grievance E-mail: mbinvestorcomplaints@360.one
Website: www.360.one
Contact Person: Devesh Patkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000012801

REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE

KFin Technologies Limited
Selenium Tower-B, Plot No. 31 & 32, Gachibowli,
Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally
Hyderabad - 500 032, Telangana, India
Tel: + 91 40 6716 2222/ 1800 309 4001
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@kfintech.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: einward.ris@kfintech.com
Website: www.kfintech.com
Contact Person: Williams R
SEBI Registration No.: INR000000221

Company Secretary
Ms. Savithri Parekh

Compliance Officer
Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran

TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park,
Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli,
Navi Mumbai 400 701Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 7967 0000
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com

Investors may contact the Company Secretary or Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Issue in case of any pre-issue or post-issue related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Issue related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

Continued on next page...

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AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP:

Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP, before applying in the Issue. A copy of the RHP is made available on website of SEBI at **www.sebi.gov.in**, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**, respectively, and on the website of the Company at **https://www.jio.com**; and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one;.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS:

A copy of the abridged prospectus is made available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Issue at **https://www.jio.com/platforms/** ; **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one; Registrar to the Issue, **KFin Technologies Limited** – www.kfintech.com., respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS:

Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED**, Tel: +91 22 7967 0000; BRLMs: **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited**, Telephone: +91 22 4336 0000; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6118 1000; **BofA Securities India Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6632 8000; **Axis Capital Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4325 2183; **BNP Paribas,** Telephone: +91 22 3370 4000; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6175 9999; **CLSA India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6650 5050; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4202 2500; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6616 9000; **HDFC Bank Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 3395 8233; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6864 1289; **ICICI Securities Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6807 7100; **IIFL Capital Services Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4646 4728; **Jefferies India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4356 6000; **JM Financial Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6157 3000; **SBI Capital Markets Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807; **UBS Securities India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6155 6000; **and 360 ONE WAM Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4031 7000; **Syndicate Members: HDFC Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2230753400, **Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited** Tel: + 91 2268497400, **JM Financial Services Limited** Tel: +91 22 6136 3400, **Kotak Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2242858484, **SBICAP Securities Limited** Tel: +91 22 6943 2521, **Sharekhan Limited** Tel: +91 22 6750 2000, **360 ONE Capital Market Private Limited** *(Formerly known as Bativala & Karani Securities India Private Limited)* Tel: + 91 022 40317000 / +91 022 40076000 **and 360 ONE Distribution Services Limited** Tel: 9321332882 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Issue. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-Syndicate Members:

Almondz Global Securities Ltd, Ambit Capital Limited, Ambit Private Limited, Amrapali Capital & Finance Services Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Asit C Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Axis Securities Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Bob Capital Markets Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Centrum Finverse limited, Centrum Wealth Management Ltd, Choice Equity Broking Private Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Pvt Limited, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd, G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, Inga Ventures Pvt Ltd, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Intensive Fiscal Services Private Limited, Jhaveri Securities, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Private Limited, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Pvt Ltd, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Lakshmishree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance Ltd, Mehta Equities Limited, Monarch Networth Capital Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Motilal Oswal Securities Limited, Nextbillion Technology Private Limited, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Paytm, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Broking Limited, Religare Securities Limited, Rikhav Securities Ltd, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Sundae Capital, Sunidhi Securities & Finance Ltd, Sushil Financial Services Pvt. Ltd., Systematix Shares & Stocks (India) Limited, Tanna Financial Services, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited, Viren M Shah, YES Securities (India) Limited, Zerodha

Escrow Collection Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Refund Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Public Issue Account Banks: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

Sponsor Banks: Axis Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

UPI: UPI Bidders can also bid through UPI mechanism

Jio Platforms Limited has provided a toll free number to address any queries related to the Issue.

Toll free number: 1800 309 4001

You may also address your queries related to the Issue by typing **'Hi'** or **'Hello'** on

WhatsApp to 7977222222

For JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED
On behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Ms. Savithri Parekh
Company Secretary

Place : Mumbai, Maharashtra
Date : October 21, 2026

All capitalised terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them In the RHP.

Jio Platforms Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC on October 14, 2026. The RHP is made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, i.e. BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the website of the Company at www.jio.com and on the respective websites of the BRLMs. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk, and for details relating to such risk, please see the section titled "**Risk Factors**" on page 30 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision and should instead rely on the RHP, as filed with the RoC, for making investment decisions.

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News

T.N. bypoll: NTK's Dharapuram candidate Karthika arrested

She and seven others were held for staging a protest on Oct. 4 during T.N. Chief Minister Vijay's roadshow to canvass votes for TVK's candidate. NTK leader Seeman slams State govt. for the arrest

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUPPUR

Naam Tamilar Katchi (NTK) functionary M. Karthika, who was among those defeated in the recent byelection for Dharapuram (Reserved) Assembly constituency in Tiruppur district of Tamil Nadu, was on Tuesday arrested in a case registered on October 4 against her and seven others for staging a protest when TVK leader and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay held a roadshow canvassing votes for his party candidate P. Sathyabama.

All the co-accused, including her husband Muruga Chandrakumar, were also arrested.

Ms. Karthika and her husband were picked up in Coimbatore and taken to Dharapuram after detention at the Peelamedu police station.

On October 4, Ms. Karthika and 20 others were detained for staging a road blockade to protest against the denial of permission to conduct their campaign along Mr. Vijay's roadshow route. She said the TVK was disbursing cash and gifts to voters and the authorities were turning a blind eye to it.

M. Karthika

> False charges have been framed, and the police action reflects the TVK's fascist and retributive politics. The TVK-led government is making the same mistakes as the Dravidian parties
>
> **SEEMAN**
> NTK chief coordinator

On Tuesday, in a video shared widely on social media platforms, Ms. Karthika was seen being taken forcibly by policewomen into the Dharapuram police station.

Condemning the arrest, NTK chief coordinator Seeman said "false charges" had been framed and the police action reflected the TVK's "fascist and retributive" politics. In a series of posts on X, Mr. Seeman said the TVK government's collapse was not far. Rather than fixing law and order and reining in TVK workers indulging in criminal activities, arresting Ms. Karthika in a "fabricated case" was a "shameful act". The TVK-led government was making the "same mistakes" as the Dravidian parties, he alleged. Mr. Seeman said he had groomed the NTK cadre to face "oppression" with courage even during the rule of the late Chief Ministers of the DMK (M. Karunanidhi) and the AIADMK (Jayalalithaa). Demanding the immediate release of Ms. Karthika and others, he warned that the "vengeful" arrest would lead to "disastrous consequences".

Stalin condemns arrest

DMK president M.K. Stalin demanded the release of Ms. Karthika, alleging that the TVK government was intimidating political opponents through arrest. In a statement, he said women from oppressed communities who entered politics and public life should be encouraged, irrespective of their ideology or political affiliation. "What does the TVK government seek to achieve by intimidating them through arrest," he asked.

Mr. Stalin said that when Ms. Karthika had criticised the DMK and its leaders in the past, the party had responded in a principled manner and clarified its position. "We never thought of silencing her through arrest. But the TVK government behaves like an autocratic and undemocratic government," he said. He accused the TVK government of misusing its power during the byelection and said the arrest of a candidate for questioning the alleged misuse of power smacked of a dictatorial attitude and a sectarian mindset.

"Police officers who arrest people for bailable offences will face the condemnation of courts," he said.

Crackdown on protesters violates India's international legal obligations: UN experts

Kallol Bhattacherjee
NEW DELHI

Against the backdrop of ongoing protests against the deletion of voters from the electoral roll by the Election Commission of India, a group of globally recognised rapporteurs and experts on human rights have said that the recent actions by the Indian security agencies and the police in Delhi violate India's "core international legal obligations".

The UN Human Rights Office has called for independent, impartial and thorough investigation without delay. FILE PHOTO

In a joint statement by the experts, issued by the UN Human Rights Office of the High Commissioner (OHCHR), the experts pointed out that "over 7,000 youths, journalists, human rights defenders" were detained in New Delhi arbitrarily during the protests, and expressed concern over reports of sexual violence.

"These actions violate India's core international legal obligations, including the rights to freedom of peaceful assembly, freedom of expression, liberty, security of the person, and the right to defend human rights," the experts said, adding that, "any restrictions on peaceful assembly must be legal, pursue a legitimate aim, and be necessary and proportionate". The statement said that the crackdown revealed a "broader troubling pattern" wherein the Indian authorities have been using "undue restrictions on peaceful assembly, excessive use of force, arbitrary detentions, enforced disappearances and the targeting of student activists..." Demanding "reparations" , the experts called for "independent, impartial and thorough investigation" into the activities of the law enforcers and associated forces "without delay".

The experts whose names appear in the statement are Gina Romero, Margaret Satterthwaite, Cecilia M. Bailliet, Farida Shaheed, Bethanie Margaret Carney Almroth, Ivana Krstic, Haina Lu, Dorothy Estrada-Tanck, Claudia Flores, Laura Nyirinkindi, Grazyna Baranowska, Ana Lorena Delgadillo Perez, Gabriella Citroni, Aua Balde, Mohammed Al-Obaidi, Astrid Puentes Riano, Elena Carolina Diaz Galan, Sofia Monsalve Suarez, Nicolas Levrat, Leopoldo Maldonado Gutierrez, Andrea Bolanos Vargas, Pau Perez Sales, Reem Alsalem, and Ana Brian Nougreres.

The External Affairs Ministry is yet to respond to the latest remarks from UN human rights experts.

Call to classify assistive devices as essential products

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

A disability rights group has written to the Union government seeking the classification of augmentative and alternative communication (AAC) devices and prostheses as essential assistive products under the draft Rights of Persons with Disabilities (Amendment) Rules, 2026.

Doctors with Disabilities: Agents of Change, an organisation of health professionals with disabilities, said in its communication that the Centre should classify communication aids and prostheses as essential products.

Policy concerns

In a representation to the Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities, the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare and the Indian Council of Medical Research, the group noted that these products, put in the specialised assistive products category, could create uncertainty over access to insurance coverage, public financing, replacement and maintenance.

The draft rules, issued under the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016, propose a framework for standards and accessibility of assistive products and technology. The notification follows a Supreme Court directive calling for clear, non-negotiable accessibility requirements under Section 40 of the Act.

The draft invites objections and suggestions before finalisation.

The AAC devices include picture-based communication boards, speech-generating devices and applications that convert text or symbols into speech.

The group argued that the need for specialist assessment, customisation, fitting or rehabilitation should not determine whether a product is essential. It called for the classification to reflect the role assistive products play in enabling autonomy, participation and the exercise of rights.

Cyclones, floods and landslides threaten telecom resilience

Rahul Karmakar
GUWAHATI

Telecom towers in Assam and Tamil Nadu have a common problem; they are highly vulnerable to cyclonic winds and flooding, a study by the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure said.

The New Delhi-based global coalition comprises 72 members from national governments, international organisations and the private sector.

The coalition's Disaster Risk and Resilience Assessment Framework, developed in collaboration with the Department of Telecommunications and the National Disaster Management Authority, assessed telecom resilience in five high-risk States – Assam, Gujarat, Odisha, Tamil Nadu and Uttarakhand.

The study mapped 48,416 telecom towers across Tamil Nadu and found 57% face high or very high cyclonic wind risk, with major concentrations in Chennai, Chengalpattu, and Tiruvallur. Along with Kanchipuram, Chennai and Chengalpattu also have the highest concentrations of towers exposed to flooding (33% State-wide).

About 14% of the towers are exposed to storm surges exceeding six metres, particularly in Kanchipuram, Thanjavur, and Tirunelveli, the telecom study report said.

Of the 18,388 telecom towers mapped in Assam, 83% were situated in very high cyclonic wind zones, 43% in areas with high flood exposure, and 5% in areas with high landslide exposure.

Over half of telecom towers in Tamil Nadu face high cyclonic wind risk.

The report identified Nagaon, Barpeta, Lakhimpur and Tinsukia among districts particularly prone to flooding, while highlighting landslide exposure affecting telecom towers in Kamrup (Metropolitan), and Dima Hasao.

According to the report, Odisha's telecom towers face threats similar to Tamil Nadu – 57% are exposed to high and very high cyclonic winds, 14% to storm-surge exposure exceeding six metres, and 13% exposed to flooding.

In Gujarat and Uttarakhand, 28% (12,650 structures) and 25% (2,440) of telecom towers are exposed to very high cyclonic winds, respectively. While 12% of Gujarat's telecom towers face flood exposure, 10% of those in Uttarakhand are located in areas with high landslide susceptibility.

Additionally, all towers in Assam and Uttarakhand, and 12% of towers in Gujarat, are located in high and very high seismic zones (Zone IV and V).

Vital for growth

The Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure said telecom resilience is a system-level challenge. Tower exposure is only one aspect – networks can suffer severe outages without direct tower damage when flooding disrupts power, fibre and backhaul connectivity, road access, and generator fuel supplies.

"Telecommunications is vital for economic growth and social development... the sector has contributed about 15% to global GDP in the past decade and is projected to reach a $2.8 trillion market by 2030. In India, with 1.2 billion subscribers, telecommunications enable last-mile connectivity and essential services, and 5G is expected to add $450 billion to the economy from 2023 to 2040," the report said.

The assessment highlights vulnerabilities in power and last-mile connectivity, as well as gaps in disaster preparedness and coordination, given that reliable connectivity is crucial for early warnings, emergency response, healthcare access, and livelihoods, Amit Prothi, Director General, Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure, said.

"These figures describe the exposure of tower locations to hazards; they do not mean that every exposed tower will sustain damage or become non-operational during a disaster," Mr. Prothi told *The Hindu*.

Protection and backup

The coalition recommended combining stronger physical protection with backup networks, reliable power, and better coordination. Practical measures include raising generators to reduce flood exposure, providing flood doors and waterproof cable connections, strengthening tower and antenna design, and maintaining adequate battery backup.

It also recommended assessing requirements for temporary communications systems, including 'Cells on Wheels' and other deployable technologies.

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DRAFT PROPOSAL

In Ladakh plan, L-G gets final authority over laws

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FOCUS ON 'PDA' PLAN

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DATA POINT

Trump's labour crackdown may backfire

The U.S. is ignoring the role of skilled migrants

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PERFECT FINISH

Harmanpreet, Shafali star as India wins 3-0

SPORT » PAGE 15

IN BRIEF

Shah visits Punjab; drug menace in focus ahead of poll

CHANDIGARH
Ahead of the 2027 poll, Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Tuesday visited Punjab and met the families of those who died after speaking out against the drug menace. » Page 10

Rustication orders revoked; JNUSU ends 17-day stir

NEW DELHI
Jawaharlal Nehru University has revoked the rustication of students' union office-bearers, bringing the union's 17-day hunger strike to an end on Tuesday. » Page 2

OPPORTUNITIES » PAGE 3

Rubio pitches oil from U.S., Venezuela in Mumbai visit

External Affairs Minister hosts U.S. Secretary of State, UAE counterpart; Rubio expresses desire to send more Venezuelan oil to Ambani-owned plant in Jamnagar, praises India's refining capacities

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

Calling India a "refining superpower", U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio on Tuesday said he discussed possible Indian oil purchases from the U.S. during talks with External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar, adding that India and the U.S. are "very, very close" to wrapping up negotiations on a much-delayed free trade agreement.

He will also discuss a plan for more Venezuelan oil to be refined at the Mukesh Ambani-owned Reliance Energy plant in Jamnagar, Mr. Rubio said.

Energy ties, trade, and connectivity were on the agenda as Mr. Jaishankar hosted Mr. Rubio and United Arab Emirates Foreign Minister Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan in Mumbai. The External Affairs Minister met with each of his counterparts separately, and then held a meeting with both of them together, indicating that trilateral cooperation on the issues was also discussed.

External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar with U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio and UAE FM Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan. ANI

Mr. Jaishankar called the trilateral meeting a "useful exchange of perspectives on energy, connectivity and contemporary developments".

The trilateral meeting, which was not earlier announced by the External Affairs Ministry, comes at a time when the UAE is facing many challenges in energy exports and trade due to the U.S. war in Iran and Tehran's blockade of the Strait of Hormuz. "The U.S., India, and the UAE have real opportunities to advance cooperation on energy, trade, technology, and regional connectivity," U.S. Ambassador to India Sergio Gor said in a social media post, sharing a photograph of the three leaders together in Mumbai.

However, the comments made no mention of plans for the 'I2U2' that the three countries formed with Israel in 2021 or the India-Middle East Economic Corridor (IMEC) that was announced in 2023.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10
'PERFECTLY ALIGNED' » PAGE 11

Terror ecosystem must be dismantled, Rajnath tells SCO

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

There can be no justification for terrorism and no double standard in tackling the menace, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh said on Tuesday as he called upon the member states of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) to dismantle the entire ecosystem of terrorism.

Speaking at the 25th meeting of the SCO Council of Heads of Government in Dushanbe, Tajikistan, in the presence of Pakistan's Deputy Prime Minister Ishaq Dar, Mr. Singh stressed that there can be no place for "those who provide safe havens to terrorists".

"Terrorism results in the loss of innocent lives and disrupts investment and commerce. It radicalises societies and deprives youth of the opportunities they rightfully deserve. There can be no justification for terrorism, no double standard in addressing it, and no place for those who finance, support, or provide safe havens to terrorists," Mr. Singh said.

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh at a meeting of the SCO Council of Heads of Government in Dushanbe, Tajikistan, on Tuesday. ANI

He recalled Prime Minister Narendra Modi's remarks at the recent SCO Summit in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, calling for concrete steps on security, connectivity, and opportunity.

Mr. Singh said the bloc must adhere to the principles of sovereign equality, consensus, and mutual respect.

The Defence Minister also called for strengthening resilient supply chains, facilitating trade and investment, and leveraging technology to address global uncertainties arising from geopolitical tensions, trade disruptions, and concerns over energy and food security. India supported the adoption of an action plan for the multilateral trade and economic cooperation for the period 2026-2030, he said.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10

Political differences must not hinder national interest: PM

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday identified "forces harming the country, those dividing society, and a mindset hostile to Indian culture" as three enemies of India, urging people and institutions to unite in the national interest.

"Forces that hurt the nation's honour and dignity, people who divide society, and a mindset that hates our culture are enemies of the country," Mr. Modi said while addressing a gathering for the Vijayadashami celebration at the IP Ground in Delhi.

He urged people to identify the "enemies of the nation" and defeat them. Invoking the ideals of Lord Ram, Mr. Modi described Dasara as a symbol of the triumph of righteousness over evil. He called for a collective commitment to national interest, saying political differences should not come in the way of safeguarding the country.

"Let our thoughts be aligned... all the institutions of the nation, all political parties... let us stand together for the national interest. We must proceed with this very spirit; we must fight together against the enemies of the country," he said.

Working together

The Prime Minister said India's progress depends on people and institutions working together to protect the country's values, heritage and social cohesion. He said even in the face of major crises, citizens should not remain passive but recognise their capabilities and work towards solutions.

Reiterating his vision of a self-reliant and developed India, Mr. Modi urged people to translate their determination into strength through hard work and confidence in the country's resources. He said obstacles should not deter the nation from moving forward.

Highlighting social justice and inclusive development, the Prime Minister said the welfare of the poor and underprivileged remains a priority for his government.

Invoking the concept of "Ram Rajya", he said it represents a society free from discrimination, where everyone has access to justice and equal opportunities.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the Vijayadashami celebrations in New Delhi on Tuesday. PTI

Fiery protest

Up in flames: Protesters setting fire to effigies of political leaders during a protest against the killing of three civilians, in Manipur's Imphal East district on Tuesday. PTI (REPORT ON PAGE 10)

Less than 1% of Delhi Form 6s processed

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

Only 1,238 of the 4.5 lakh Form 6 applications seeking inclusion in Delhi's electoral roll have been disposed of in 42 days, data accessed by *The Hindu* show.

With the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls under way, eligible citizens left out of the draft roll, published on August 31, are required to fill Form 6, meant for new voters, in the ongoing claims and objections period to seek inclusion in the final roll.

However, not even 1% of the Form 6 applications have been processed, delaying inclusion. Those disposed of include both accepted and rejected applications.

The delay has raised concerns among citizens seeking re-inclusion in the poll rolls amid the Delhi SIR.

The deadline to dispose of all claims and objections is November 30, and the delay has raised concerns among citizens seeking re-inclusion.

FULL REPORT ON » PAGE 11

China imposes restrictions on export of tunnel-boring, high-altitude machinery

Ananth Krishnan
BEIJING

China has said that it would introduce export controls, starting November 18, on tunnel-boring machines (TBMs) and other heavy machinery used in high-altitude terrain "to better safeguard national security and interests".

Announcing measures that will likely impact exports to India, China's Ministry of Commerce on Monday said "operators exporting the aforementioned items to sensitive countries and regions in dispute with China shall apply for a license", while exports to other countries will require prior registration to obtain certificates. The announcement listed TBMs and other heavy machinery, such as walking excavators and plateau-type wet shotcrete machines, used in construction in mountainous terrain and "altitudes above 3,000 metres". The Ministry said the items covered by the measures "have clear dual-use (civilian and military) characteristics".

The announcement comes amid India's concerns on clearance from China for imports of tunnel-boring machines. FILE PHOTO

"The measures are intended to better safeguard national security and interests, while also enabling China to better fulfil its international obligations, including those related to non-proliferation," the announcement said, adding that China had "notified the relevant countries and regions with which it has established export-control dialogue mechanisms."

The announcement comes days after Beijing unveiled a plan to impose sweeping export controls on 40 cutting-edge technologies including those for certain advanced solar manufacturing and some AI platforms.

India has previously raised with China the delays in customs clearance for imports of TBMs, which are used for several projects, including the construction of Metro rail networks and critical tunnelling projects in border areas.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10

Oppn. accuses BJP govt. in Odisha of 'silence' on disputed region with A.P.

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

Opposition parties in Odisha on Tuesday accused the State unit of the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) of compromising the State's territorial integrity in Kotia and maintaining a "studied silence" on the region, which is claimed by both Odisha and Andhra Pradesh, because of the ruling Telugu Desam Party's (TDP) support to the Narendra Modi government at the Centre.

Both the Biju Janata Dal (BJD) and the Congress voiced concern over Kotia after the TDP-led Andhra Pradesh government issued a notification for holding rural polls in three panchayats on November 28. Former Chief Minister and BJD president Naveen Patnaik has also written to Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi, drawing his attention to the notification.

Tribal women from Kotia on the Andhra-Odisha border region. FILE PHOTO

DETAILS ON » PAGE 4

AAP seeks FIR against Ramlila panel over cockroach effigy

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on Tuesday filed complaints with Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Delhi Police against the organisers of a Ramlila committee in north-west Delhi's Pitampura for installing the effigy of a cockroach, which was later set afire along with those of demon king Ravana, his son Meghnad and brother Kumbhakarna.

End of evil: An effigy of demon king Ravana goes up in flames at a Dasara event in north-west Delhi's Pitampura. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Panel led by a BJP MLA

In his complaint, AAP Delhi unit president Saurabh Bharadwaj sought the registration of an FIR against Shri Keshav Ramlila Committee, including its president and Model Town MLA Ashok Goel from the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), for "hurting religious sentiments of the Hindu community" by installing a 30-foot "insect-themed" effigy at the Delhi Development Authority ground in Netaji Subhash Place, Pitampura.

Cockroach Janta Party founder Abhijeet Dipke thanked organisers for providing "free publicity" to his organisation.

Mr. Goel said they burnt the effigy of the cockroach as a symbol of "filth". He added that Mr. Bharadwaj was "frustrated" after his party lost power in Delhi.

Labour Minister and senior BJP leader Kapil Mishra, who set the cockroach effigy afire, remarked: "The cockroach's effigy is burning, and termites are in pain."

In his complaint, the AAP leader stated Dasara is a sacred event governed by ancient rituals, scriptures and longstanding traditions. "The burning of effigies is associated with mythological figures representing particular forms of evil, as described in the Ramayana. The addition of an insect-themed effigy to a religious ritual distorts sacred traditions, mocks the solemnity of Sanatana customs and deeply hurts the sentiments of the Hindu community," he added.

JNUSU ends 17-day protest after rustication orders of its office-bearers revoked

University agrees to demands such as withdrawing FIRs against union members; V-C highlights democratic nature of administration; JNU forced to bow before collective strength, say students

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) has revoked the rustication of students' union office-bearers Aditi Mishra (president), K. Gopika Babu (vice-president), Sunil Yadav (general secretary) and Danish Ali (joint secretary), and of former JNUSU president Nitish Kumar, bringing the union's 17-day hunger strike to an end on Tuesday.

(From left in front row) JNUSU gen. secy. Sunil Yadav, vice-president K. Gopika Babu and president Aditi Mishra. Joint secy. Danish Ali is seated in the middle of the row behind them. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

'Clear all penalties'

The five students had been rusticated and asked to pay a penalty of ₹20,000 each on February 8 for "vandalism" during a demonstration staged the previous year against the installation of a biometric system for entry into the Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Central Library on the campus.

The students have been asked to clear the fines immediately.

The impasse came to an end after Dean of the School of Social Sciences Vivek Kumar met student representatives on Monday and agreed to revoke the rustication orders, which was among the 13 demands the protesters had placed before the administration.

The university also agreed to withdraw all the FIRs against students for protests in the aftermath of the rustication and to review the 2023 Chief Proctor Office manual on demonstrations, which stipulates stringent fines on protesting students.

While Vice-Chancellor Shantishree Dhulipudi Pandit said JNU never took "extreme action" against the rusticated students who had "destroyed property worth ₹20 lakh", the union said the administration was forced to "bow down before the collective strength of the student community".

Committee on JNUEE

As per the minutes of the meeting between Mr. Kumar and the student representatives on Monday, the administration has agreed to form a committee, which would include a JNUSU representative, to examine bringing back the JNU Entrance Examination (JNUEE) in place of the current admission process that is based on exams conducted by the National Testing Agency.

The university has also agreed to several other demands, which include an audit of the Equal Opportunity Office, forming a panel on hostel reservations, considering a 25% increase in merit-cum-means scholarship and structural audits and renovation of all hostels.

No to 'extreme action'

In a release, Ms. Pandit stated: "This administration has been the most democratic and humanitarian and never took extreme action against the rusticated students for destroying public property worth ₹20 lakh."

She added that the rusticated students had violated all prescribed restrictions, including staying on the campus and participating in all protests, which she described as political, in violation of their bail conditions.

The JNUSU termed its 17-day agitation part of a wider struggle against the "criminalisation of dissent". The union added that it would not let the commitments made by the administration "be reduced to empty promises, indefinite consultations or bureaucratic delays".

The Winter Action Plan will be in force from Nov. 1 to Feb. 28, said CM Rekha Gupta. ANI

Govt. acting early, firmly against foul air, says CM

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday said her government will enforce progressive measures to ensure every resident's right to breathe. "Delhi is acting early and firmly against winter [air] pollution," she said and reiterated the curbs that will come into force over the coming days, including a ban from November 1 to January 31, 2027 on the entry of non-Delhi registered vehicles that don't meet BS-VI or stricter emission norms.

"The Winter Action Plan will remain in force from November 1 to February 28 [2027], with construction and demolition curbs, AI-based site monitoring, 50% work from home and staggered office timings," the CM said. E-buses, metro, last-mile connectivity and carpooling will support the effort, she added.

Two hurt as amusement ride gate breaks open

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Two persons were injured after falling from an amusement ride at a Dasara ground in west Delhi's Vikaspuri on Tuesday, the police said. The two are being treated at RML Hospital. As per a preliminary probe, a gate of 'Mixer Ride' broke open while it was spinning, causing Gudiya, 27, and Ravi, 35, to fall, said a senior officer.

An FIR has been registered under Sections 125(a) (rash or negligent act endangering human life) and 289 (negligent conduct with respect to machinery) of the BNS. The incident was reported at 1.36 a.m., said the officer.

The officer added that the organisers were found to have all the required licences from the agencies concerned. No arrests were made till the time of going to press.

Hygiene lapses found at sweet shops in Chandni Chowk, Okhla, Naraina, Narela

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi government's Food Safety Department has found lapses in hygiene, cleanliness and storage at several sweet manufacturing units across the Capital, according to a statement from the Chief Minister's Office on Tuesday. Audits in Chandni Chowk, Narela, Okhla, Badli and Naraina revealed pest activity in storage areas, employees handling food without gloves, inadequate cleanliness and shortcomings in documentation. The teams collected samples of milk and milk-based items for analysis, the statement added.

'No compromise'

Speaking about inspections ahead of the festive season, CM Rekha Gupta said, "There will be no compromise on citizens' health amid festive celebrations. The government is committed to ensuring that citizens have access to safe and hygienic food. Awareness, accountability and compliance with prescribed standards are essential to protecting public interest and public health."

She added that all food establishments must take full responsibility for complying with rules on hygiene, safe storage, employee training and proper food-handling practices.

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PUBLIC NOTICE

WHEREAS, Adviya Residency LLP is in the process of undertaking development of a Affordable Group Housing Colony (Under AGH Policy - 2013) in Sector-143, Faridabad, Haryana over an area measuring 13.302089 acres in the revenue estate of Village-Sikri, Tehsil Ballabgarh in accordance with the provision of License No. 183 of 2022 dated 11.11.2022, granted by Director, Town & Country Planning, Haryana, Chandigarh.
AND WHEREAS, several individuals have made bookings/entered into purchase agreement for allotment of Residential Apartment/Property & Commercial Shop in the said Affordable Group Housing Colony (hereinafter referred as allottees).
AND WHEREAS, in the building plans earlier approved for the said Affordable Group Housing Colony. It is now proposed to be revised (changes are only "Internal changes in commercial block and rest all is same").
AND WHEREAS, the office of Director, Town & Country Planning, Haryana, Chandigarh has required seeking of objections/suggestions against the revision of building plan as a pre-condition for allowing such revision in the Building Plan.
Accordingly, vide this Public Notice, objections are hereby invited from any of the allottees in the said colony on the proposed revision (changes are only "Internal changes in commercial block and rest all is same") of the Building Plan of the said colony. A copy of the earlier approved building plan vide Memo No. ZP-1956/AD(GK)/2024/12756 Dated: 25/04/2024 & the building plan now proposed to be revised vide Memo No. ZP-1956-II/PA(DK)/2026/36409 Dated 14/10/2026 is available for perusal on our website (www.advitya.co.in). The said building plan can also be perused at the site office of Advitya Residency LLP at 42 Milestone, Near Golden Galaxy, Village Sikri, Sector 143, Faridabad, Haryana as well as in the office of Senior Town Planner (P), HSVP Complex, Sector-12, Faridabad, Haryana.
Any allottee having any objection in revised Building Plan, may file his objection in the office of Senior Town Planner (P), HSVP Complex, Sector-12, Faridabad, Haryana and in the office of the undersigned within thirty (30) days of publication of this notice, failing which it shall be assumed that there are no objections to the proposed revision in the building plan.

Mukesh Kumar Aggarwal, Partner
For Advitya Residency LLP
42 Milestone, Near Golden Galaxy,
Village Sikri, Sector 143, Faridabad, Haryana
Phone no. 9555112233, Website: www.advitya.co.in

Place: Faridabad
Date: 19.10.2026

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

1st Year Remembrance

Birth : 10/02/1966
Joined Heaven : 21/10/2025

Officially G.PADMINI
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Ponni ma & Paddu

A Softer call, a warmer sound,
Your helping hand, loving voice,
affection, cuddling filled
all our Homes. Holding your
memories close to my hearts
believing that you will come
one day

V. Muralidharan (Retd. S.Rly) - Husband
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NOTICE INVITING TENDER

1.	Date of Publication on website	16-10-2026
2.	Downloading of tender documents, start date	16-10-2026
3.	Pre-bid meeting with bidders	21-10-2026 at 01.00 PM
4.	Uploading of tender documents start date	23-10-2026
5.	Due date/time	29-10-2026
6.	Opening of tender	30-10-2026

e-NITNo.MHCJ/Tech/e-NIT/2026-27/11 dated:16/10/2026 due on 29/10/2026

S.No.	Description	Details
1	Bid Document Fee & Mode of Payment	₹ 5,000.00 (In the shape of Treasury Challan or online mode or Demand Draft in favour of Superintending Engineer, Mechanical & Hospital Circle Jammu payable at Jammu)Account no. 0077010200000062 in the name of The Superintending Engineer, Mechanical & Hospital Circle, Jammu Branch code:0077, IFSC: JAKA0GANDHI (Please read zero between JAKA and Gandhi), MICR CODE: 180051008.
2.	Estimated Cost of the Project	Rs.3,40,00,000.00 (Rupees Three crore forty lakh only)
3.	EMD & Mode of Payment	Rs 6.80 lacs (In the shape of CDR/FDR pledged to Superintending Engineer, Mechanical & Hospital Circle Jammu).
4.	Time of completion	Sixty (60 days) from the date of placement of Letter of Award / Allotment order.
5.	Performance Security and validity period	The Successful bidder or Contractor shall submit unconditional and and irrevocable Performance security in the shape of BG/CDR/FDR @ 5% of contract value pledged to the Superintending Engineer, Mechanical & Hospital Circle, Jammu valid for 40 months. The said performance security shall be released after completion of warranty period and Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract (CAMC) beyond defect Liability Period.
6	Bid Validity Period	180 days from the date of opening of Price Bid.
7	Defect Liability period	01 year (12 months) from the day of successful completion and commissioning of works.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
Mechanical & Hospital Circle
Jammu

DIP/J-12717/26

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE
Bangalore - 560012
IISc/CCMD/Tenders/2026-27 Date: 16.10.2026

Tender Notification- IISc/ Tender-CIV-10/2026-27

Indian Institute of Science invites bids in two cover system through e-procurement platform **https://eprocure.gov.in.** Any specialized firms company registered under KPWD/ CPWD/ railways/ MES/ central PSUs/ or any Government department of **Class I/ Class A Civil Contractors** are eligible to apply for the work of **"Renovation work of Gents & Ladies toilet in Mechanical Department in IISc".** Estimated Cost of Project is **Rs. 19,45,642.00 (Incl. of GST).** Last date of receipt of application is **05th November 2026 at 15:30 Hrs.** Any other details can be obtained from the office of the Centre for Campus Management & Development, Indian Institute of Science, Bangalore on all working days or e-mail **office.ccmd@iisc.ac.in**

Sd/-, Registrar

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE
Bangalore - 560012
IISc/CCMD/Tenders/2026-27 Date: 16.10.2026

Tender Notification- IISc/ Tender-ELE-05/2026-27

Indian Institute of Science invites bids in two cover system through e-procurement platform **https://eprocure.gov.in.** Any specialised firms company registered under KPWD/ CPWD/ railways/ MES/ central PSUs/ or any Government department of **Class I/Class A Electrical Contractors** are eligible to apply for the work of **"Providing 120 KVA UPS & replacement of main LT panels for main building at IISc".** Estimated Cost of Project is **Rs. 1,15,88,594.00.** Last date of receipt of application is **05th November 2026 at 15:30 Hrs.** Any other details can be obtained from the office of the Centre for Campus Management & Development, Indian Institute of Science, Bangalore on all working days or e-mail **office.ccmd@iisc.ac.in**

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Office of the Deputy General Manager-1, BSWML, 1st Floor, BBMP Building, Thimmaiah Road, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 052

No: DGM-1/BSWML/TEND/33/2026-27 Date: 19.10.2026

INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER (Only through GOK KPP Portal) Call-03

The Deputy General Manager-1, Bengaluru Solid Waste Management Limited on behalf of the Managing Director, BSWML, Bengaluru invites bids from eligible bidders for the Services mentioned in the table given below.

Sl No	Name of Work	Amount put to tender per annum (Rs.in Lakhs)	EMD (In Rs)	Cost of Tender Document	Contract period
1	Primary Collection and Secondary Transportation of Municipal solid waste (MSW) and Street sweeping waste in Bangalore South-2 division (Package-21) Call-3	955.72	Rs.1,00,000/- through e payment mode under of the following i.e., online / RTGS/ NEFT / OTC and the balance Rs.13,34,000/- by bank Guarantee/FDR issued by Nationalized /scheduled Bank	As per e-Portal	84 Months

(1) Tender documents can be downloaded from KPP Portal : **19.10.2026, (2)** Last date to upload pre-bid queries in KPP Portal: **23.10.2026 before 11.00 hrs. (3)** Tender Pre Bid meeting : **23.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs. at above mentioned office. (4)** Last Date of Receipt of Tender : **30.10.2026 before 17.00 hrs. (5)** Opening of Technical Bid : **31.10.2026 after 17.30 hrs.**
More details can be downloaded from website **-https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**

Sd/-
Deputy General Manager-1, BSWML.

DIPR/CP/3316/SHIRDI SAI/2026-27

ZONAL HEADQUARTERS EOW CRIME BRANCH JAMMU
e-Mail ID:sspcrimejmu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice

It is informed to the General Public through the medium of this Hue and cry Notice that the accused person, namely Manzoor Ahmed Khan S/o Gulam Rasool Khan, R/o Brar Chattibandey, Tehsil & District Bandipora, is involved in the case FIR No. 15/2022 u/s 420, 465, 467, 468, 471, 120B IPC, r/w section 66-D IT Act. 2000 of police Station Crime Branch, EOW, Jammu. This agency requires the arrest of the above-mentioned accused person for legal proceedings, but the accused person is deliberately evading his arrest since the registration of the instant case.
As such, anybody having knowledge/information about his whereabouts may please inform SSP Crime Branch Jammu by **E-mail ID:-sspcrimejmu@jkpolice.gov.in** or ph. Nos. 0191-257890/9479782138. The photograph of the accused person is attached herewith. The identity of the informer shall be kept secret

NO:- CBJ/EOW/RS/26/30198 Dt. 17.10.2026

Sr.
Superintendent of Police,
Economic Offence Wing
Crime Branch, Jammu

DIP/J-12709/26

Cong. plans 'Uttarakhand Nyay Yatra'

Press Trust of India
DEHRADUN

Gearing up for the 2027 Assembly election, the Uttarakhand Congress unit on Tuesday shared a roadmap for 'Uttarakhand Nyay Yatra', where the party will reach out to the public to highlight the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government's "anti-people policies" and the "pressing issues facing the State".

Party leaders said the yatra will be conducted across the Assembly constituencies in Dehradun district.

On Tuesday, the State Congress held a meeting chaired by ex-State president Pritam Singh, the chairman of the party's election campaign committee.

Manifesto release on Constitution Day to focus on 'PDA' plan, says SP

The document will incorporate separate sections on women, youth, and law and order, reflecting party's commitment to these issues apart from its focus on social justice and equality in the State

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav announced on X that the manifesto will highlight party's outreach to backward classes, Dalits and minority communities. FILE PHOTO

The Samajwadi Party (SP) will release its election manifesto for the upcoming 2027 Assembly poll, titled 'Jan-Man Manifesto', on November 26 to coincide with 1949 adoption of the Constitution.

Party president Akhilesh Yadav announced on X on Monday that the manifesto will highlight SP's outreach to backward classes, Dalits and minority communities.

"The manifesto will focus on socially and economically marginalised sections of the society, including women, backward classes, Scheduled Castes (SCs), minorities and other neglected sections. We will also include separate documents for women, youth and a manifesto on law and order. It will include our commitment to various groups of people," said former U.P. Chief Secretary Alok Ranjan, who has closely worked with the party on policy issues.

SP spokesperson Nasser Salim elaborated on the symbolism of the Constitution Day date.

"This manifesto is not merely a political document, but a public covenant inspired by the ideals of justice, liberty, equality and fraternity. It reflects our commitment to the constitutional empowerment of PDA [Pichhda, Dalit, Alpsankhyak or Backwards, Dalits and minorities] and every citizen of India," he said.

Significance of the date

"The date is significant as Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, a Dalit community icon, was the leading figure in the drafting of the Constitution. Selecting November 26 will give further weight to the party's social justice plank," said Asad Rizvi, a Lucknow-based political analyst.

Pinarayi questions SMA drug 'trial' in govt. hospital

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Even as the Leader of the Opposition in the Kerala Assembly, Pinarayi Vijayan, alleged that "experimental drugs" meant for "clinical trials" were being distributed to spinal muscular atrophy (SMA) patients, the government-run SAT Hospital has clarified that only drugs ratified by the Central Drugs Standards Control Organisation (CDSCO) are being distributed to SMA patients.

Mr. Vijayan, in a statement on Tuesday, said the "negligent stance" of the Health Minister was criminal and demanded that the government conduct an enquiry into the incident.

He said that the parents of SMA patients themselves had pointed out that the medicines distributed through SAT Hospital, Thiruvananthapuram, were marked "Physician Sample" and "For Clinical Trials Only," and that this is a blatant violation of the Drugs and Cosmetics rules and of all procurement norms. The Health Department cannot evade responsibility for this, the statement said.

Hospital refutes claim

However, SAT's Superintendent clarified that the drug distributed in the hospital on Monday was the very same drug that is being given to SMA patients. "The only difference was that it was the generic version of the patented original formula by Roche, manufactured by Natco Pharma and approved by drug regulatory bodies in the country. The drug is priced 97% lower than its patented version, making it possible for the government to give the drug free of cost to more patients," a statement issued by the SAT Hospital said.

SAT Hospital has been running an SMA clinic since 2022.

At the time, Roche Pharma was the only firm that was licensed to produce and market the drug Risdiplam for SMA. The cost of one bottle of 60 ml was ₹6.3 lakh.

Kerala is the only State to utilise public funds for providing free SMA treatment to children. With more children being identified with the disease and getting registered for free treatment, sustaining the free drug supply was becoming a problem.

SIR must for checking inflow of 'outsiders', says Arunachal BJP

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The Arunachal Pradesh unit of the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) has backed the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, emphasising the need for accurate voters' lists amid concerns over inflow of "illegal migrants".

Arunachal Pradesh has 26 major tribes and more than 120 sub-tribes, some with a population of a few thousand. Most of these communities see the SIR as a shield to protect their land, culture, and identity against numerically larger "outsiders".

The State has experienced tension between the Arunachal Pradesh Scheduled Tribes (APSTs) and the non-APSTs in areas bordering Assam. It also went through a tense phase during the SIR exercise in areas inhabited by the Buddhist Chakmas and Hindu Hajongs, who were settled in the 1960s after displacement in East Pakistan, now Bangladesh.

Speaking at a party meeting in East Kameng district on Monday, BJP State general secretary Tadar Niglar underscored the importance of the SIR in maintaining correct, updated voters' lists.

"Electoral roll revision is a structured process and should not be misrepresented as an arbitrary exercise. Procedural safeguards involved in SIR demonstrate the importance of verification, transparency and opportunities for eligible voters to raise claims or objections before the final roll is published," he said.

He also criticised the protests staged by the Cockroach Janta Party and the Congress-led INDIA bloc, terming their "disruptive actions" as politically motivated.

'File FIR in NSUI leader's assault case'

The Hindu Bureau
JAIPUR

Senior Congress leaders and party workers staged an overnight protest at the Jaipur Police Commissionerate on Tuesday demanding registration of a first information report (FIR) over the alleged assault on NSUI national secretary Ritu Barala during a recent protest in New Delhi.

While the police refused to register the FIR, the protesting leaders, led by Pradesh Congress Committee president Govind Singh Dotasra, stayed put and slept in the corridor during the night. Mr. Dotasra said the protesters would leave only after an FIR is registered. Outside the Commissionerate office, a large number of party workers gathered and raised slogans. The police used mild force to disperse the protesters.

Ms. Barala alleged that a Delhi Police woman constable had assaulted her inside a bus carrying the detained protesters during a demonstration over Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar on October 13 and seven to eight women police personnel assaulted her later at Connaught Place police station.

Timings
DELHI

WEDNESDAY, OCT. 21		
RISE	06:25	SET 17:46
RISE	14:51	SET 01:26
THURSDAY, OCT. 22		
RISE	06:26	SET 17:45
RISE	15:21	SET 02:22
FRIDAY, OCT. 23		
RISE	06:27	SET 17:44
RISE	15:51	SET 03:21

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	32	17
Safdarjang	32	17
Palam	29	17

Delhi Palam Today
32°C The weather will be dry. Day will be little warm. Night will be slight cool.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
33°C Morning will be slight cool with mist and haze. Day will be warm. Night also will be pleasant. Dry weather to continue.

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INBRIEF

Digvijaya embarks on Ujjain to Ayodhya 'Satya Sanatan Yatra'

Senior Congress leader Digvijaya Singh embarked on 'Satya Sanatan Swabhiman Yatra', a walkathon aimed at spreading the 'core ideals of the Sanatan culture', on Tuesday, Vijayadashami. A group of seers is leading the procession. The padyatra, which began in Ujjain, will cover a distance of around 930 kilometres before reaching Ayodhya. Before commencing the foot march, Mr. Singh, a former Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister, visited the Chintaman Ganesh temple in Ujjain to offer prayers. Then he sought the blessings of Lord Mahakal at the Mahakaleshwar temple and also visited the Harsiddhi temple. PTI

Delhi mosque 'eviction notice': Mirwaiz expresses concern

Chief cleric of Kashmir Mirwaiz Umar Farooq on Tuesday expressed concern over a reported eviction notice to the historic Race Course Mosque in New Delhi, a gazetted waqf property since 1977 and a listed heritage site. He said the failure of the waqf authorities to defend the mosque was also alarming. "This is precisely why we strongly opposed the Waqf amendments and increased government control through appointed nominees over Muslim religious endowments. If even a legally recognised mosque cannot be protected, what safeguards remain for others?" he wrote on X. PTI

Oppn. accuses BJP govt. in Odisha of 'silence' on disputed region with A.P.

Furore over Andhra Pradesh notification to conduct rural elections in three panchayats in Kotia on Nov. 28; BJD and Congress allege Majhi govt. in a bind due to TDP's support to Central govt.

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

To win over the residents of Kotia, on the Andhra-Odisha border, the govts. of both States have announced welfare schemes. FILE PHOTO

The Biju Janata Dal (BJD) and Congress on Tuesday accused the Odisha unit of Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) of compromising the State's territorial integrity in Kotia due to the Telugu Desam Party's (TDP) support for the Narendra Modi government at the Centre and keeping a 'studied silence' about the region being claimed by both Odisha and Andhra Pradesh.

The Opposition parties voiced concern about Kotia after the TDP-led Andhra Pradesh government issued a notification for conducting rural polls in three panchayats on November 28. Former Chief Minister and BJD chief Naveen Patnaik has written to Odisha CM Mohan Charan Majhi drawing his attention to the notification.

Odisha's Revenue and Disaster Management Minister Suresh Pujari, who was at home for Dasara holiday on Tuesday, held a review meeting virtually with senior officials, including the department's Secretary Arabinda Padhee, Revenue Divisional Commissioner (Southern Division) Sangram Keshari Mohapatra and Koraput District Magistrate Manoj Satyawan Mahajan from Sambalpur district. Mr. Pujari instructed Mr. Mahajan and Koraput's Superintendent of Police to keep a close watch on the situation in Kotia.

Odisha and Andhra Pradesh have been locked in a territorial dispute over Kotia for more than seven decades dating back to March 1955 when Andhra officials attempted to collect rent from villagers. Efforts by then Union Home Minister Y.B. Chavan to resolve the dispute failed, prompting Odisha to move the Supreme Court in 1968.

In order to win over the local populace, Andhra Pradesh stepped up the implementation of welfare schemes in the region after 2015. Reacting to it, Odisha formed an inter-departmental committee in 2018 to monitor welfare activities and road construction by Andhra Pradesh. The then BJD government had announced a special package of over ₹100 crore for Kotia's development. Both States subsequently held panchayat elections in the disputed region in 2021 and 2022. A majority of voters in Kotia's villages hold voter identity cards of both States.

"The BJP government in Odisha had formed a high-powered committee on the Kotia issue. It was hardly convened once or twice and the meeting outcomes were never made public. If the Odisha government dares to take action against Andhra Pradesh, there is a possibility that the Narendra Modi government could collapse," claimed BJD MLA Arun Sahoo.

'Govt. has surrendered'

Odisha Congress unit president Bhakta Charan Das also levelled a similar allegation. "Why the silence? What we have understood is that the BJP at the Centre depends on the TDP's support. For this reason, the Odisha's BJP government has surrendered," he said.

CM Suvendu Adhikari interacting with the grieving family of a stampede victim at Arambag in Hooghly district on Tuesday. ANI

Appoint retired judge to probe stampede, HC tells Bengal govt.

Press Trust of India
KOLKATA

The Calcutta High Court on Tuesday directed that the West Bengal government set up a commission of inquiry headed by a retired judge of the court to inquire into the stampede at Chorbagan Durga puja pandal on October 17 that claimed 19 lives.

A Division Bench presided over by Chief Justice Ravindra V. Ghuge said a sitting judge of the High Court cannot be appointed to head an inquiry in accordance with a Supreme Court directive, as sought for by the State government. The Bench said a retired judge of the Calcutta High Court can be chosen by the West Bengal government to head the inquiry commission into the cause of the stampede and the people responsible for the incident.

Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari had earlier said that a sitting judge of the High Court would head a special investigation team to be formed to probe the incident.

Special sitting

The Vacation Bench of the court, in a special sitting on Navami of the Durga Puja, was hearing a PIL by a lawyer seeking an independent and speedy probe into the stampede on Saptami, the first day of the festival.

SEE ALSO » PAGE 10

Medical interns resume strike in J&K hospitals over U.T. govt.'s 'failure' on stipend hike promise

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

MBBS and BDS interns staging a protest demanding an increase in their monthly stipend, in Jammu on Tuesday. ANI

Hundreds of medical interns at government-run hospitals in Jammu and Kashmir went on strike on Tuesday over the government's alleged failure to implement a promised stipend hike, despite a written assurance a month ago. They also alleged that officials had attempted to "intimidate the protesters".

Failure of talks

The interns resumed their strike a day after talks between their representatives and the government failed to resolve their demand to raise the monthly stipend from ₹12,300 to ₹30,000. The meeting was held with the Officer on Special Duty (OSD) to Health Minister Sakina Masood Itoo and the Director-General of Finance.

"We have seen 'approvals' and 'assurances' before. This time, J&K MBBS and BDS interns will not call off the strike on verbal claims or media reports. We will end our agitation only after the official government order is issued and implemented immediately," Mohammad Tasadduk Kawser, joint secretary of the Jammu and Kashmir chapter of the All India Medical Students Association, wrote on X.

"Instead of a concrete resolution, we were met with humiliating remarks. The OSD reportedly told us that the government was doing us a favour by providing free medical education. Since when has public expenditure become anyone's personal charity? The money belongs to the taxpayers of J&K, not to Ministers or bureaucrats," said Mr. Kawser.

Defeat leaders who oppose Maratha quota, Jarange urges people

Press Trust of India
BEED (MAHARASHTRA)

Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange-Patil on Tuesday urged the community to defeat political leaders who oppose reservation in the coming elections.

Addressing a Dasara rally at Narayangad pilgrimage site in Beed tehsil, Mr. Jarange-Patil slammed the Devendra Fadnavis government over the "meagre" drought compensation of ₹5,000 for crisis-hit farmers. He alleged that Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde secured ₹500 crore from the BJP and funnelled it via his son and MP Shrikant Shinde. "Mr. Shinde should answer. I have proof," Mr. Jarange-Patil said.

He said elected representatives had amassed enormous personal wealth while leaving ordinary citizens and poor Marathas in dire distress.

The Maratha leader also demanded swift clearance of pending crop insurance dues.

Sena ultimatum

Meanwhile, Shiv Sena leader Sanjay Lakhe-Patil on Tuesday threatened to file a defamation suit seeking ₹1 in damages from the Maratha quota activist over his allegations.

"If you know the details of the alleged payment, you must also name the BJP leader who gave you this information," Mr. Lakhe-Patil said, giving Mr. Jarange-Patil until Wednesday evening to disclose the name.

"Jarange-Patil is acting at the behest of someone within the BJP. He should reveal the source of his claim that the money had been routed through Shinde's son Shrikant," Mr. Lakhe-Patil said in a video statement.

Activists seek Odisha Governor's intervention to secure release of arrested anti-mining protesters

The Hindu Bureau
BHUBANESWAR

In a petition to Governor Braj Mohan Ram, activists claimed that the police are resorting to indiscriminate arrests. ANI

Human rights activists have approached Odisha Governor Braj Mohan Ram seeking his intervention to secure the release of people who were arrested for allegedly opposing bauxite mining at Sijimali hill, which straddles Rayagada and Kalahandi districts.

In a petition sent to the Governor on Monday, activist Prafulla Samantara stated, "Since many Dalit and tribal people are opposing bauxite mining at Sijimali, the police in Kalahandi and Rayagada districts are resorting to indiscriminate arrests."

"When an industrial or mining project comes to an area, it is natural that the affected local people question its viability and express their apprehensions about the loss of livelihood and the socio-economic and ecological impact on their community life. People have the right to carry out peaceful protests. However, people are arrested on false and fabricated criminal charges as the administration is trying to stifle voices of protest," it added.

The Sijimali bauxite block was allocated to the Vedanta Group in 2023.

According to activist Ranjana Padhi, two activists, Randall Sequeira and Laxman Naik, associated with the resistance to the Sijimali bauxite mining project, were picked up from Bhabanipatna in Kalahandi district on October 16. Ms. Padhi alleged that family members and lawyers were not allowed access to the activists.

Mr. Samantara said it was "unfortunate" that tribal leader Lada Sikaka of Niyamgiri was facing several non-bailable charges in old cases in which his name did not figure in the chargesheets. Vedanta Group chairman Anil Agarwal in a recent statement had said the Niyamgiri bauxite reserve should be reopened for mining.

"Although gram sabhas rejected the mining proposal in the Niyamgiri hills and there has been no agitation by tribals, they are being unnecessarily targeted," Mr. Samantara said, adding that Mr. Sequeira and Mr. Naik were victims of "police repression".

Allahabad HC directive to hold panchayat polls in U.P. puts ruling party in a fix

NEWS ANALYSIS

Anuj Kumar
GHAZIABAD (U.P.)

While U.P. panchayat elections are fought without official party symbols, they heavily influence grassroots politics. FILE PHOTO

"Before May, we could get work of ₹5 lakh done at the gram sabha level. Now, for even ₹10 lakh worth of work, we need approval from the district administration," said a village pradhan from Kasganj district in Uttar Pradesh, citing the delay in panchayat elections in the State.

The Allahabad High Court's directive last week to the Uttar Pradesh government and the State Election Commission (SEC) to complete the three-tier panchayat elections within three months has sparked conversations in village *chaupals*.

The State government had deferred the elections, due after the previous term expired in May 2026, to await a report from the Dedicated Backward Classes Commission on Other Backward Classes (OBC) reservations. The government put an interim arrangement in place where the outgoing gram pradhans are temporarily functioning as administrators until the new elected bodies take charge.

However, the High Court ruled that the polls cannot be delayed past constitutional limits and must proceed under the existing 27% OBC reservation framework. The figure comes from the previous exercise before the 2021 poll, when, instead of a triple-test survey that investigates political backwardness, the State conducted a rapid survey to estimate the OBC population for reservation purposes.

Political observers and Opposition leaders argued that the State government knew the May 2026 expiration date and could have set up the commission months, or even a year, in advance to prevent a governance vacuum. They reminded the court that the Supreme Court-mandated "triple test" formula for providing OBC reservations in local body elections has been in place since 2010 and was made mandatory by the Supreme Court in 2021.

Welcoming the High Court order, Panchayati Raj Minister Om Prakash Rajbhar said the State is ready to hold the polls. "The High Court has issued its order; the Backward Classes Commission should take care of the matter. What do we have to do? We are ready to comply with the order. Once the commission's report is submitted, why would there be any need to approach the apex court?" he said at a press conference.

However, Rashtriya Panchayatiraj Gram Pradhan Sangathan, an organisation that advocates for the rights of village heads and panchayati raj institutions, said it would challenge the order in the Supreme Court because the top court requires quota for OBCs against its triple-test formula, which states if test requirements (including forming a dedicated panel) are not met, the seats reserved for OBCs must be treated as unreserved/open category seats.

Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav, Congress MP Tanuj Punia, and Aam Aadmi Party leader Sanjay Singh have also flagged discrepancies in voter lists. While several States borrow, sync, or adopt the Election Commission of India's (ECI) master voter list for local elections, U.P. is one of the few exceptions, strictly maintaining its own independent electoral rolls for local body polls.

Bid to avoid bad blood

According to sources in the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and its ally Rashtriya Lok Dal (RLD), the panchayat elections were put on the back burner because the ruling dispensation didn't want to create "bad blood amid its rural cadre in an election year". While U.P. panchayat elections are fought without official party symbols, they heavily influence grassroots politics. When a political party backs a specific candidate, parties feel the rejected contender and his supporters may turn against it in a subsequent Assembly election. "It is a well-recognised dynamic in rural politics, but you have to live with it, and the panchayat poll is considered a kind of semifinal," said a hopeful with BJP links. "It seems the party wants to go straight into the final," he said.

An RLD insider said there is meaningful silence on the ground because people know the government is not in a mood to conduct panchayat polls before the 2027 Assembly election. "Had it been conducted in May, we were ready, but now with little gap between the two polls, it is neither practically nor politically viable," he said.

T.N. sanctions scheme for guaranteed 150-day work

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government has accorded administrative sanction for 'Vetri 150', a scheme to provide an additional 25 days of employment, with State funds, to registered vulnerable rural households that complete the 125 days of guaranteed employment under the Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G).

Enhancing the minimum guaranteed employment to 150 days for rural households was part of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam manifesto for the 2026 Assembly election.

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Help sugar cane growers, Karnataka CM urges Centre

Govt. should continue procurement of cane-based ethanol and increase minimum selling price of sugar so that mills and factories can pay fair price to growers, says Shivakumar in letter to PM

The Hindu Bureau
BELAGAVI

Distress times: Sugar cane growers staging a protest at Kalaburagi recently seeking higher prices. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar has sought the urgent intervention of the Union government in resolving the crisis faced by sugar cane farmers. The farmers have been on a protest path seeking higher prices for sugar, cane, and ethanol.

In a letter to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the Chief Minister presented a list of demands that include policy changes.

The State government would fulfil some of their demands including monitoring of sugar factories, he said. He urged Mr. Modi to revise the minimum selling price of sugar that has remained unchanged since 2019 and to reconsider the exclusion of sugar cane-based ethanol from procurement tenders. Mr. Shivakumar also sought an increase in the price of sugar cane-based ethanol.

"The minimum selling price of sugar has remained at ₹31 per kg since February 14, 2019, whereas the fair and remunerative price for sugarcane (that factories are mandated to pay farmers) has increased from ₹2,750 to ₹3,650 a tonne. Given the sugar price levels of 2019, mills are unable to pay the fair price for cane. Therefore, the minimum selling price of sugar should be revised," he said.

Mr. Shivakumar urged the Centre to reconsider its decision not to procure cane-based ethanol owing to drought and rising sugar prices. "This will adversely affect sugar mills and diminish their ability to make timely payments to farmers," he said.

Keralam govt. seeks FSSAI criteria on food with high levels of fat, sugar, salt

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM:

The Keralam government will strengthen all legal measures to curb unhealthy eating habits among children and prevent excessive consumption of junk food, Health Minister K. Muraleedharan said.

The State would approach the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) seeking clarity on the definition of HFSS (high fat, sugar and salt) food and on the criteria for regulating their sale, he said in a statement here.

As junk food has no precise scientific definition, there is no clarity on which food items should be included in this category or how their sale should be regulated. Foods containing high levels of fat, sugar and salt can be classified as HFSS, but clear criteria and guidelines are needed to fix the upper limits. At present, it is the absence of such criteria which is hampering efforts to draw up a list of HFSS food and to regulate its sales near schools.

On August 7, 2026, the FSSAI published a draft regulation on this. The draft proposes that if solid food contains more than 4.2 g of fat, 3 g of sugar or 0.625 g of salt per 100 g, it should be considered as high levels. Mr. Muraleedharan said the State would write to the FSSAI requesting that criteria be finalised without delay.

Karnataka BJP predicts rebellion in Cong.

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

BJP State unit president B.Y. Vijayendra has said dissidence in the ruling Congress in Karnataka had reached a flashpoint, and senior leaders as well as MLAs were set to rebel against Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar. Interacting with mediapersons on Tuesday, he claimed, "Mr. Shivakumar is frustrated as senior Congress leaders and MLAs are set to raise a banner of revolt against him." However, he ruled out any possibilities of the BJP trying to remove the government.

Caste groups line up rallies as U.P. Assembly election season picks up

The Hindu Bureau
LUCKNOW

Members of the Tyagi Brahmin Bhumihar Samaj Samiti at a gathering in Saharanpur. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Several caste-centric social organisations are preparing to mobilise members and hold large gatherings in Uttar Pradesh over the coming days as the 2027 Assembly election campaigns by various parties pick up pace. Outfits representing Brahmin, Bhumihar, and Kushwaha communities have planned multiple programmes across the State in the days ahead, which some see as shows of strength ahead of ticket distribution.

On October 11, one such body – the Tyagi Brahmin Bhumihar Samaj Samiti – organised a gathering in Saharanpur, where speakers pushed for an anti-dowry drive, better education, fight against social evils, and political awareness.

Himanshu Bharadwaj, a member of the Parsuram Yuva Jagriti Manch, a Brahmin caste-centric social organisation, said, "Attempts are being made to marginalise us. We will raise our demands to set up a Brahmin Welfare Board and press for the community's representation in the ticket distribution process."

The group will host a community gathering in the last week of October in Shamli district, he said.

Key demands

Sarv Kushwaha Chetna Sangh, a social outfit focused on issues pertaining to the Other Backward Classes, has planned a conference in Jaunpur on October 28. "We want economic and social upliftment. Our share in government and private jobs is low. Hence, it is necessary for us to be united and raise issues," said Madhukar Kushwaha, a member of the outfit.

THE HINDU IN SCHOOL PRESENTS SCHOOL BUZZ
A Newspaper exclusively curated for School Students

ALL-INDIA SPORTS MEET HELD

Bal Bharati Public School, GRH Marg, hosted the 17th All-India Sports Meet, organised by the Sports Council of Child Education Society (CES), with 1,100 players from 24 units competing in seven disciplines. Guest of Honour Mr. Ashok Dhyanchand, Arjuna awardee and former Olympian, and Guest of Distinction Dr. Piyush Jain, General Secretary, PEFI, attended. Mr. Nikhil Channa, CES President, declared the meet open. Mr. Khullar, Ms. Asha Prabhakar, Mr. Laksh Vir Sehgal, Ms. Meenu Goswami and Principal Mr. Deepak Dua were present. The mascot, Agnix, was unveiled amid cultural performances.

ANNUAL DAY CELEBRATED

Salwan Public School, Gurugram, celebrated their Annual Day under the theme 'Suno Bhai Sadho – A Symphony of the Soul', inspired by Sant Kabir's teachings. Chief Guest Major General Cyrus Addie Pithawala, Ashoka Chakra, Vishisht Seva Medal, Guest of Honour Capt. Indu Boken Kasana, District Education Officer, and alumnus Shri Dinker Sharma, actor-director, attended. Officiating Principal Dr. Sunita Jakhar presented the annual report, and Chairman Dr. Prasad Medury addressed the gathering. Musical performances and dance-dramas were staged, and meritorious students, including Muskan Gupta, district topper in CBSE Class XII, were felicitated.

CYBER HYGIENE MUN HELD

The Manthan School, Greater Noida West, hosted the two-day Cyber Hygiene Model United Nations, organised under the Information Security Education and Awareness Project of MeitY, with support from C-DAC and CERT-In. Delegates from over 20 schools deliberated on cybersecurity and digital ethics in the UNGA, UNHRC and International Press committees. The inaugural was graced by (Retd.) Wing Commander Saumya Seth and Dr. Rakshit Tandon, Cyber Crime Consultant, Uttar Pradesh Police. Mr. Sumit Srivastava, Project Manager, C-DAC, and Mr. Manoj Chandra Undi, Scientist 'E' and Additional Director, Government of India, attended the valedictory. The host school won Best School Team.

For Subscription related queries, please contact Kapil Nagar:
Handphone:+91 9810089457/Email: kapil.nagar@thehindu.co.in

TDP trying to stop us from fighting local body polls, says YSRCP

Press Trust of India
AMARAVATI

Andhra Pradesh YSRCP coordinator Sajjala Ramakrishna Reddy on Tuesday said alleged "attacks, intimidation" and criminal cases will not force the party out of the ongoing local bodies elections.

The Opposition party leader demanded an inquiry by a sitting High Court judge into alleged police firing in Pulivendula recently, claiming that officers opened fire without provocation while Opposition candidates were trying to file nominations.

"Attacks, intimidation and criminal cases will not force YSRCP out of elections," Mr. Reddy said in a YSRCP press release.

He alleged that the TDP-led coalition government was "preventing nominations, coercing withdrawals and engineering rejections" before celebrating "unopposed victories".

Police attacks

"Chief Minister Chandrababu Naidu and his media were portraying this exclusion as public support while blaming the YSRCP for violence committed by ruling party groups. "The police are going further.. and are directly attacking and obstructing candidates," he alleged.

Caste and no-dues certificates were being delayed while candidates faced threats, he alleged.

Meanwhile, the TDP posted a message on X claiming that the YSRCP's agenda was "rowdyism and winning elections to obstruct development."

HC refuses to drop charge against father for fatal accident caused by minor son

Krishnaprasad
BENGALURU

Expressing concern over accidents caused by vehicles driven by minors and emphasising the need for parental accountability, the High Court of Karnataka has refused to discharge a father from the charge of culpable homicide not amounting to murder after his 14-year-old son drove a car and caused an accident that claimed three lives of a family.

"A parent who knowingly places the steering wheel in the hands of a child cannot always retreat behind the minority of that child, when the adventure ends in catastrophe. Parenthood carries not merely affection and authority, but responsibility. Roads are shared public spaces, not training grounds for unlawful indulgence," the court said.

Justice M. Nagaprasanna made the observations while dismissing a criminal petition filed by Nadeem of Mysuru, who sought to quash the chargesheet against him under Section 304 Part-II of the IPC. The petition was restricted solely against the charge of culpable homicide, which attracts an imprisonment of up to 10 years, as the petitioner did not challenge the other connected offences, attracting lesser punishments.

POSTGRADUATE INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL EDUCATION & RESEARCH CHANDIGARH

Global Tender Enquiry Notice No. PI(EP)/ 26-27/G/02 Phone No. 0172-2756469

Tender applications are invited for purchase of various items against Global Tender No. **1-31** from the Manufacturers or their sole authorized distributors/agents. The bidders can place their bids as per terms & conditions contained on https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app.

S. No	Equipment/Item Name	Qty.	EMD (Rs.)	Bid submission Date	Bid Opening Date	Deptt Name
	Non –Pre Bid case					
1	Incubator for culturing Human Gametes and Embryos (Incl. Automatic Gas (Analyzer)	01No.	40,000/-	**10-11-2026**	**11-11-2026**	Obst. & Gynae
2	Thromboelastogram(TEG)/Thromboelastometer/ROTEM	02Nos.	80,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Anaesthesia
3	Hemodialysis Machine with Accessories	10Nos.	4,40,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Nephrology
4	High End Intra Operative Ultrasound for Surgeries	01No.	60,000/-	**11-11-2026**	**12-11-2026**	General Surgery
5.	High End Intra Operative Ultrasound for Surgeries	01No.	60,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	General Surgery
6	Microdebrider for ENT Surgery	01No.	60,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	ENT
7	Therapeutic Hypothermia Device	01No.	80,000/-	**12-11-2026**	**13-11-2026**	Pediatrics Medicine
8	Fluorescent Microscope/Portable Fluorescent Microscope	01No.	80,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Virology
9	Radiofrequency cutting, coagulation and vessel sealing system standalone or integrated with bipolar device, with hand instruments for open/laproscopic surgery	03Nos.	1,90,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Gastroenterology
10	Hemodialysis Machine with Accessories	01No.	70,000/-	**17-11-2026**	**18-11-2026**	Pediatrics Medicine
11	Mobile Endoscopy Unit	01No.	90,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	ENT
12	Automated Peritoneal Dialysis Set with Cassette	02Nos.	60,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Nephrology
	Pre Bid case					
13	Mobile Endoscopy Unit	01No.	1,00,000/-	**18-11-2026**	**19-11-2026**	Radiodiagnosis
14	High Fidelity Mannequins for Medical/Surgical Training	01No.	6,40,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Pediatrics Medicine
15	ECMO (Extended Respiratory Support Application) Oxygenator Adult/Pediatric)	01No.	3,00,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Pediatrics Medicine
16	CO2 Fraction Laser	01No.	3,40,000/-	**19-11-2026**	**20-11-2026**	OHSC
17	FPLC	01No.	1,30,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Exp. Medicine & Biotechnology
18	Cholangioscopy Direct Visualization System with Accessories	01No.	1,40,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	GI Surgery HPB & Liver Transplantation
19	High End Intraoperative Ultrasound Surgeries	01No.	3,50,000/-	**21-11-2026**	**23-11-2026**	GI Surgery HPB & Liver Transplantation
20	Extra Corporeal Shockwave Lithotripter	01No.	1,20,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Urology
21	Laproscopic Surgery Set with High Definition Camera (3D/4K) (Adult/Pediatric) with Accessories	01No.	5,00,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Urology
22	Cardiac Output Monitoring System	02Nos.	4,00,000/-	**25-11-2026**	**26-11-2026**	Pediatrics Medicine
23	Digital PET-CT	01No.	72,00,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Nuclear Medicine
24	Fully Automated Clinical Chemistry Analyzer with Integrated Electrochemiluminne scence Immunoassay Analyzer (ECLIA) or other immunoassay system System	01No.	1,50,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Endocrinology
25	Laparoscopic Surgery Set with High definition Camera (3d/4k) (adult/Pediatric) with Accessories	01No.	3,00,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	GI Surgery HPB & Liver Transplantation
26	High Resolution Manometry system	01No.	2,60,000/-	**26-11-2026**	**27-11-2026**	Gastroenterology
27	High-Fidelity Simulator System: All Specialties	01No.	10,00,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	AEC
28	High End Operating Microscope	02Nos.	16,00,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	AEC
29	Dual Segment/Dual Pump Torsional/Transversal Phacoemulsification System	02Nos.	16,00,000/-	**28-11-2026**	**30-11-2026**	AEC
30	Electro Physiology System 2D/3D/EP Catheters/Instruments/Accessories	01No.	3,50,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	AEC
31	Gamma Knife Esprit, Elekta Ltd	01No.	64,00,000/-	**-do-**	**-do-**	Neurosurgery

Tender document can also be downloaded from website **www.pgimer.edu.in** and can be applied on website **www.eprocure.gov.in**. Bid Security (EMD) should be for the amount as per tender documents either in the form of Account Payee Demand Draft, or Fixed Deposit Receipts (FDR), Banker's Cheque or Bank Guarantee Form issued by Scheduled Commercial Bank having its validity at least for one year & duly pledged in favour of **Postgraduate Institute of Medical Education and Research, Chandigarh**. The tenders will be opened on the dates given above at 12:00 PM in the presence of the authorized intending tenderers. Tenders not submitted on the prescribed form, not accompanied with Bid Security shall be summarily rejected. The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject any or all the tenders received without assigning any reason thereof. **"PRE-BID CONFERENCE" WITH INTENDING BIDDERS FOR ITEM Sr. No. 13 to 31 shall be held on 28.10.2026 from 2:30P.M. ONWARDS IN THE PI(EP), OFFICE, PGIMER, CHANDIGARH.** The intending bidders are free to join Pre bid Conference through video conference. For more details contact: 0172-2756469 at Procurement Branch (Import).

NOTE 1. The terms and Conditions of the original Notice Inviting Tender (NIT) available on PGIMER Website will remain same. However on switching over to e-tendering on e-Procurement, the bids will be received in electronic form on e-Procurement website and no bid will be received in Physical form. **The EMD will be received in Physical form in Procurement Branch (Import) and scan copy is to be uploaded in electronic form on e-procurement website, CPPP Portal (Central Public Procurement Portal).**

NOTE 2. If any of the tender opening dates happens to be a holiday in PGIMER, Chandigarh, then the same shall be opened on next full working day.

Additional Terms and Conditions.

1. The Institute has adopted amended Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) which is available on e-Procurement website **(https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app)** and **Website: www.pgimer.edu.in .** Therefore the bidders are requested to go through the Instructions Carefully before submitting bids.
2. The above items are relaxed to invite Global Tender Enquiry under rule 161 (IV) of G.F.R rules 2017, therefore Para 5 of Annexure 'A' of NIT will not be applicable in these cases.

PGI/RC/Advt./2026/HR-000547 **Professor In-Charge (EP)**

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GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare, Kashmir
Lalmandi, Srinagar, 190008, J&K
Notice

Subject : Submission of copies of retirement notification(s)/other documentary evidence with regard to retirement of retired officers.

Ref : Agriculture Production Department, Civil Secretariat letter No. Agri-Gaz/55/2026 dated 25.08.2026.

Whereas, the Agriculture Production Department, Civil Secretariat, vide above referred letter has sought copies of retirement notification(s)/other documentary evidence with regard to retirement of retired officers up to 2018;

Whereas,the requisite records available in this Directorate have been examined and the information/documents in respect of some retired officers have been ascertained;

Whereas, despite examination of the available records,the requisite information/documents in respect of the retired officers mentioned below could not be ascertained/traced from the records available in this Directorate;

Now, therefore, officers enlisted below who had left the department/ expired/ retired or their legal heirs/ representatives, wherever applicable or any other person(s) having an interest in the matter, through the medium of this notice are hereby informed and thereby requested to furnish copies of copies of retirement notification(s)/ Pension Payment Order (PPO)/Service Book or other documentary evidence with regard to their retirement within a weeks' time from the date of issuance/ publication of this notice.

S. No.	Name of the Chief Agriculture Officers and equivalent	Last post held on substantive basis	Seniority Position in Seniority list notified vide GO No.12-Agri of 2003 dated 17.01.2003	DOB as per seniority list	Date of Retirement	Remarks
1	R.L. Munshi	CAO/DD/SMS-I	110	22.03.1943	31.03.2001	
2	Piaray Lal Koul	CAO/DD/SMS-I	89	15.06.1933	31.05.2001	
3	Vijai Kumar Kachroo	CAO/DD/SMS-I	102	02.10.1943	31.10.2001	
4	Roshan Lal Bamzai	CAO/DD/SMS-I	119	13.07.1946	31.07.2004 B K Sharma	
5	R. K. Mirakhur	Mushroom Specialist / Scientist Pathologist	14	25.04.1942	30.04.2000	

S. No.	Name of the District Agriculture Officers	Qualification / Designation	Date of birth as recorded in Seniority list notified vide GO No. 283-Agri of 2015 dt 18.09.2015	Date of retirement	Date of substantive appointment as DAO& equivalent as per GO No.359-Agri of 2005	Remarks
1	Ram Dass Sharma	SMS-II (DL)	25.11.1943	30.11.2001	01.06.1993	
2	P.K. Raina	DAO/Equivalent	17.10.1941	31.10.1999	01.06.1994 (S.No. 09)	
3	M. R. Kaw	DAO/Equivalent	22.02.1939	28.02.1997	01.06.1994 (S.No. 11)	
4	**Mohammad Shafi Bhat**	**DAO/Equivalent**	**17.04.1940**	**30.04.1998**	**01.06.1994 (S.No. 13)**	
5	M.C. Tickoo	DAO/Equivalent	15.03.1939	31.10.1997	01.06.1994 (S.No. 17)	
6	Harikrishan Handoo	DAO/Equivalent	15.03.1939	31.10.1997	01.06.1994 (S.No. 18)	
7	Ram Krishan Koul	DAO/Equivalent	27.05.1941	31.05.1999	01.06.1994 (S.No. 19)	
8	Kanyalal Rajnaik	DAO/Equivalent	05.04.1940	30.04.1998	01.06.1994 (S.No. 21)	
9	Tej Krishan Koul	DAO/Equivalent	27.12.1941	31.12.1999	01.06.1994 (S.No. 26)	
10	Makhan Lal Koul	DAO/Equivalent	26.03.1944	31.03.2002	05.06.1996 (S.No. 50)	DOR 30.11.1998
11	R.L. Wattal	DAO/Equivalent	14.10.1941	31.10.1999	01.12.1996 (S.No. 54)	
12	Subash Chander	DAO/Equivalent	18.11.1944	30.11.2002	04.12.1996 (S.No. 56)	
13	R.L. Zutshi	DAO/Equivalent	23.10.1943	31.10.2001	04.12.1996 (S.No. 57)	
14	Deep Lal Tickoo	DAO/Equivalent	04.04.1941	30.04.1999	04.12.1996 (S.No. 55)	
15	B.L. Koul	DAO/Equivalent	15.03.1958	31.03.2016	01.05.1997 (S.No. 66)	
16	Roop Krishan Chander	SMS-II	25.02.1949	28.01.2007	01.05.1998 (S.No. 75)	
17	Ashok Kumar Vaishnavi	SMS-II	30.12.1954	31.12.2012	01.07.1998 (S.No. 76)	
18	Mahraj Krishan Pandita	DAO/Equivalent	02.10.1945	31.10.2003	01.09.1998 (S.No. 79)	
19	P.N. Koul	DAO/Equivalent	13.02.1943	28.02.2001	01.08.2000 (S.No.101)	
20	S.K. Zutshi	DAO/Equivalent	14.08.1943	31.08.2001	01.01.2000 (S.No.108)	

The requisite documents/information may be furnished with in weeks' time from the issuance of this notice so that the same is compiled and submitted to the Agriculture Production Department, Civil Secretariat.
The matter may be treated as **MOST URGENT**.

(Sartaj Ahmad Shah)
Director Agriculture
Kashmir

DIPK-6934/26

Unknown gaps

India must do better at detecting and preventing data breaches

The cybersecurity advisory by the Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) has outlined two threat vectors *vis-à-vis* Indian commercial and government IT infrastructure: AI companies testing autonomous agents exceeding their designated operational constraints and bad actors weaponising open-source agentic AI tools for automated reconnaissance and exploitation. However, the organisations affected by recent breaches that the advisory was based on did not detect them: they came to light in the AI companies' disclosures and CERT-In operations. Aside from developers allowing experimental systems to act outside their authorised bounds, the advisory highlights two problems for India – existing arrangements focus on cybersecurity incidents after they are revealed; and the implicated organisations being found under-prepared for the DPDP Act – to be enforced from 2027, including steep penalties on entities not maintaining reasonable safeguards against breaches. While CERT-In observed or received reports of 29.4 lakh incidents in 2025, it does not routinely publish postmortem analyses and is exempt from the RTI Act. As a result, public accountability is also weak: CERT-In found that the AI agents and/or bad actors exploited vulnerabilities, including exposed passwords, that are known security problems separate from AI agents' abilities.

AI companies and labs have made several disclosures this year of agents unexpectedly breaching real-world infrastructure worldwide during testing. For India, however, the legal boundaries specified by the IT Act 2000 leave open an accountability gap for autonomous agents without the backing of human intentions. A more specific lacuna is that while CERT-In requires an organisation to report an intrusion within six hours, many organisations remain incapable of, or unwilling to, discover it. The reporting deadline itself has not ensured detection. Overall, the national cybersecurity landscape is fragmented across a pastiche of enforceable requirements in some domains, advisory technical standards in others, and narrow AI-specific accountability in yet others. As human and autonomous threat actors become more sophisticated, India needs to leapfrog to a landscape with enforceable risk-based requirements for both testing and defending against autonomous agents; better spotting unauthorised access, especially in the public sector; and a legal safe-harbour for security research conducted in good faith, in line with CERT-In policy. CERT-In should also publish more information, anonymised where necessary, which includes remediation outcomes and whether the affected individuals were informed. Finally, the government should also review the exemption for CERT-In from the RTI Act as such a sweeping exemption is unnecessary for effective cyber-defence.

Fall of the centre

Economic woes have fuelled public discontent in France under Macron

When Emmanuel Macron came to power in 2017, at age 39, he promised to keep extremist political forces at bay, build a new France through his 'revolution', rejuvenate economic growth, manage debt and create employment opportunities. Nine years later, with six months to go for France's next presidential election, Mr. Macron, whose approval rating is at an abysmally low 15%, and Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu, who lacks a parliamentary majority, are struggling to restore order in a country battered by economic woes, street protests, violent riots and a surging far right. Even in France, where protests are part of the political culture, Saturday's riots and looting were a shock with at least 3,000 businesses and shops damaged. Municipal halls were attacked and buildings set on fire, including the 19th century Limoges town hall. Some 2,400 people were arrested and Prime Minister Lecornu called for local curfews. The trigger for the unrest was a move by Mr. Lecornu to pass budget proposals raising some taxes and freezing spending on social programmes. When school students hit the streets with demands for better educational facilities, the government responded with force and tear gas. But its heavy-handed response helped the student protest snowball into an anti-government movement, culminating in riots.

To understand the precarious situation France is in today, all one has to do is to look at the macroeconomic numbers. Growth remains sluggish with the economy estimated to expand by a mere 0.8% in 2026, while the unemployment rate stands at 8.3%. The core problem is the country's public finances. France's national debt stands at 120% of GDP, the third highest in the eurozone, after Greece and Italy. The French Treasury's debt servicing bill is expected to reach about €60 billion in 2026. When Mr. Macron came to power, he reduced corporate taxes and sought to restrain public spending to stimulate growth. But growth remained sluggish while public debt ballooned. When protests gripped the country in 2018-19, he offered economic concessions, but with no long-term solutions to the structural problems the French economy was facing. In 2024, he called snap elections to blunt the far-right momentum. After the elections, he invited a leader from smaller blocs to form a government to keep the left-wing New Popular Front, the largest bloc, out of power, deepening the political crisis and weakening his position. This is Emmanuel Macron's legacy. Worse, Marine Le Pen, leader of the far-right, anti-immigrant National Rally, could exploit the chaos and public anger to her benefit ahead of the 2027 presidential election.

The RSS at 101, between change and continuity

Shashi Tharoor

A fourth-term Member of Parliament (Congress party) from Thiruvananthauram, and the Sahitya Akademi Award-winning author of 29 books, including 'Why I Am a Hindu' and, most recently, 'The Sage Who Reimagined Hinduism: The Life, Lessons and Legacy of Sree Narayana Guru'. His forthcoming book is 'The Fight for Indian Liberalism' (January 2027)

As the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) concluded its centenary celebrations on Vijayadashami (October 20) 2026, the organisation that began in 1925 as a cultural response to Hindu subjugation has grown into one of the most influential socio-political forces in the country. It runs 88,949 daily *shakhas* at 55,683 locations, while one of the 32 organisations it has inspired, the Bharatiya Janata Party, governs India. Yet, its legacy remains deeply contested. For many liberals and secularists, the RSS evokes a history of exclusion, communalism, and ideological bigotry. For its supporters, it represents discipline, service, and a proud assertion of Hindu identity. The question now is twofold: whether the RSS is evolving (whether there is, in fact, an RSS 2.0); and whether the rest of us, secular Indians, can find a *modus vivendi* with it.

A duality

The discomfort of secular and liberal Indians with the RSS is not without foundation. The organisation's early years were marked by conspicuous silence and distancing from the freedom struggle. While Congress leaders courted arrest and endured colonial repression, the RSS abstained from anti-British agitation. Its tactical accommodation with the British Raj, and the Hindu Mahasabha's with the Muslim League in the government of Bengal, in the waning years of Empire, reflected its prioritisation of Hindu consolidation over Indian nationalism.

Post-Independence, the RSS's image was indelibly stained by its association, however indirect, with the assassination of Mahatma Gandhi, which many of its cadres celebrated by distributing sweets. Though the organisation was banned and later exonerated, the ideological proximity between Nathuram Godse and the Sangh Parivar left a lasting scar. In subsequent decades, the RSS and its affiliates were frequently accused of complicity in fomenting communal discord, from the demolition of the Babri Masjid in 1992 to the Gujarat riots of 2002.

Its intellectual canon, too, has been appalling: M.S. Golwalkar, the second Sarsanghchalak from 1940-73, praised Nazi Germany's racial policies and commended Hitler's treatment of the Jews as a model for Hindus in dealing with Muslims. His writings, once central to RSS pedagogy, portrayed minorities as threats to national unity, Mahatma Gandhi as an un-Hindu pacifist, the Constitution as divorced from Indian roots, and secularism as a western import. Even in more recent years, the organisation's stance on women, emphasising domestic roles, child-bearing and cultural preservation over autonomy, has been labelled regressive, misogynist and patriarchal, and not only by women.

Yet, to reduce the RSS to a stereotype of intolerance is to ignore its vast and varied social footprint. During the Partition riots, RSS volunteers played a critical role in protecting, rescuing and rehabilitating Hindu and Sikh refugees, especially in Punjab. In times of national crisis – wars, earthquakes, floods, landslides – the organisation and its social service arm, Seva Bharati, have mobilised swiftly and effectively, often outpacing state machinery. Its educational initiatives, through Vidya Bharati schools and Ekal Vidyalayas, have brought basic literacy to remote tribal areas. Its health camps, blood donation drives, and charitable outreach have earned praise even from ideological opponents. For many Indians, especially in small towns and villages, the RSS is not a political entity but a provider of tangible services and moral discipline.

Signs of a 'shift'

This duality – ideological bigotry on one hand, genuine civic engagement on the other – has long confounded observers. But recent years suggest a shift toward a more conciliatory posture. Under Mohan Bhagwat, the RSS has adopted a noticeably softer tone, publicly affirming Islam's place in India ("Islam arrived in India and will remain in India") and cautioning Hindus against religious provocation, famously urging Hindus to "stop looking for a Shivling under every masjid", a notable departure from earlier combative rhetoric. The leadership now reinterprets "Hindu Rashtra" not as majoritarian rule, but as an inclusive civilisational ethos, quietly omitting from new editions Golwalkar's most incendiary views in favour of appeals to national unity and service. Outreach to Dalits and tribals has expanded alongside cautious interfaith dialogue; during an August 2026 visit to the United States, Mr. Bhagwat championed pluralism, declaring that excluding Muslims contradicts Hindutva itself. Concurrently, the RSS frames its link with the BJP as hands-off: "We only give suggestions," Mr. Bhagwat has said, distancing the organisation from the day-to-day decisions of government. "Things cannot be achieved through politics alone."

Still, there is a widespread view among secular liberals that Mr. Bhagwat's recent remarks are a tactical manoeuvre to make Hindutva acceptable to a broader, international audience rather than a fundamental change in core RSS ideology, which endorses or condones exclusionary and bigoted conduct in practice. To dispel such misgivings, we argue, the RSS chief must address critical issues with solid institutional and public messaging within India rather than relying on platitudes abroad. In particular, Mr. Bhagwat should clearly oppose any initiatives that violate the spirit of the Places of Worship Act, 1991 (particularly regarding temple reconstruction in Mathura and Varanasi, causes which Mr. Bhagwat says the RSS itself would not back while swayamsevaks are free to join them). He should deplore how anti-conversion legislation in Maharashtra shifts the burden of proof onto minorities during ordinary acts of worship, prompting churches in Mumbai to require self-attestations before permitting entry to non-Christians. He must demonstrate moral leadership by actively opposing physical attacks on Christian churches, priests and nuns, prayer meetings and burial grounds, while ensuring that the law is not weaponised against minorities, especially Muslims, through selective first information reports for offering namaz or the hasty use of bulldozers against religious structures without due process or appeal.

Institutionally, Mr. Bhagwat and the RSS should sanction leaders of the BJP and Sangh Parivar organisations for engaging in hate speech, while expressing his own anguish over why India's communal atmosphere has become increasingly toxic despite a decade of inclusive public rhetoric. Without such concrete measures, Hindutva continues to align with a majoritarian understanding of democracy, with Hindus alone seen as the primary owners of the nation, making truly inclusive dialogue difficult. That would require the RSS to renounce and denounce vigilantism unequivocally, to uphold constitutional pluralism and inclusion, and to treat disagreement and dissent not as betrayal, but as proof of India's democratic vitality, in its civilisational tradition of *samvad* (dialogue/conversation/discussion).

The next generation is watching

There is also a generational test here, and it may well prove a decisive one. A majority of Indians are under 35 years, and they will judge the RSS by what they see it do on the street and on their phones. By that measure the record is thin: meme pages, troll armies and vigilantes who act against everything Mr. Bhagwat has said, and do so in Hindutva's name, have only multiplied, and it is hard to point to any instance of the RSS publicly disowning, let alone disciplining, any of them. If his words are meant, young Indians will expect to see them enforced. If they are not, the young will draw their own conclusions, and an organisation that has always prided itself on shaping the character of India's youth will have failed the one audience that will decide its second century.

At 101, both the organisation and the nation stand at a political and civilisational crossroads. While its tone is softer and outreach broader, elements within the Sangh ecosystem still traffic in hate and exclusion. As the RSS's influence grows across institutions, secular Indians face a profound dilemma. Acknowledging that cultural nationalism is now entrenched does not warrant embracing it, but it does demand engagement. Rather than seeking reconciliation at the expense of principle, secular liberals can challenge its inconsistencies, insist on inclusive governance, and achieve coexistence without surrender.

The test of RSS 2.0 lies in demonstrating a commitment to inclusion and protecting India's pluralist traditions

Moves by the North of England to unlock India trade

Kishore Jayaraman

The Group CEO of the UK India Business Council (UKIBC). He has been the India Chair of UKIBC and a Member of the UKIBC Group Board since 2016, and is also the former President of Rolls-Royce, India and South Asia

The India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) has opened the door to a new phase in the relationship between the two countries, with the focus now shifting from agreement to action. The momentum is already being seen, as the leaders from across the North of England have been travelling together to India, for the first time under The Great North banner to strengthen ties on trade, investment, innovation, culture and the visitor economy.

Beyond headlines

Agreements are only as powerful as the opportunities they unlock. Tariff reductions, regulatory alignment, and mobility provisions matter enormously; yet, their true value is realised only when businesses on the ground understand precisely where and how they apply. Keeping this in mind, the Northern Mayors were joined by businesses, small and medium enterprises and universities from across the region to help bolster links, showcase the North's economic assets and create new opportunities for trade, investment and academic collaboration. The North of England and India already have deep and growing ties, with nearly 5,40,000 people of Indian origin living across the region. Indian companies have invested over £1bn in the Northwest alone, supporting more than 6,700 jobs, according to the Confederation of Indian Industry report. Nearly 200 delegates from across the North were part of the visit, bringing together mayors, businesses, universities and leaders from tourism, culture and sport to make the case for the North as a destination for investment, partnerships and growth.

U.K. Foreign Secretary David Lammy's statement (made in 2024) describing the trade pact as "the floor, not the ceiling" of the bilateral relationship is the true essence of the current ties between New Delhi and London. The agreement is the result of several rounds of negotiations, over the years – 14 rounds of discussions, with each point deliberated to deliver and cash-in on strengths and individual goals of the two nations.

The U.K. India Business Council, a mission partner for the Great North delegation, is working to help U.K. businesses better understand the opportunity and reframe how they see India. India is no longer simply a market to sell into. It is a strategic partner with the potential to become an integral part of the U.K.'s research and development (R and D), technology, talent and supply chains.

Visits to action

In the last few years, the ministerial and government visits have been largely with a broader vision to keep the ball rolling. This was seen with former U.K. Prime Minister Sir Keir Starmer's delegation coming to India in 2025 and vice-versa. But this time we see policymakers coming in to discuss the next steps. Government meetings, business delegations, university partnerships, R and D collaborations, sports and cultural ties and targeted regional engagements in business hubs of India. The itinerary was designed to build a long-term relationship.

There is already some impact, with the footprint of Indian businesses in the U.K. having expanded sharply this year, the number of Indian-owned companies rising nearly 60% from the previous year and combined revenues surpassing £105 billion, according to the latest India Meets Britain Tracker published by Grant Thornton UK.

Bilateral trade between India and the U.K. rose to £47.4 billion in 2025, marking an 11.7% increase from the previous year. Growth was concentrated on advanced manufacturing, clean energy and technology. With the CETA now in place, the India-U.K. corridor is poised for unprecedented growth, creating value for both economies.

In one of the UK India Business Council (UKIBC)'s reports on the CETA, it has focused on regional collaboration, mapping them against the sector-specific pathways for growth. A regional approach to trade engagement offers India a nuanced and targeted pathway into the U.K. economy; one that goes beyond London and into the innovation-rich heartlands of Britain. The report takes one step ahead from the macro view and delves into specifics. Examine Maharashtra's aerospace ambitions, Gujarat's chemical exports, Karnataka's world-class IT ecosystem and Tamil Nadu's pharmaceutical prowess. It asks not just what this deal means for India or the U.K. in aggregate, but also what it means for the industries and communities that will live with its consequences day to day.

Conversations need to translate into business. For a micro, small and medium enterprise, the challenge is often not whether the benefits of a trade agreement exist, but how one can access them. That means understanding and navigating the finer details, such as knowing that a tariff preference exists, establishing whether a product qualifies, meeting rules of origin, securing the right documentation, and managing the administrative costs of claiming the benefit. It can be seen as an empowering process.

Business guide

As India signs more trade agreements, the task is about ensuring businesses can take full advantage of what has been negotiated on their behalf. To simplify this, the UKIBC has developed a U.K.-India CETA Business Utilisation Manual – A Practical Activation Guide for Indian and UK Businesses, which was launched recently by Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal in London. The guide is designed to simplify the agreement and help businesses understand where the opportunities lie, whether they qualify, and how to act on them.

Regional partnerships can help businesses unlock the potential of the India-U.K. trade pact

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Institutional trust

Student unrest is gathering strength across the globe — in India, France, Albania, Belgium, Serbia, Spain, Portugal and Italy. Beyond a revolt against governments, this is a generational test of whether institutions can still command trust. Where education fails to offer opportunity, politics appears unresponsive, and digital expression produces little tangible change, the streets become the staging ground. Courts must protect citizens' right to assemble, protest and criticise, while ensuring that restrictions imposed in the interest of public safety are necessary and proportionate. Student unrest may be episodic in one country yet politically consequential in another. The common thread is the steady erosion of institutions swayed by political vagaries.

R. Narayanan,
Navi Mumbai

A new chapter

We congratulate the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam government and Dr. Pushpavanam Kuppusamy on his appointment as Chairman of the Tamil Nadu Eyal Isai Nataka Manram (TEINM), an organisation functioning under the State government's Department of Art and Culture. His appointment is a welcome opportunity to revitalise the institution and strengthen its support for artists and Tamil culture, particularly folk and classical art forms. The new chairman is expected to reconstitute the Executive Committee and General Council, which will advise the government on matters such as the Kalaimamani Awards. It is hoped that Dr. Kuppusamy will consult eminent Sangeeta vidwans and folk artists, while ensuring that the film industry is treated as a distinct sector rather than grouped with classical and folk traditions. A renewed and inclusive approach could give fresh impetus to Tamil Nadu's rich cultural landscape and offer a model for neighbouring States.

V.P. Dhananjayan,
Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

The ECI's unfinished lessons

Anurodh Lalit Jain

Vice-Chairman, AICC Minority Department. Views are personal

India's electoral system has evolved through successive efforts to make elections more inclusive, enforceable and accessible. Today, the mass revision of electoral rolls, suspicious voter deletions, and questions about access to polling records test the Election Commission of India's (ECI) ability to ensure that every eligible voter can participate equally. Its history offers lessons for the challenges ahead.

When India prepared its first electoral roll, nearly 28 lakh women were left off because they were identified through their relationships to men rather than being registered under their own names. Sukumar Sen, India's first Chief Election Commissioner, worked to ensure that women were enrolled in their own right, and by the 1957 elections, about 85% of those affected had been registered under their own names.

This lesson matters now as the ECI undertakes its Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. In Bihar, around 65 lakh names were missing from the draft roll published in August 2025. The Commission cited reasons such as deaths, migration and duplicate entries. While updating electoral rolls is necessary, voters must be able to check why their names have been left out and challenge errors. The Supreme Court directed the ECI to publish the list of excluded voters along with the reasons for exclusion.

In a similar line, West Bengal shows what happens when correcting errors becomes slow. More than 27 lakh names were deleted during adjudication, prompting around 22 lakh appeals. Moreover, tribunal judges have raised technical concerns such as problems with the appeals portal, including difficulties issuing notices, conducting hearings and restoring names. While both cases show that removing names may be necessary to keep rolls accurate, correcting wrongful exclusions is equally important. A remedy that comes too late results in a lost vote.

> While the ECI need not accept every allegation made by political parties, constitutional authority cannot substitute for verifiable evidence

The Form 7 question

The same principle applies to Form 7, through which an elector can seek the deletion of a name from the roll. In Aland, Karnataka, 6,018 online applications sought deletions. Of these, the ECI said that they rejected 5,994 applications as they were incorrect, and accepted only 24 after verification. An inquiry followed, and an FIR was registered. Rejecting incorrect applications show that safeguards can work. But a concentrated pattern of applications requires the ECI to establish who submitted them and whether identities or documents were misused. Every deletion request should leave a verifiable record of the applicant, supporting evidence, and the final decision.

Transparency in polling data presents another test. In Maharashtra's 2024 Assembly election, reported turnout rose from 58.22% at 5 p.m. to 66.05% in the final figure. The Commission explained that the earlier number was provisional and that data continued to be updated as polling parties returned and records were scrutinised. While a difference between provisional and final figures does not by itself establish improper voting, a substantial change makes a clear explanation necessary.

In December 2024, following a Punjab and Haryana High Court order to release election-related records in a case concerning the Haryana Assembly election, the government amended Rule 93 of the Conduct of Elections Rules. The change raised concerns about public access to electronic records, including CCTV footage and webcasting material. The timing of the change raised questions about whether the aim was to protect privacy or limit scrutiny.

Institutional independence matters just as much. In *Anoop Baranwal vs. Union of India* (2023), the Supreme Court prescribed an interim selection committee comprising the Prime Minister, the Leader of the Opposition and the Chief Justice of India to select election commissioners. Parliament later replaced the Chief Justice with a Union Cabinet Minister. The government now controls two of the three keys to the room where election commissioners are chosen. This hardly inspires public confidence in the ECI's independence.

While the ECI need not accept every allegation made by political parties, constitutional authority cannot substitute for verifiable evidence. Accurate rolls, traceable deletion requests, timely appeals and independently examinable polling records are safeguards owed to every voter. In an electoral democracy, trust must be earned through evidence, clarity and the willingness to correct mistakes.

On paddy field conservation in Keralam

Chitra K. P.

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Preetha K.V.

Assistant Professor, PG Department of Social Entrepreneurship, Madras School of Social Work, Chennai

A conservation law meant to protect Keralam's paddy fields is gradually becoming an instrument facilitating its decline. The State had 8.82 lakh hectares (ha) of paddy fields during 1974-75, which reduced to 1.76 lakh ha in 2024-25, a drop of 80%, owing to crop shifts, housing and commercial growth, developmental needs, and a speculative land market. Despite the enactment of the Kerala Conservation of Paddy Land and Wetland Act (KCPWA) in 2008, the decline continues.

Rather than ineffective enforcement, what is unfolding is an implausible dilution of conservation logic through ongoing bureaucratic redesign, effected by multiple circulars and orders. The shift is astounding, as the State rightfully recognised the ecological value of paddy fields within KCPWA.

> Neglecting paddy fields as a socio-ecological system that regulates local biodiversity, the hydrological cycle, and microclimate constitutes a grave failure, amid rising food insecurity and floods

A case of legal dilution

The structural and procedural modifications to KCPWA demonstrate how even a strong conservation law can be diluted. The Kerala Finance (No.2) Act, 2015, amended the KCPWA by adding Section 3A, which regularised unauthorised paddy field conversions prior to 2008 upon the payment of a nominal fee. This contravened the Local Self-Government Department (LSGD) circulars of 2008 and 2011, which set 1998 as the cut-off year for implementing the conservation norms, thereby legitimising the reclamations between 1998 and 2008. In 2016, a State notification removed Section 3A without reference to the regularisation cases during the amendment period.

Although the KCPWA mandates the development of a verifiable databank of paddy fields, the process remains incomplete. Consequently, no reliable data source exists to verify the land status in many districts. This blatant administrative failure has become a legal loophole, as KCPWA (Amendment) 2018 and successive revenue circulars are facilitating the conversion of a larger extent of unnotified land (paddy fields in revenue records but not included in databank) for residential, commercial, or other purposes.

Building permits on unnotified lands are facilitated by expanding eligibility criteria and expediting category change applications. In 2017, the LSGD withdrew its 2008 and 2011 circulars, which declared 1998 as the cut-off year for regularisation, and its 2012 and 2013 circulars, which restricted land transactions after obtaining housing permits. Despite a High Court order in 2015 for strict legal compliance in building permit issuance, from 2016 onwards, multiple LSGD and revenue circulars facilitated the rapid disposal of applications, with little emphasis on water conservation mandates.

The Comptroller and Auditor General of India's revenue sector report of 2016 identified the non-detection of illegal paddy field conversions, the non-reporting of unauthorised reclamations, legal non-compliance, and non-reinstatement of illegally converted land as major lapses. The scrutiny turns challenging as the State is fast-tracking conversion applications by deploying additional officials and infrastructure and processing land parcels in clusters.

Until 2002, the Department of Agriculture, with direct agro-ecological stakes in wetland conservation, largely monitored non-agricultural land use. Post-KCPWA, the Department of Revenue became the primary monitoring authority. The Department's dual role as both a conservation regulator and a revenue generator from regularisation confers immense power over land-use decision-making. Until 2024, the Department earned up to ₹1,606 crore through paddy field regularisation. A strict enforcement of the conservation law remains constrained since the regulator earns consistent revenue from paddy field conversion, causing a structural dilemma.

Over the years, bureaucratic enforcement appears to be facilitating regularisation of paddy fields – recategorisation to non-wetland status, dilution of water-conservation mandates, and widening of conversion eligibility – with limited conservation focus. Neglecting paddy fields as a socio-ecological system that regulates local biodiversity, the hydrological cycle, and microclimate constitutes a grave failure, amid rising food insecurity and floods.

Given that the KCPWA is a progressive statute, political and administrative goodwill is needed to achieve its conservation goals. Completion of a verifiable wetland-paddy databank, strict monitoring, and ecologically informed conversion penalties are a few of the immediate steps that can be taken.

The impact of U.S.'s crackdown on skilled migrant labour

The Trump administration's crackdown on skilled foreign workers ignores the benefits they bring into the U.S. economy

DATA POINT

Gandla Sneha Sambavi Parthasarathy

The U.S.'s move to suspend several firms including Indian IT companies from the Permanent Labor Certification (PERM) programme is the latest in the Donald Trump administration's crackdown on employment-based immigration.

While the U.S. has reasoned that its crackdown, including the proclamation signed by Mr. Trump last year to raise the H-1B visa fee to $1,00,000, is an attempt to persuade companies to hire more U.S. workers, data show this will significantly affect the U.S.'s access to skilled workers, and prove counterproductive in the long run.

Employment-based migration to the U.S., particularly the H-1B programme, allows highly skilled immigrant workers to take temporary employment in the U.S. Later processes such as employer-sponsored PERM certification and Form I-140 can pave the way for permanent residency through a green card. However, applications under these categories have already been on a decline under the Trump administration.

First, the number of H1-B registrations have taken a hit after the $1,00,000 fee was imposed in September 2025 **(Chart 1)**. This fee was later struck down by federal courts in June 2026.

Second, while temporary workers depend on the employment route for green cards, their share is quite low. More than 10 lakh people obtained permanent residency in the U.S. each year. However, the share of those utilising the employment route for green cards has been decreasing in recent years **(Chart 2)**. Green cards were largely obtained by immediate relatives of U.S. citizens and family-sponsored preferences.

The recent move suspending several firms – Microsoft, Adobe, Infosys, TCS, Wipro, HCL (America/Tech), Cognizant, Capgemini – from applying for PERM may have limited impact as well. These companies have already been filing fewer applications since Mr. Trump came to office. These companies together accounted for less than 10% of all PERM applications filed **(Chart 3)**. Their share had already dropped to a mere 4% in 2025, the first year of the second Trump administration. So far this year, these companies filed about 2,000 PERM applications, less than 2% of all applications filed by various employers.

While Indians accounted for more than half of these PERM applications, a breakdown of I-140 preferences illustrates the extent of skilled labour migration. An analysis of the I-140 visa applications, filed with the U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services to classify workers for employment-based immigration, shows that more than 20,000 Indian professionals with advanced degrees applied for citizenship in the U.S. each year since 2014 **(Chart 4)**.

This eligibility criteria requires that the applicant either have a U.S. master degree or higher (or a foreign equivalent) or a U.S. bachelor degree (or foreign equivalent) followed by at least five years of work experience in the specialisation. In the process of merely qualifying for the eligibility itself, these applicants contribute to the U.S. economy as both students and employees.

Much of the debate on immigration crackdown also ignores the benefits they bring to the economy. According to a Congressional Budget Office analysis in July 2024, the immigration surge was estimated to add $1.2 trillion in federal revenues over the 2024-2034 period, largely due to their income and payroll taxes **(Chart 5)**.

In the long term, an increased crackdown on migrant workers could risk investments and activities by corporations outside the U.S.

Losing a good hand

The data for the charts were sourced from U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services and Congressional Budget Office

Chart 1: The H-1B petitions filed and approved between FY 2021 and FY 2025. These figures represent all approved petitions during the respective fiscal year, irrespective of whether the petition was filed in the same or in a previous fiscal year

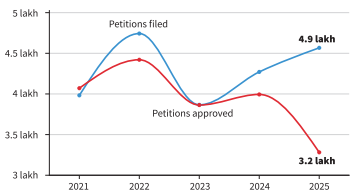
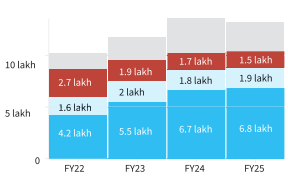


Chart 2: New lawful permanent residents by broad class of admission. *The share of those utilising the employment route for green cards have been decreasing in recent years*



In all the charts, the figures for 2026 correspond only till Q3.

Gandla Sneha is interning with The Hindu Data Team

Chart 3: Number of PERM applications filed by the suspended IT companies and others

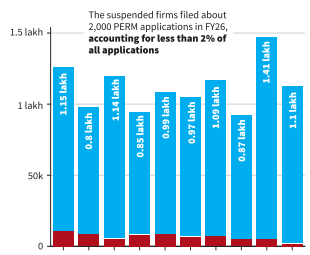


Chart 4: The employment-preference wise break-up of India's I-140 visa applications. Categories with less than a thousand applications are clubbed as 'Others'

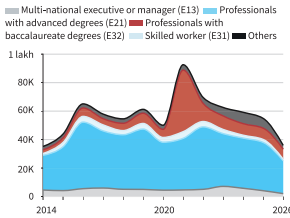
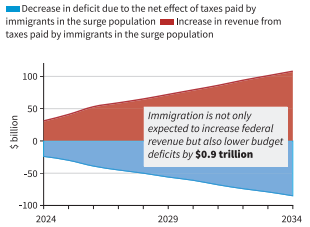


Chart 5: Estimated effects of the immigration surge on U.S. revenue and deficit



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 21, 1976

Electronic device to aid executives

New Delhi, October 20: The National Physical Laboratory (NPL) here has developed an electronic device which could help busy executives get their engagements announced at the appropriate time.

Called "Electronic Secretary", the device is attached to a cassette tape-recorder which is used to record the details of engagements fixed by the executive for the day.

It helps avoid engagement diaries which the executives have to go through frequently. Personal secretaries need not remind their bosses frequently about appointments.

The device could be used to pre-record all the details of a person's engagements for a number of days sequentially.

The device, which is programmable, then gives commands to the tape-recorder for making different announcements at different times of the day. It would, therefore, be possible to listen to all the details of the engagements just before the engagement time.

Although engagements of several days are recorded in advance, the device has to be programmed every day to make announcements at different times.

There is also provision in the device to recall any particular information of any particular day and make instant modification. The device displays both time and date.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 21, 1926

Indian railways

Simla, October 20: That the Indian Railways are second to none is the opinion of the Hon. Mr. Beyers, leader of the South African Deputation. In a letter addressed to Sir Clement Hindley, Chief Commissioner of Railways, Mr. Beyers writes: "I should like, on behalf of my colleagues and myself, to convey to you and through you to the agents of various railway systems in India over which we have travelled, our grateful appreciation of the courtesy and consideration which we received from the staff and of the admirable efficiency and smoothness with which arrangements connected with our journeys worked. From our brief experience of your railways in India, we can say they are second to none. You may well be proud of them."

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Value of Amazon's planned investment in Germany in 2027

16 in euro billion. Amazon announced plans to invest over €16 billion ($18 billion) in Germany in 2027, including in data centres and infrastructure supporting artificial intelligence. Nearly €5 billion will go towards expanding Amazon Web Services operations in the Frankfurt area. The funds will also support satellite internet services and warehouse upgrades. AFP

Number of vacant police posts to be filled by M.P. in two years

22,500 Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav announced that 22,500 vacant posts in the State Police Department will be filled over the next two years. Mr. Yadav also introduced the Indore Police's "Police Setu" app aimed at improving communication between citizens and the police. PTI

Number of Afghans to face acute food insecurity by April

19.2 In million. More than 19 million people in Afghanistan are projected to face acute food insecurity in the winter lean season from November to April, the UN humanitarian agency OCHA has warned. Around five million people are expected to face emergency levels of hunger. Funding cuts have forced many nutrition centres to suspend services. AFP

No. of Ebola cases in Kenya that prompted U.S. travel warning

8 The United States has raised its travel advisory for Kenya from Level 2 to Level 3, urging citizens to reconsider travel following the country's eighth Ebola case. The outbreak began with a man who returned from the Democratic Republic of Congo and died in Nairobi on October 5. Kenya's seven subsequent cases involved relatives and healthcare workers. AFP

Percentage surge in U.S. oil prices amid the West Asia conflict

5.7 in per cent. U.S. oil prices surged 5.7 per cent to $109.60 per barrel on Tuesday amid growing concerns over tight supplies due to the West Asia conflict. The international benchmark, Brent crude, also rose 2% to $111.69 per barrel, reflecting heightened concerns about global oil supply disruptions. AFP

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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How conversion affects reservation

The invalidation of Tamil Nadu's order enabling persons converting to Islam from Backward Classes and Scheduled Castes to obtain Backward Class Muslim certificates highlights that while conversion cannot automatically transfer a person into a different notified community, continuing social disadvantage calls for an evidence-based inquiry

LETTER & SPIRIT

K. Kannan

The invalidation of Tamil Nadu's 2024 order highlights the distinction between Scheduled Caste status and backward-class classification. Conversion cannot automatically transfer a person into a different notified community, but continuing social disadvantage calls for evidence-based inquiry.

Grounds for upholding HC ruling

On October 15, 2026, the Supreme Court, in *The Secretary to Government v. Sameer Ahamed N.*, upheld the Madras High Court's judgment invalidating Tamil Nadu Government Order dated March 9, 2024. The order sought to enable persons converting to Islam from Backward Classes (BC), Most Backward Classes (MBC), Denotified Communities (DNC) and Scheduled Castes (SC) to obtain Backward Class Muslim certificates and use the State's 3.5% reservation for BC Muslims.

The case arose from an application by a person born into a Hindu family who converted to Islam and sought a certificate as a Muslim Lebbai. The High Court held that conversion did not make the applicant a member of any of Tamil Nadu's seven notified backward Muslim communities: Ansar, Dekkani Muslims, Dubekula, Labbais (including Rowthar and Marakayar), Mapilla, Sheik and Syed. The Supreme Court affirmed that conclusion. The courts rejected the assumption that a former caste classification establishes membership of a different Muslim community. A person does not become a Lebbai, Rowther or Dekkani Muslim merely by converting. A Jamath may attest to conversion but cannot conclusively determine eligibility for a statutory reservation category. A community certificate records legal status; it cannot create it.

The State argued that a person who had enjoyed reservation should not lose every reservation benefit by converting. The concern is understandable, but the method was legally unsustainable. The order grouped persons from SC, BC, MBC and DNC classifications, without demonstrating a common social characteristic linking them to the seven notified Muslim communities. The verdict rejects automatic transfer of status; it does not, however, declare that Muslims can never qualify as a backward class.

Two constitutional routes

The Constitution treats Scheduled Caste status and backward class identification differently. Article 341 empowers the President to specify Scheduled Castes; Article 341(2) provides that Parliament may alter the list by law. Paragraph 3 of the Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950 restricts SC status to persons professing Hinduism, Sikhism or Buddhism. Under the existing Order, conversion to Islam or Christianity does not preserve SC status merely because of former caste identity.

Backward-class identification follows another route. Articles 15(4) and 16(4) permit special provisions for socially and educationally backward classes and for their adequate representation in public employment. Article 342A, as amended by the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021, recognises States' power to maintain their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes.

Backward classes need not be identified exclusively through Hindu caste names. Occupational groups, sects and communities among non-Hindus may qualify if constitutional criteria are met. But the State cannot establish qualification merely by assigning converts to an existing Muslim community without evidence of membership or a defensible basis for a fresh classification.

The Supreme Court recently upheld the Madras High Court's judgment invalidating Tamil Nadu Government Order dated March 9, 2024. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

The Mandal Commission's indicators

The Second Backward Classes Commission, chaired by B.P. Mandal, offers a useful comparison. It used 11 indicators across social, educational and economic criteria. Social indicators carried three points each, educational indicators two, and economic indicators one, for a maximum score of 22. Its aim was to identify communities experiencing combined disadvantage, not simply reproduce caste names. The indicators need not be mechanically applied to every later classification. The enduring principle is that identification requires a reasoned assessment of disadvantage.

Caste has often been the principal organising unit of reservation. Once a caste is recognised as backward, an individual ordinarily proves membership rather than personal backwardness afresh. Yet the constitutional purpose is to advance socially and educationally backward classes, not preserve labels regardless of present conditions.

A person from a Hindu MBC may face inherited exclusion after conversion to Islam. But the former caste name does not establish membership of a Muslim community already notified as backward. Equally, the absence of caste hierarchy as a religious principle in Islam cannot prove, without inquiry, that inherited disadvantage has disappeared. The State should identify a recognisable group among converts, assess its continuing social and educational position, and explain why the evidence warrants inclusion in its backward-class list.

T.N. Commission's views

The Government Order followed a letter dated February 6, 2024, from the Chairman of the Tamil Nadu Backward Classes Commission. The letter of the Commission actually records the fact that one of the members had observed that for extension of benefit of consideration for a backward class Hindu to Islam, quantifiable data may be collected by the Government to show how many such people converted to Islam have availed the benefits. This was not yet good enough. The State is reported to have said that it had considered the Commission's views, following stakeholder engagement and deliberation. Neither the Commission nor the State conducted any empirical inquiry establishing that converts from different Hindu classifications shared a relevant characteristic with the seven notified Muslim communities.

As described in the judgment, the recommendation proposed rationalising BC Muslim certificates for converts from specified Hindu classifications. It did not establish the link between a person's former classification and membership of a particular Muslim community.

A Hindu BC, an MBC member, a member of a Denotified Community and a person recognised as belonging to a Scheduled Caste do not necessarily experience the same disadvantage. Grouping them together cannot be justified solely because conversion may affect their previous reservation entitlement. The question is not whether the Government acted with benevolent intent, but whether its means were constitutionally permissible.

The Sachar Committee

The Sachar Committee, constituted in 2005 under Justice Rajindar Sachar, examined Muslims' social, economic and educational status. Its 2006 report documented disadvantage in education, employment and access to credit.

The report shows why social position must be examined through evidence rather than inferred from religious identity. It did not establish that Hindu converts from particular BC or MBC communities formed a distinct backward class under Tamil Nadu's framework. Nor does evidence of general disadvantage among Muslims prove membership of one of the seven notified communities.

Religious identity, caste history, occupation, location, educational attainment and representation in public employment may all be relevant. Their relationship, however, must be demonstrated rather than presumed.

Distinct legal inquiries

The National Commission for Religious and Linguistic Minorities, chaired by Justice Ranganath Misra, reported in 2007 and recommended delinking SC status from religion by deleting paragraph 3 of the 1950 Order. It argued that the treatment of historically disadvantaged castes should not depend on the religion their members profess. The recommendation did not amend the Order; its restriction remains unless changed through the prescribed constitutional process.

The Commission led by former Chief Justice of India K.G. Balakrishnan, constituted in October 2022, was tasked with examining whether SC status could be accorded to persons claiming historical SC origins who converted to religions outside those specified in the Presidential Orders. Its remit concerns the consequences of caste-based disadvantage after conversion.

This is distinct from the Tamil Nadu BC Muslim issue. The SC question arises under Article 341 and the 1950 Order; backward-class identification arises under Articles 15(4) and 16(4), and requires identification of a socially and educationally backward class under the State framework. The Mandal, Sachar, Ranganath Misra and Balakrishnan exercises illuminate different questions and cannot substitute for one another.

A way forward

The ruling means that conversion to Islam does not automatically carry forward a former Hindu BC, MBC or DNC classification into BC Muslim status, or permit assignment to a notified Muslim community without a lawful basis for membership. The separate restriction governing SC status under the 1950 Order remains unaffected.

The larger question is whether the State should investigate evidence that converts continue to experience social exclusion, inherited disadvantage or educational deprivation. Invalidating automatic transfer does not establish that fresh classification is impossible. Tamil Nadu could commission an independent study through its Backward Classes Commission, examining educational attainment, representation in public employment, social acceptance, and the experiences of converts from different BC, MBC and Denotified Communities.

The inquiry should not treat all converts as homogeneous. The State must define any proposed class, explain its relationship with existing classifications and demonstrate that it meets constitutional criteria.

(K. Kannan is a Senior Counsel and Mediator, a former judge of the Punjab and Haryana High Court and Chairman of the Railway Claims Tribunal.)

THE GIST

- The Supreme Court upheld the Madras HC judgment invalidating Tamil Nadu's order enabling persons converting to Islam from Backward Classes and Scheduled Castes to obtain Backward Class Muslim certificates
- The State argued that a person who had enjoyed reservation should not lose every benefit by converting. The concern is understandable, but the order grouped persons from SC, BC, MBC and DNC classifications, without demonstrating a common social characteristic
- The larger question is whether the State should investigate evidence that converts continue to experience social exclusion and inherited disadvantage. Invalidating automatic transfer does not establish that fresh classification is impossible

CACHE

Growing market: People wait for their electric scooters at a vehicle charging and battery-swapping station in Bengaluru. SUDHAKARA JAIN

Can India turn retrofitment into the next mobility revolution?

Unlike new EV manufacturing, which rewards scale and centralisation, retrofitment rewards distribution through local workshops, technicians and entrepreneurship; with the right training, neighbourhood mechanic shops can become certified retrofitters, absorbing the existing workforce

Jaideep Saraswat
Ashish Dokania

For decades, India's growth story has been written in a familiar script: take a technology invented elsewhere, strip it down, re-engineer it for cost, and scale it for the masses. Generic drugs, low-cost telecom, frugal automobiles are examples of this approach. It is a script that India has performed brilliantly. The question India must ask now is whether it is ready to move from optimisation to creation.

There are signs that it already has. Digital payments existed long before Unified Payments Interface (UPI), yet UPI reimagined the entire architecture of a transaction and created a model good enough that other countries want to emulate. Retail existed long before quick commerce, yet ten-minute delivery rewired consumer expectations in a way no global template had. In both cases, India moved beyond the familiar script and engineered a new category of implementation for existing systems. These models are suited to India's density, informality, and scale. Now, they are travelling across borders. Mobility presents a similar opening.

Vehicle retrofitment

Vehicle retrofitment sits at the centre of the new opportunity. Retrofitment, which converts an existing petrol or diesel vehicle into an electric one by replacing the powertrain, keeps the chassis intact. It is a useful technical fix, but a genuine innovation opportunity arises from everything that needs to be built around it – from diagnostics for legacy vehicles, battery and power-electronics systems designed for retrofitted architectures, calibration software, testing protocols, safety certification, financing solutions, installation networks, and a skilled service workforce. Innovation arises from moving beyond a single product to creating an entire operating system for a new industry, whose definitive version is not built yet.

India has the raw ingredients to attempt it: a deep automotive supply chain, engineering talent that has already proven itself in frugal design, a fast-growing EV sector, credible software capabilities, and critically, a domestic market large and varied enough to pressure-test solutions.

The decentralisation edge

India's advantage is structural. Unlike new EV manufacturing, which rewards scale and centralisation, retrofitment rewards distribution like local workshops, local technicians, and local entrepreneurship. India has already shown what decentralised infrastructure delivery looks like at scale.

The PM Surya Ghar Yojna (PMSGY) on rooftop solar has now reached over 63 lakh households, built through a network of more than 34,000 empanelled vendors that has generated more than 4.6 lakh jobs across the solar rooftop value chain. Here is the blueprint for what a retrofitment ecosystem could look like, encompassing not a few large factories, but thousands of certified local centres. Each centre can convert, service, and maintain vehicles while generating an average of at least 20 direct and indirect jobs.

India's automotive geography is not confined to its metros. Millions of vehicles run in Tier-II and Tier-III towns and rural India, held together by an enormous, largely informal network of mechanics, garages, and spare-parts dealers. With the right standards and training, that existing workforce can be absorbed, converting neighbourhood mechanic shops into certified retrofitters. That proximity between service providers and vehicle owners also solves a trust problem that new technologies always face.

An opportunity for the Global South

The opportunity extends beyond India's border. Countries across South Asia, Southeast Asia, Africa, and Latin America share the same three conditions that make retrofitment relevant in India. They have large fleets of ageing vehicles, price-sensitive consumers, and ownership cycles far longer compared to wealthier markets. Collectively, the Global South spends more than $550 billion a year importing oil, a dependence that new EV sales alone will take decades to meaningfully dent, since new vehicles replace only a fraction of the fleet each year.

Retrofitment offers these countries a faster and cheaper route to displacing that fuel bill using vehicles already on their roads.

This is precisely the shape of opportunity UPI has already proven India can capture. UPI-linked payments are now live in eight countries, and India has signed digital-infrastructure cooperation agreements with 23 more. This was realised not because India sold a payments app, but because it exported a replicable model and an implementation playbook that other countries could adapt to.

Retrofitment could follow the same arc. If India builds the certification standards, financing models, safety protocols, and training pipelines for retrofitment near home, and at scale, it will have effectively built an exportable system.

Other nations with similar vehicle fleets and fuel-import pressures would rally behind it.

None of this happens by accident. It requires India to treat retrofitment, not as a stopgap measure to be tolerated until new EVs become universally affordable, but as a genuine innovation category to be engineered deliberately. India has the right pieces, the engineering talent, the manufacturing base, the technician networks, and the domestic testing ground. Now it needs the intent to bring these pieces together for retrofitment at the scale of PMSGY.

(Jaideep Saraswat is the Associate Director of the Clean Power, Electric Mobility & Emerging Technologies vertical at Vasudha Foundation. Ashish Dokania is the CEO of Green Tiger Mobility Private Limited. The authors declare no competing interest.)

THE DAILY QUIZ

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

A quiz on El Clasico, the much followed fixture between two of the most popular clubs in world football, Real Madrid and Barcelona, set to be held this Sunday

Srinivasan Ramani

QUESTION 1
In 2010, when Barcelona delivered a "manita" (little hand with five fingers) 5-0 victory against Real Madrid, who scored the fifth goal for the Catalan club?

QUESTION 2
This footballer played for Barcelona in its 5-0 win against Real Madrid in January 1994 and was fielded by Madrid in its revenge 5-0 win against Barcelona in January 1995. Name him.

QUESTION 3
Argentine Lionel Messi holds the record for the most goals scored in the Clasicos (26). His countryman (who also played for Spain) shares the record for the second-most goals scored alongside Cristiano Ronaldo. Name him.

QUESTION 4
Which frequent teammate of Messi holds the record for playing in the most Clasicos (48)?

QUESTION 5
What connects Josep Samitier, Luis Enrique, Luis Figo and Ronaldo and the Clasicos?

Visual question: Identify this manager who coached the most Clasicos and the club he coached. NATIONAAL ARCHIEF FOTOCOLLECTIE ANEFO

Questions and answers to the previous daily quiz: 1. According to the Navaratri Puja Paddhati, these are the first, fifth and ninth nine manifestations of Goddess Durga when she is worshipped consecutively during the nine nights of Navaratri. **Ans: Shailaputri, Skandamata and Siddhidatri**
2. Name of the auspicious occasion that announces the beginning of Devi Paksha and precedes the main Durga Puja celebrations. **Ans: Mahalaya**
3. Three figures that are commonly represented by the large effigies burnt during Dussehra celebrations in North India. **Ans: Ravana, his brother Kumbhakarna and son Indrajit**
4. UNESCO honour given to Durga Puja in Kolkata in 2021. **Ans: It was inscribed in Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity**
5. The traditional display of dolls during Navaratri in Tamil Nadu and Karnataka. **Ans:** *'Golu'* **and** *'Bombe Habba'*
6. This puja marks the exact moment when Goddess Durga assumes her fierce form of Chamunda to slay Chanda and Munda. **Ans: Sandhi Puja**
Visual: Name of the legendary tusker, which attained 60 years in April this year, that been granted special permission to participate in 'Jamboo Savari' in Mysuru this year. **Ans: Abhimanyu**
Early birds: KN Viswanathan| Tamal Biswas| Tito Shiladitya| Lalchand Bhutani| Saravanan Chennappan

FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the meaning of "gonna" and "wanna" ? (A.A. Latheef, Alappuzha)
Gonna is actually "going to" and "wanna" is "want to". In informal styles of writing, many Americans tend to spell these words in this manner. Similarly, "got to" is often spelt "gotta". In fact, one finds these words spelt in this manner in comic books. These spellings, however, are not acceptable in formal contexts. Teachers tend to frown on them. So you "gotta" know when it's OK to write "wanna" cos not everyone is "gonna" accept it when it is spelt this way.

What is the meaning and origin of the idiom "be hoist with one's own petard"? (K.P. Nair, Thiruvanthapuram)
Scholars claim that this is an expression, which was made popular by Shakespeare. The idiom "be hoist with one's own petard" is a line from his well-known tragedy "Hamlet".

The "petard" was actually a crude kind of bomb that was used in the old days by invading armies. Soldiers used to place these bell shaped bombs near the walls/gates and then light the slow burning fuse that was attached to them. Sometimes, however, the fuse burnt much more quickly than expected, and in the process blew up not only the wall/gate, but also the man who was lighting the bomb. The soldier was lifted off or hoisted off his feet by the exploding bomb.

Now that you know the origin of the expression, you can probably guess its meaning. It means creating problems for yourself. Have you ever had a plan backfire on you? You may have planned to create a problem for someone, but something goes wrong and you end up creating problems for yourself. Just like the unpredictable bomb (petard), it blows up on your face, in stead of on the face of your opponent. Here is an example:

The teachers were hoist with their own petard when the inquiry they had asked for determined that they were being overpaid and not underpaid.

What is the difference between a "housewife", "housekeeper" and "house sitter"? (P. Rajagopal, Hyderabad)
A "housewife' is a married woman who looks after her house. She does not have a job outside the house; she is not employed by any body else. She spends all her time running the house. Cooking, cleaning, shopping, looking after the kids and the husband. A "housekeeper", on the other hand, is someone who is hired to look after someone else's house. The housekeeper is usually responsible for the cooking and the cleaning of the house. She may or not stay with the owners.

Rama said that she couldn't afford a housekeeper.

A. "house sitter" is also someone who is hired. In this case, the individual is hired to look after the house while the owners are away. For example, if you and your family decide to take a vacation, but are scared that someone may break in to your house, you may decide to hire a house sitter. It is his/her job to take care of the house while you are away. These people stay inside the house; they are not like the watchman whom you post outside for security.

Published in The Hindu on April 23, 2002

Word of the day

Impugn:
attack as false or wrong

Synonym: challenge, contest, contradict

Usage: *The government's actions were impugned in the court.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/impugn

International Phonetic Alphabet: /ɪmˈpjuːn/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'

From Page One

Rubio pitches U.S., Venezuela oil to India

The U.S. official's visit comes at a time of tension in India-U.S. ties due to a number of issues, including the U.S.'s recent moves to stop H-1B visas, threatened sanctions (that have since been held off) over India's import of Russian oil, and delayed FTA negotiations.

"We're very, very close. I would say we're about as close as you can be without having executed the [free trade] agreement. I think there's a small number of items left to wrap up, so I think that will happen shortly," Mr. Rubio said, adding that the State Department was involved closely with the negotiations between trade officials.

While Mr. Jaishankar met Mr. Abdullah in Mumbai just four days after he had travelled to Abu Dhabi where the two Foreign Ministers had also spent time together, this is Mr. Rubio's second visit to India in five months after his last visit to Delhi for the Quad Foreign Ministers meeting in May this year. This time around, Mr. Rubio's focus is on the economic side of the bilateral relationship, officials said.

There have been questions raised about Mr. Rubio's planned two-day visit to Jamnagar, as well as criticism that he had "summoned" Mr. Jaishankar to Mumbai rather than travelling to meet him in Delhi. Speaking to journalists at the Taj Mahal Palace Hotel in Mumbai where he and Mr. Jaishankar offered tributes to those who were killed in the 26/11 terror attacks, Mr. Rubio fielded questions over the purpose of his visit, and why he had returned to India so soon.

"First of all, I will point out that the Foreign Minister of India has been to the United States four times this year," Mr. Rubio explained, adding that as the most populous country and largest democracy that is a trade and defence partner, a "strong strategic partner" and a Quad member, India is an important country to interact with.

Reviving Reliance's Venezuelan link

He explained that his visit to Jamnagar, where he will see the Reliance energy refinery and the Vantara animal facility, was in order to discuss more Venezuelan oil being brought to the refinery.

"We've talked to them [Reliance Energy] about it in the past. We're going to go see what the holdup is and what opportunities exist. We'll see how the conversation goes. This is a company that has had a presence in Venezuela in the past and whose refining capabilities are substantial," he added.

When asked about India's purchase of Russian oil that makes up about 45% to 50% of its intake, Mr. Rubio said that he was "happy" to see India has made "substantial progress" on diversifying its oil purchases, adding that the U.S. and Venezuela can be the source of more energy inputs to India.

(with inputs from Vinaya Deshpande in Mumbai)

Terror ecosystem must be dismantled: Rajnath

New SCO mechanisms should address clearly identified needs and avoid duplication, Mr. Singh said. He welcomed the decisions to establish the Universal Centre in Tashkent and the Anti-Drug Centre in Dushanbe as permanent SCO bodies, while stressing the need for effective coordination and timely implementation.

Thorny connectivity projects

Highlighting regional connectivity, Mr. Singh noted that initiatives such as the International North-South Transport Corridor and the Chabahar Port in Iran could connect Central Asia with wider markets. However, connectivity projects must respect the sovereignty and territorial integrity of all countries, he said.

The meeting reviewed economic and trade cooperation among member states and discussed transport, finance, the digital economy, and social development and the Heads of Delegation adopted a joint communiqué, the SCO budget for 2027.

Mr. Singh also invited member states to participate in the first SCO Civilisational Dialogue Forum, to be hosted by India later this year.

China imposes curbs on machinery exports

On Monday, China also announced export control measures related to certain types of drones. The controlled items include "autopilots specially designed for Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs); UAVs or unmanned airships with a maximum endurance of three hours or more; certain engines specially designed for UAVs or unmanned airships; and UAVs with a range of 300 kilometres or more" among other items.

The latest announcements followed Beijing on October 16 unveiling a sweeping draft plan to restrict exports of more than 40 cutting-edge technologies, including solar manufacturing technologies, some AI models, and certain biotech platforms.

A number of technologies related to the manufacture of solar cells have been listed for either a complete export ban or restricted exports. While the draft plan does not restrict most solar exports, the new controls on next-generation solar manufacturing technologies could impact efforts by countries including India to reduce dependence on China as they look to move up the solar manufacturing chain.

Centre's plan for Ladakh gives L-G final authority over laws

Draft asks whether the delimitation of constituencies for proposed elected body will be done by election authority or a Delimitation Commission; it also explores reservation of seats for women

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Members of the LAB and the KDA have long demanded the inclusion of Ladakh in the Sixth Schedule of the Constitution. FILE PHOTO

The draft proposed by the Centre for a unique constitutional arrangement in Ladakh says that the Lieutenant-Governor (L-G) would be the final authority on any regulation made by the Union Territory-level elected body.

In the document titled "Constitutional and Statutory Framework", in response to a question on how the U.T.-level body's decisions would take effect, the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) said, "As a legislative practice enshrined in the Constitution of India, every regulation (law) made by the U.T.-level body would go to the Lt. Governor and would take effect after his assent."

Two civil society groups, Leh Apex Body (LAB) and Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA), are part of a high-level committee constituted by the Centre in 2023, to ensure constitutional safeguards for the region, following the revocation of Article 370's applicability in the erstwhile State of Jammu and Kashmir in 2019.

The draft, accessed by *The Hindu*, asks, whether the delimitation of constituencies for the proposed U.T.-level elected body will be done by an election authority or a Delimitation Commission.

It asks whether the delimitation would be only population-based or based on both population and area in different proportions such as 50-50, 60-40 or 40-60 or based on population, panchayat boundaries, seasonal inaccessibility, administrative boundaries and public convenience. There are questions about the electoral rolls whether it will be local body electoral rolls or Lok Sabha poll rolls. On women's representation, the draft explores multiple options, including reserving one-third or up to 50% of the seats in the proposed body for women. It also invites suggestions on whether such reservation should apply only to elected seats or extend to nominated positions as well.

The draft proposes that the new constitutional amendment would create a special governance framework for Ladakh through a new Article in the Constitution, which would provide constitutional status to a U.T.-wide elected body for Ladakh.

The draft seeks LAB's and KDA's views on several institutional questions – whether LAHDCs should receive constitutional status or continue under the existing LAHDC Act, 1997; whether members of the U.T.-level body should be elected directly by the public or indirectly through LAHDCs and panchayati raj institutions; whether nominated members should include experts with special knowledge; the role of Member of Parliament and LAHDC Chief Executive Councillors in the body.

"The principal task at this stage is to settle the constitutional and institutional choices that determine the coherence of the entire framework. The proposed next step is therefore to approve the answers to the options in principle, before proceeding to the clause-by-clause finalisation of the legislative instruments," the draft said.

It added that once the decisions have been settled, the constitutional amendment and the proposed regulation under Article 240 of the Constitution can be revised into a coherent package, supported by a clear subject-allocation framework.

Hill councils to be created in all eight districts of Ladakh

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

Ladakh is all set to hold elections to eight hill councils for eight districts as President Droupadi Murmu promulgated the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (LAHDC) (Amendment) Regulation, 2026, Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena said on Tuesday.

Terming it a "historic regulation", Mr. Saxena said: "It was implemented in a record time of just six days and now paves the way for creation of LAHDC in all eight districts of Ladakh, including the newly-created Sankoo district. The Union Cabinet had approved the amendments on October 14, followed by its promulgation by the Honourable President on 16th October."

Elaborating on the council's composition, Mr. Saxena said the amended regulation rationalises the number of constituencies from the earlier 26 seats in each council, to a minimum of seven seats and maximum 24 seats now. "It also provides for nomination of four members from 'women' and 'unrepresented communities' for greater people's participation in the local governance," said Mr. Saxena.

Ladakh was carved out as a Union Territory in 2019 from the Kashmir division of erstwhile State of Jammu and Kashmir. Prior to 2019, Ladakh had only two hill councils, Kargil and Leh. However, the L-G administration has created eight districts this year.

At present, LAHDC-Kargil, which held elections in 2023, remains in place.

Questions on timing

Meanwhile, the Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA), one of the key civil society bodies holding dialogue with the Centre over the demands of Statehood and Sixth Schedule, questioned the timing of the amendments to the LAHDC.

"At a time when talks are ongoing to negotiate a settlement for Ladakh it is deeply problematic that the government has chosen to make substantial changes to the composition, powers and functioning of these councils without consulting the people and stakeholders of Ladakh," said KDA member Sajjad Kargilli.

Police get transit remand for suspects in actor attack case

Yohaan Varghese
KOTA

The Mumbai Police were granted a 48-hour transit remand for three suspects arrested in connection with the firing at actor Tiger Shroff's car in Mumbai's Juhu by a court in Rajasthan's Kota on Monday.

The investigation has been transferred to the Mumbai Crime Branch's Anti-Extortion Cell.

The suspects were intercepted aboard the Pune-Jaipur Superfast Express at Kota railway station in a joint operation by the Rajasthan Police and the Anti-Gangster Task Force, following inputs from the Mumbai Police. The accused have been identified as Phool Singh, 18, and Rehan, alias Sukka, 18, both residents of Sonipat in Haryana, and Hrithik Kumar, alias Roshan, 22, originally from Begusarai in Bihar.

The suspects were produced before a judge in Kota. After the Mumbai Police secured their 48-hour transit remand, they underwent medical examinations before being handed over to the Mumbai Police.

Meanwhile, the Delhi Police Special Cell has arrested four people, including two women, in connection with the firing. Police suspect they were acting on the directions of a gangster operating from abroad.

(With inputs from PTI)

Shah visits Punjab; drug menace takes centre stage ahead of polls

The Hindu Bureau
CHANDIGARH

Amit Shah meets families of those who lost their lives for raising their voices against the drugs mafia in Punjab. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The drug menace in Punjab, which took centre stage for more than a decade, is yet again emerging as the key poll issue ahead of the 2027 Assembly election.

On Tuesday, Union Home Minister Amit Shah travelled to Punjab and met the families of those who recently lost their lives after speaking out against the drug menace.

Hours before his visit, the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government announced a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe into the murder of Parminder Singh Jhota, anti-drug crusader, who was murdered in Mansa on October 13. Reacting to this development, Mr. Shah said: "Today morning when Bhagwant Mann *ji* came after celebrating his birthday, he did a good thing by handing over an inquiry to the CBI. I also want to appeal to the Chief Minister, please hand over the other two cases to the CBI as well."

Addressing a press conference in Ludhiana, Mr. Shah took a dig at the AAP government. "In Gurdaspur, Bikramjit Singh, in Sangrur, Gurdas Singh and in Mansa district, Parvinder Singh Jota – all three were killed or had to commit suicide because of their fight against drugs. I met their families and I have never found myself so distressed," he said.

He accused the AAP government of doing nothing concrete to eradicate the drug menace. "I have come to remind the Punjab government and its leaders that you had promised to end the drug business within three months. But five years have passed and the business is growing day by day," he said.

"They [AAP] accuse us saying drugs come from the ports of Gujarat and Maharashtra. We have caught up to ₹20,000 crore worth of drugs. What do they mean, should we not catch them? But how do those drugs reach Punjab? It is not possible without political patronage", he added.

UDP expels three MLAs over bid to join NPP

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Less than a month after eight of its 12 MLAs joined the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), Meghalaya's regional United Democratic Party (UDP) is set to lose three more.

On Monday, the UDP expelled three MLAs – Paul Lyngdoh of the West Shillong seat, Renikton Lyngdoh Tongkhar of Mawkyrwat and Nujorki Sungoh of Mookaiaw – after they submitted an application to Assembly Speaker Thomas A. Sangma, seeking to merge with the National People's Party (NPP). The NPP heads the Meghalaya Democratic Alliance government.

With 10 MLAs after eight crossed over from the UDP, the BJP is the second-largest constituent of the coalition government. The Speaker said this was the fifth merger application received during his tenure.

Kuki man killed in Manipur; calls for shutdown intensify

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Most establishments remained closed in Imphal on Tuesday in a shutdown to protest the recent killing of three Meitei civilians. PTI

Unidentified gunmen killed a Kuki man in Manipur's Kangpokpi district on Tuesday, a day after the killing of three Meitei men triggered outrage across Imphal Valley.

Local people said Paolenmung Thangneo, a 44-year-old resident of P. Muolding village, had ventured into a forest with another villager, Laldenga, to collect bamboo shoots when they came under attack around 7 a.m. Mr. Thangneo died due to injuries, while Mr. Laldenga escaped unhurt.

The Committee on Tribal Unity, a Kuki organisation, announced a 24-hour "total shutdown" in Kangpokpi from Tuesday midnight to express collective anguish and demand justice, accountability, protection for the Kuki-Zo people.

The P. Muolding Village Authority blamed the attack on the Isak-Muivah faction of the National Socialist Council of Nagalim (NSCN-IM) and the Zeliangrong United Front (Kamsong). No group had so far claimed responsibility.

Meanwhile, educational institutions, shops and other commercial establishments remained closed across the five districts of the Meitei-dominated Imphal Valley during the 48-hour strike called by the Native People Committee Manipur from Monday midnight to protest the killing of three Meitei civilians.

The three men were killed while collecting firewood in a jungle along the border between Kangpokpi and Imphal East districts.

Protesters blocked roads in some places and burned effigies of Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh, Deputy Chief Minister Nemcha Kipgen and Home Minister Konthoujam Govindas. They held the government responsible for the deteriorating law-and-order situation and demanded their resignation. The Chief Minister met leaders of the INDIA bloc to review the State's overall security situation.

CM hands over aid to stampede victims' kin

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Tuesday called on the family members of those who died in a stampede at Kolkata Durga Puja pandal on October 17.

Mr. Adhikari visited the families of the deceased across several districts Purba Bardhaman, Howrah, Nadia and Hooghly and expressed his condolences to the families. The Chief Minister also handed over a cheque of ₹25 lakh to the relatives and assured government job for one person in every family. Mr. Adhikari spoke to the family members of two of the deceased. "I have no words to console you, nor do I have the power to bring back those who have left us. I am giving you the ₹25 lakh ex gratia," he told the family members in Madhavdighi area in Purba Bardhaman district.

Seven persons have been arrested in connection with the tragedy. West Bengal to hold an investigation by a sitting judge of the Calcutta High Court into the incident.

APPEAL

I am Vimala, 31 years old diagnosed with RDH-MOD, MS, Severe MR, Mod AS, Mild AR and advised to undergo Mitral Valve Repair, (Heart Surgery) at Public Health Centre, Chennai. The surgery cost is Rs.2,00,000/-. I have a 4 Months baby boy and my husband is a daily wage earner. Kindly support me to meet this expenditure. The donations sent through Ch/D.D/NEFT Transfer & GOOGLE PAY (Canara Bank, Nungambakkam Branch, A/c No. 60182010063310, IFSC No: CNRB0016016) favouring **WOMEN'S WELFARE SYNDICATE** is exempted under 80G IT. Your mail id is requested.

All correspondence is done through **WWS**, Regd Public Charitable Trust, **Flat No. GF 1, Corddet Apartments, O.No.13, N.No.29, Pycrofts Garden Lane, Chennai-600006. Ph: 044-42137401/ 31523781/ 7338978027. E-mail ID: womenswelfaresyndicate@gmail.com. Website: www.womenswelfaresyndicate.org.**

Vimala

People facing Ravana in form of joblessness, inflation: Cong.

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Congress general secretary Priyanka Gandhi Vadra on Tuesday said people are facing 'Ravana' in the form of unemployment and inflation, asserting that "we are fighting for the truth" in the battle against falsehood.

Ms. Vadra made the remarks to reporters as she attended the Ramlila event at Gandhi Maidan, located on the Red Fort grounds, where she offered prayers to Lord Ram and sought his blessings.

"This is not an occasion for us to engage in politics, so I will not give any specific message to the government. I would just say that today, the entire public is facing what can be described as a form of Ravana – unemployment, rising inflation," she said.

The battle between truth and falsehood continues even today, she said. "We are fighting for the truth, and we will always continue to fight," she added.

She participated in the Ramleela Mahotsav and the Ravana 'dahan' ceremony.

Earlier in the day, she said in a post in Hindi on X, "Heartfelt greetings on the auspicious festival of Vijayadashami, a symbol of the victory of justice, truth and righteousness over injustice, falsehood and unrighteousness."

"I pray to the epitome of propriety, Lord Ram, that he may bring happiness, peace and prosperity into all your lives," she said.

CJP leaders move HC against extension of their judicial custody

Judicial custody extended by two days; extension of detention violates prescribed procedure, fundamental right to personal liberty, leaders say

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) co-conveners Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka have approached the Delhi High Court challenging the extension of their judicial custody, alleging that their continued detention was illegal.

Mr. Das and Mr. Ranka sought a night hearing in the High Court, which is shut this week for Dasara vacation. The court is likely to take up the petition on Wednesday.

A newly appointed Special Executive Magistrate at the Mandir Marg police station on Monday extended their judicial custody by two days, citing concerns over the possibility of disturbance to public peace.

Mr. Das and Mr. Ranka were taken into custody on October 13 for allegedly climbing over a locked gate to enter Jantar Mantar, which had been denotified as a designated protest site. They were initially remanded to five days of judicial custody.

SEM Ritu Raj observed that the previous conduct of Mr. Das and Mr. Ranka raised doubts about their commitment to complying with the law and their assurance that they would not repeat the alleged actions.

"....at this stage, the grounds of apprehension as presented before me apparently suggests that the conduct of the respondents is not above board; rather it shows no respect for law and their habitualness in calling protest at denotified areas," the SEM stated.

Security personnel outside the police station ahead of the bail hearing of the CJP leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka. ANI

He added that the investigating officer's application contained sufficient material to warrant further consideration of the potential threat to public order.

Leader's petition

In their petition, the CJP leaders have challenged the magistrate's order, arguing that it violates the prescribed legal procedure and their fundamental right to personal liberty under Article 21 of the Constitution.

They have alleged that they have remained in custody for six days despite submitting the required sureties multiple times.

The CJP leaders have also questioned the justification for their continued detention on grounds of public order. Their plea states that any restriction on liberty must be backed by a real and proximate connection with a disturbance of public order, rather than a remote possibility of such a disturbance.

The petitioners have contended that protesting at a site that has been denotified as a designated protest venue would, at most, raise a question of regulatory compliance and would not, by itself, establish a threat to public order.

Only 0.27% of 4.5 lakh Form 6s have been disposed of so far in Delhi

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

Only 1,238 of the 4.5 lakh Form 6 applications seeking inclusion in Delhi's electoral roll have so far been disposed of in 42 days, data accessed by *The Hindu* show.

With special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls under way, eligible citizens left out of the draft roll, published on August 31, are required to fill Form 6, meant for new voters, in the ongoing claims and objections period to seek inclusion in the final roll.

Last week, Delhi's Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) issued fresh directions instructing electoral registration officers to reverify the 47.5 lakh names, through door-to-door visits by booth-level officers (BLOs), removed from the draft roll under the 'absent, shifted, dead and duplicate' (ASDD) categories. Only 10 days remain to file forms for inclusion.

However, not even 1% of the Form 6 applications have been processed, delaying inclusion. These disposals include both accepted and rejected applications.

The deadline to dispose of all claims and objections is November 30, and the delay has raised concerns among citizens seeking re-inclusion.

People whose applications have been pending for over a month said they will lose the chance to reapply if their application is rejected due to errors after October 30, the last date for filing applications for inclusion in the poll rolls. The final roll will be published on December 4.

Ground report: The deadline to dispose of all claims is November 30, and the delay has raised concerns among citizens. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Of the 4.5 lakh applications for inclusion, about 2.39 lakh were filed by those seeking re-inclusion or applying for the first time after the draft roll was published, according to the Delhi CEO's daily bulletin of claims and objections received till October 18. This is only a fraction of the 47.5 lakh names deleted at the draft stage. The remaining 2.12 lakh applications were received even before the draft roll was published, between June and August.

No disposal

The report on form disposal shows that in 15 of the 70 constituencies, no Form 6 has been disposed. This includes Burari, where 1.67 lakh names were deleted, the highest in Delhi in absolute numbers. In the entire north district, where over 36,000 applications have been received, only 27 forms have been disposed of.

Officials attributed the delay to BLOs being engaged with disposal of notice cases.

The same report shows that the disposal of applications objecting to the inclusion of names or requesting deletions of existing names in the roll through Form 7 is five times higher than that of Form 6. Over 5,800 Form 7s have been disposed of during the same period. This is even as BLOs must conduct field verification for both applications for inclusion and objections, with the latter also including a 15-day notice period.

For Form 6 applications, a BLO is assigned to conduct physical verification and submit a report, based on which a decision is taken.

'Rejected twice'

Shagufta, 35, said that for a month now she has been making rounds of the voter centre in Okhla constituency to get herself and her daughter, who turned 19 this year, enrolled. Ms. Shagufta was removed from Delhi's roll even before the SIR began. "I submitted online application Form 6 twice for both of us, and it was rejected. No BLO contacted us and the number we got never picks up."

Even after she visited the voter centre, the reason for the rejection remained unclear. "Now I want to submit the offline form, but voter centre is still asking me to fill it online," she said.

Aman Singh, 42, who was left out of the roll after shifting to a new address in the same area, has been waiting for further action on his Form 6 for the past month. He opened the ECINET app on his phone to show that he submitted his form on September 18, and a BLO was assigned on September 20, but there has been no progress since.

"It has been a month. The SMS I received with the BLO's contact number is unreachable at all times."

The name of the assigned BLO was not mentioned in the BLO list for that area, *The Hindu* verified.

Now, Mr. Singh is anxious as the deadline is nearing. "If I fill in another form, then it will be duplication," he said.

With the filing of claims and objections ending on October 30, voters left out can re-enter the electoral rolls only by submitting a filled Form 6 along with a new declaration that seeks details of the previous SIR. In parts of Delhi, confusion has persisted over a new declaration, with BLOs telling citizens that filing previous SIR details is mandatory.

CPI(M) flags concern over Census Rules in a letter to President

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Communist Party of India (Marxist) general secretary M.A. Baby has urged President Droupadi Murmu to intervene and ask the Centre to withdraw amendments to the Census Rules that allow hiring of private individuals as census enumerators, warning that such a tweak in rules could lead to "arbitrary and politically motivated appointments".

The amended rules allow teachers from aided and unaided private educational institutions, employees of institutions, societies and trusts, as well as officials and clerical staff of public sector undertakings, statutory bodies, banks and companies to be deployed for Census work.

They also empower State governments and Union Territory administrations to appoint any person they consider suitable.

In a letter, Mr. Baby said, "It raises serious questions about the criteria for selection, the impartiality of those appointed, and the safeguards against partisan interference. The discretion granted to State governments and Union Territory administrations, without clearly specified criteria or publicly accountable safeguards, creates considerable scope for arbitrary and politically motivated appointments."

Mr. Baby also expressed concern over the information sought in the Census questionnaire. He said it must not become another SIR and be turned into "an instrument of surveillance, citizenship determination or electoral exclusion".

Does govt. plan to introduce a fresh proposal on delimitation, asks Cong.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Tuesday asked the government whether it had a fresh proposal on delimitation, and why it was "stubbornly refusing" to convene an all-party meeting.

In a post on social media platform X, the party's communications chief, Jairam Ramesh, questioned whether the Centre intended to revive the Constitution Amendment Bill that was defeated in the Lok Sabha in April.

He was responding to Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju's letter to Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge, who had urged Prime Minister Narendra Modi to convene an all-party meeting before bringing any fresh delimitation proposal to Parliament.

Jairam Ramesh

Mr. Ramesh claimed Union Home Minister Amit Shah's consultations with select political parties in March had resulted in commitments that were not incorporated into the Constitution Amendment Bill taken up on April 16. The Bill was defeated in the Lok Sabha on April 17.

"Does the Modi Government have a firm NEW proposal for delimitation that it has discussed with any party," he asked.

He questioned why the government was refusing to "present its NEW proposal in a transparent manner and hear the views of all parties in a collective forum". His third question was whether the Centre intended to bring back the defeated Bill and try to secure its passage with a "super-tainted" two-thirds majority. "That will no doubt fail again," he said.

In his letter to Mr. Kharge on Monday, Mr. Rijiju said the government had consistently sought the Opposition's support for the delimitation-linked women's reservation legislation, and expected the Congress to cooperate.

"I am writing to you to clarify certain points and place on record the facts regarding the efforts made by the government to engage with the Opposition on this subject," he said in his letter to Mr. Kharge.

Mr. Rijiju said he had written to Mr. Kharge on March 16 and 26 and April 12, and had also discussed the matter with him personally. "However, after repeated requests, the Congress party didn't give dates for a discussion, after which the government's outreach had extended to other political parties," the Minister wrote.

He questioned why the demand for consultations was being repeated when the government had already made "sustained efforts for dialogue".

Responding to Mr. Kharge's objection that Parliament had not been prorogued 64 days after it was adjourned *sine die* on August 13, Mr. Rijiju said there was "no constitutional requirement prescribing a specific period" within which a House must be prorogued.

Report flags feature to centrally control access on ECINET

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

Access for State Nodal Officers to view enumeration forms could be switched off, it says

The ECINET, the Election Commission's comprehensive digital platform, has a feature through which viewing of enumeration form details is enabled State by State. This means that access for State Nodal Officers (SNOs) could be switched off anytime making it a centralised platform, according to an audit by 'Charchagram', a civic tech initiative.

The report assumes significance in view of objections raised by Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi over the centralisation of ECINET and the electoral roll database.

The ECINET has a dedicated State Nodal Officer management area (create, manage, update) with a built-in disable action, according to the report, authored by Saurav Rajput, a data scientist and an alumnus of IIT, Delhi and IIM, Calcutta.

Enable, disable buttons

As far as State-level access was concerned, ECINET has an SNO module behind the official login. Each SNO row has a disable button and the disable pop-up says: "On disabling this State Nodal Officer, the user will no longer be able to access the application."

Separately, the code has a message: "View enumeration form details is not enabled for selected State." This, in effect, means that viewing the enumeration form can be switched on or off State by State which, in turn, means that access for State Nodal Officers (SNOs) can be switched off.

The feature can be switched on and off per State, and for States where it is not enabled, officials get a message "View Enumeration Form Details is not enabled for selected State" instead of the form details.

While it was not clear since when this feature was available on ECINET, it might be recalled that the portal itself was launched in January 2026. The ECINET is the ECI's unified portal for officials. Mr. Rajput said he could locate the feature since September 28. The audit says ECINET also carries a feature that can bar electoral registration officers (EROs) and assistant EROs (AEROs) only in West Bengal from reviewing voters' enumeration forms and viewing the notice-and-hearing dashboard.

The Congress said: "It is by now well-established how [CEC] Gyanesh Kumar, at the instance and instructions of the PM (Narendra Modi) and the HM (Amit Shah), put in place ECINET to centralise all manipulations of the election process."

"The law establishes that EROs have statutory authority over the electoral roll. But across the country, the ECINET system and the Election Commission's IT division have overruled and violated these safeguards," Congress leader Jairam Ramesh said in a post on X.

India and U.S. are perfectly aligned on core issues: Rubio

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

India and the U.S. are perfectly aligned on their core issues of national interest, U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio said on Tuesday.

The countries are jointly committed to "dismantling terrorist networks" and "securing justice for victims", according to a statement from the U.S. Consulate-General of Mumbai.

"When two powers are aligned on issues that define the 21st century, then we have an opportunity to write those pages of history of the 21st century," he said, addressing a 'Freedom 250' event in Mumbai. This is Mr. Rubio's second visit to India and first to Mumbai.

Earlier in the day, Mr. Rubio laid a wreath at south Mumbai's Taj Mahal Palace Hotel to honour the memory of the victims of the 26/11 terror attacks. External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar appreciated the gesture and said that India expected its partners to show zero tolerance towards terrorism.

Combating terror

There were six American citizens among the 166 victims who lost their lives in the co-ordinated terror attacks in Mumbai on November 26, 2008, "The Secretary strongly condemned the attacks and reaffirmed the United States' unwavering solidarity with the people of India. Secretary Rubio underscored the Trump Administration's commitment to dismantling terrorist networks and ensuring that those responsible for acts of terrorism are brought to justice, including individuals facing charges for their roles in planning the 2008 Mumbai attacks. His visit reinforced the shared U.S.-India commitment to combating terrorism and securing justice for victims worldwide," the U.S. Consulate General of Mumbai said in a statement.

Boosting ties: Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis with U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio and U.S. Ambassador Sergio Gor. ANI

Mr. Jaishankar said that the entire country appreciated this gesture, welcoming the Trump administration's decision to extradite key accused Tahawwur Rana to India. "We are clear on the right to defend ourselves against terrorism, and expect that our partners show zero tolerance towards terrorism as well," he said.

Mr. Rubio termed the Indo-U.S. alliance "extraordinary", adding that both the countries were equally committed to draw from technological advances in the age of 'super intelligence'. Both countries had the same expertise in technology.

Mr. Jaishankar said the newer vistas for bilateral ties lied in trade, technology, investment and energy. "World order has transitioned. Each will pursue our national interest. New opportunities in our partnership in trade, technology, investment, energy await us. We have a shared stake in strengthening them," he said.

INBRIEF

Final sortie reunites IAF chief with first flying mentor

The Chief of the Air Staff, Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh, on Tuesday completed his final flying sortie at the Air Force Academy in Dundigal, Telangana. Air Chief Marshal Singh is due to retire on October 31. He undertook the sortie on an HJT-16 Kiran Mk-1 trainer aircraft bearing tail number U 707, alongside his first flying instructor, Wing Commander V.S. Kochar (retd). The 55-minute sortie on the Kiran, an iconic trainer aircraft used to train generations of IAF pilots, linked the beginning of his journey as a pilot with its culmination more than four decades later, the IAF said in a statement. His first sortie was on January 28, 1984.

Darbar move: J&K govt. announces shifting of capital

The J&K government on Tuesday announced the annual shifting of the capital from Srinagar to Jammu, a practice stopped by the Lieutenant-Governor's administration after 2021 and resumed by the Omar Abdullah government in 2025. To ferry employees and official files, the government directed the Jammu and Kashmir Road Transport Corporation "to arrange an adequate number of buses in good condition to transport employees on October 31 and November 1." According to the 'Darbar Move' calendar, the offices are scheduled to reopen in the winter capital of Jammu on November 2. In summer capital Srinagar, offices will start closing from October 30 and 31.

Haryana power staff call 3-day strike against giving licence to private discom

HERC grants Eleven Power 25-year licence to distribute power in Gurugram, Nuh; Power Minister says State will contest move before tribunal; staff allege decision will 'undermine' State-owned firm

The Hindu Bureau
GURUGRAM

The Haryana Electricity Employees and Engineers Joint Front has called a three-day Statewide strike from Thursday to protest against the Haryana Electricity Regulatory Commission's (HERC) decision to grant a private company 25-year parallel electricity distribution licence in Gurugram and Nuh. Farmers' organisations and the Opposition, too, have condemned the move as "anti-people".

Haryana Power Minister Anil Vij said the decision was taken by an autonomous body despite the State government's opposition to privatisation. He said it would be challenged before the Appellate Tribunal for Electricity.

In its order dated October 19, the HERC granted Eleven Power Private Limited the licence under Section 14 of the Electricity Act, 2003. Now, over 8.3 lakh power consumers in Gurugram and Nuh, including households, farms, shops, industrial units and offices, can choose between two discoms.

Haryana power employees staging a protest on Tuesday against the decision to grant the licence to a private firm. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

In a statement, the Joint Front alleged that the decision would "undermine" the State-owned Dakshin Haryana Bijli Vitran Nigam by handing over high-revenue areas to a private player. It said the agitation was aimed at protecting the interests of power employees, farmers, and consumers. It announced that the next phase of the agitation and the future course of action would be declared on October 24.

The Bharatiya Kisan Union (BKU), Haryana, has demanded the withdrawal of the licence. BKU State president Rattan Mann said farmers and poor households in Nuh, who benefited from subsidised electricity, could be hit hard as the government has given no written assurance that the subsidies will continue.

'Will increase costs'

He also alleged that higher power tariffs could increase industrial and business costs in Gurugram and Manesar. He announced a mahapanchayat of farmers, workers, and traders in Nuh over the next 15 days.

Indian National Lok Dal patron Sampat Singh condemned the decision as "a grave and irreversible assault on Haryana's public power sector; the interests of farmers, rural consumers, and the poor; and the very principle that essential services must serve people before profit".

"For the first time in Haryana, two discoms have been permitted to operate in the same territory. This has opened the door to a dangerous experiment as electricity is a fundamental public service," he said.

Meanwhile, Eleven Power has, in a petition, committed to supply electricity on a non-discriminatory basis to all categories of consumers and to supply power on request under Section 43 of the Act, releasing new connections within the timelines specified in the commission's Electricity Supply Code. The network will be built in phases over five years across all five divisions of the licence area, with Nuh to be included from the first phase, it stated.

Foreign forces can exploit domestic agitations: RSS chief

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Mohan Bhagwat

Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) chief Mohan Bhagwat on Tuesday cautioned against politically motivated agitations and social divisions. "It's a wrong perception that problems get solved only through agitation," he said, warning that domestic unrest could be exploited by international forces seeking to weaken India.

In his annual address on Vijayadasami, which is the RSS's foundation day, Mr. Bhagwat said protests were a natural consequence of social problems and administrative shortcomings, but stressed that agitations should aim to find solutions rather than deepen hostility or create divisions within society. "Even if it is a section of society staging a protest, the government and administration taking action to maintain peace and order, or political leaders responding to the situation, our actions must not create discord, hostility, resentment or divisions within our united society," the RSS leader said.

He cautioned people that even if their emotions ran high, they must ensure their actions remained within the bounds of the Constitution and the standards of civility that should govern speech, conduct and behaviour, even in the protests.

"We must remain vigilant to ensure that the temptation of electoral gains, cheap popularity or political advantage does not overpower our judgment and goodwill," Mr. Bhagwat said, adding that when a protest became a political instrument driven by hostility towards a person, group or ideology, global forces seeking to keep India subdued take advantage of the situation.

He further said that the current generation needs proper guidance, and that values once passed down by family elders, schools, and society were fading. Seeking a curb on OTT platforms, he said that social media delivered unfiltered information to young people who often could not tell right from wrong.

IIT-B student death: parents seek Fadnavis' intervention

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Parents of Sahil Wakode, an IIT Bombay student who died by suicide, have written to Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis seeking intervention in the case.

Advocate Siddharth Ingale, lawyer for the family, said they received information about Professor Suryanarayan Doolla travelling abroad and wrote to the Chief Minister and the Joint Commissioner of Police seeking details of the travel and the rules under which he was allowed to leave the country while investigation was under way. Professor Doolla has been booked for abetment of suicide. Several students began a sit-in after the police removed a protest site in front of the institution.

At separate Dasara events, Shinde outlines relief work while Uddhav attacks BJP

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Eknath Shinde addressed a meet in Goregaon while Uddhav Thackeray stuck to his annual venue of Shivaji Park

The two splinters of the undivided Shiv Sena held separate Dasara events on Tuesday, a practice solidified over the past few years. Deputy Chief Minister and Shiv Sena leader Eknath Shinde addressed a gathering at the NESCO Exhibition Centre in Goregaon. Shiv Sena (UBT) chief Uddhav Thackeray stuck to his annual Dasara venue of Shivaji Park.

Mr. Shinde outlined measures for farmers facing drought, detailed schemes for women, and responded to claims made by Opposition parties regarding elections. He said the Maharashtra government has dispatched 100 trucks carrying supplies to regions facing drought in the first phase of relief operations. The administration has altered rules to raise the limit for compensation from two hectares to three hectares while compensation for losses of livestock was also provided, he said.

The Deputy CM said his party has initiated the distribution of 25,000 sewing machines to women in households of farmers and 25,000 bicycles to students. Addressing claims regarding EVMs, he said "entities rejected by voters in three elections in a row" cannot alter governance.

At Shivaji Park, Mr. Thackeray asserted that the Opposition, including his party, has stood up for bringing about a 'regime change' and promised to usher in '*achche din*' (good days) after dislodging the BJP-led government at the Centre. He insisted staging a protest is the right of youth because vote theft is happening with everyone, especially new voters.

This was the 60th anniversary of the Dasara rally at the iconic ground in Dadar. Shiv Sena founder Bal Thackeray addressed the first rally on Dasara day in 1966, four months after forming the party on the 'sons of the soil' (Marathi *manoos*) plank.

(With inputs from PTI)

Aditya-L1 mission offers new insights into the direction of solar eruptions

Hemanth C.S.
BENGALURU

Scientists have generated Doppler velocity images of activities taking place in the solar corona using data obtained with the Visible Emission Line Coronagraph (VELC) payload onboard India's maiden solar mission, Aditya-L1.

The Aditya-L1 satellite generates Doppler velocity images of the solar corona, and these images are expected to provide information on the propagation of coronal mass ejections (CMEs) along the Sun-Earth direction, which has been unavailable to date.

Scientists at the Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA), who generated the Doppler velocity images, said it is well known that solar activity leads to the ejection of hot plasma. They said that the massive and energetic plasma cloud ejected during powerful eruptions like the CMEs can travel either in the direction of the Earth or in any other direction from the Sun.

ISRO's Solar Mission Aditya-L1 entering halo orbit.

Scientists said that because CMEs can disrupt near-Earth space, it is important to infer their direction of propagation from the Sun as they erupt. "Universally, it is taught in high schools that the Doppler effect in sound helps to understand whether a train is approaching the railway station platform or moving away from it. A person standing on the platform would hear a steady increase in the pitch of the sound waves due to the train's whistle or horn when the train is coming into the station. The pitch would steadily decrease when the train is moving away from the station," scientists said.

Doppler velocity

Using a similar Doppler effect concept in light waves, the scientists have now generated Doppler velocity images.

"The positive and negative Doppler velocities indicate solar plasma moving away from and towards the direction of the observer, respectively," they said.

The detailed software for processing the VELC data is developed by Dr V. Muthupriyal, Senior Project Scientist with the VELC payload operations team in IIA, and her team. The technical details related to the data processing have been published recently in the Astrophysical Journal after international peer review.

According to R. Ramesh, Senior Professor in IIA and Principal Investigator, VELC project, the Doppler velocity images of the solar corona are unique. Only VELC has the capability to generate such images at present due to its one-of-a-kind spectroscopic observing capability in the visible wavelength range, he said. He added that the related processed images will be disseminated to the scientific community .

THE CROSSWORD 14928

(set by Arden)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thchindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY

Across

1 A continental drift — read about Adriatic sea (7)
5 A complex individual soon to be in charge of gunners (7)
9 The atmosphere during get-togethers (5)
10 Starts with British accent: Incantation in church by a priestess (9)
11 Expert made it transform into a chemical (9)
12 Involved with me in Germany, ready to overlook the odds (5)
13 Try writing about atmospheric pollution (4)
15 Wax filling expired — RIP (8)
18 Home spread — go after foot soldiers (8)
19 Girl wearing men's brand (4)
22 They assist in finding a vaccine finally to stop a virus (5)
24 Poor enthusiasm for payment (9)
26 New voice in case it's heard in and around Hong Kong (9)
27 All hope is gone once it's cooked (5)
28 Left to conclude and herald the future (7)
29 Suppressed anger finally, on the contrary (7)

Down

1 Call father up or is it our forefather (3-3)
2 One in Munich becomes a wasp (9)
3 Part of outer radius is planet Earth (5)
4 Convertible taxi allowed to go around port (9)
5 He announced with enthusiasm, "close borders by end of June" (5)
6 Passing border in record time line (9)
7 Indicate northern drift (5)
8 Program for mature political group (6)
14 A former PM out to catch the boys on time (9)
16 Extremely cohesive — only see working old Sri Lankans (9)
17 Class slogan coined as follows (4,5)
20 Crazy plan to include an aide-de-camp (6)
21 Saw hearts bleed all around (6)
23 A primary resolution to support sound money (5)
24 Combine British advance (5)
25 Keen to increase age restriction (5)

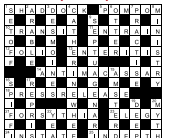
SUDOKU

8			1			7		5
		4			7	3		
9			4	2				
	3	2						4
			7		8			
4						1	9	
				3	5			2
		5	8			9		
3		8			4			6

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

No.5527017 Distribution: www.kingfeatures.com

Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

4	9	7	1	5	3	6	8	2
1	2	8	6	4	7	3	9	5
5	3	6	2	8	9	1	4	7
6	7	4	3	1	2	8	5	9
2	8	5	4	9	6	7	3	1
3	1	9	5	7	8	2	6	4
8	5	1	7	6	4	9	2	3
7	6	3	9	2	5	4	1	8
9	4	2	8	3	1	5	7	6

FAITH

Eight forms of Lakshmi

In the Vishnu Purana, sage Parasara describes Lord Narayana as the father of the entire universe and Goddess Mahalakshmi as its compassionate mother. In a discourse, Thirukkudandhai Dr. Venkatesh said Her boundless compassion manifests in eight distinct divine forms, collectively revered as Ashta Lakshmi. Each manifestation embodies a unique aspect of divine grace, bestowing spiritual wisdom, prosperity, courage, well-being, and abundance upon devotees. Sri Villur Nadadur Srinidhi Swami beautifully celebrates these eight manifestations in the sacred composition Ashtalakshmi Sathakam, highlighting Jagannatha Mahalakshmi's infinite compassion and benevolence. Adi Lakshmi: the primordial form of Mahalakshmi. Known as Bhargavi, the daughter of sage Bhrigu, she performs "Purushakaram" and intercedes for devotees before Lord Narayana. Dhana Lakshmi: adorned in golden garments and portrayed with six hands, she bestows material prosperity.

Dhanya Lakshmi, dressed in green with eight hands, blesses devotees with fertile land, abundant harvest and nourishment. Gaja Lakshmi, with four hands, is shown in a coronation posture with elephants. She symbolises dignity, recognition, and authority. Santana Lakshmi, with six hands and red garments, represents progeny and family well-being. Veera Lakshmi, with eight hands and red garments, grants courage, resilience, and strength. Vijaya Lakshmi, with eight hands and red garments, blesses righteous endeavours with success and symbolises victory over fear. Vidya Lakshmi, in half-white with four hands, grants learning and spiritual wisdom.

Why Big Tech is giving away open-weight AI models and what the companies want in return

From Muse Spark Open to Beam, Nemotron and Timestral, tech firms are releasing AI models to attract developers, challenge Chinese rivals and strengthen their ecosystems by attracting developers, to shape how AI is used and earn money from businesses, services and computing infrastructure built around their models; for Indian firms, these models are an alternative to relying on foreign AI

Balasubramanyam C.P.
CHENNAI

Beam. Muse Spark Open. Nemotron 3.5 Super VL. Nemotron 3.5 Bolt 74B-A9B. Timestral. These may sound like characters from a science-fiction franchise. They are, in fact, names of open-weight AI models announced or released by technology firms in U.S. and Europe in October.

Reflection AI released Beam's weights on October 16. Meta released Muse Spark Open while NVIDIA made two Nemotron models available on October 15. France's Mistral AI also announced Timestral, a family of models designed for time-series forecasting.

Firms are making models available for various tasks viz. from writing software and operating AI agents to interpreting images and forecasting time-series data. But why spend heavily to develop AI models and then allow others to download and adapt them? If the models are free to download, where does money come from?

The answer lies in a race to attract developers, shape how AI is used and earn money from the businesses, services and computing infrastructure built around these models.

Open-weight model

AI models learn patterns from data during training. Their trained parameters, called weights, are numerical values that help fix how the models process inputs and generate responses.

Think of an AI model as a chef who learnt from thousands of recipes. During training, the model learns patterns that help it decide what ingredients to combine and in what proportions to make a certain dish. Its weights shape these decisions. Making the weights available is like sharing the chef's acquired knowledge with other chefs, who can then adapt it to their own needs and create dishes of their own.

Most people access proprietary AI models via websites or apps while developers may access them via application programming interfaces (APIs). The provider controls access and may charge for usage.

An open-weight model makes its trained parameters available for download. Developers can run it on compatible computers or servers, adapt it for particular tasks or integrate it into applications.

This can give businesses and individual users greater control over how they deploy and customise AI models, and reduce dependence on a single provider. However, open-weight does not automatically mean open-source in the fullest sense. A firm may release weights without publishing training code or sufficient information about the data used to train the model. Licences may also curb some uses.

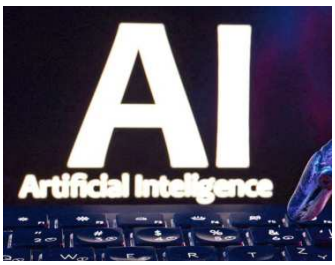
Open-weight AI is not new. OpenAI released GPT-2's weights in 2019. What has changed is the capability available via downloadable models and the emergence of Chinese developers such as DeepSeek as serious competitors, prompting a broader contest over who will shape the AI ecosystem.

Chinese competition

The growing availability of Chinese models has intensified competition in the open-weight AI market. Firms, including DeepSeek and Alibaba, released models whose weights developers can download and adapt. DeepSeek-R1, released in January 2025 under MIT licence, made a reasoning model available for others to use, modify and commercialise. Alibaba's Qwen family includes models of different sizes for a range of applications.

Developers choose models based on performance, cost, hardware requirements and licensing. If a Chinese model meets their needs at a lower overall cost, they may choose it over a proprietary American or European service.

As more developers build applications and tools around a model, its ecosystem can make it more attractive to others.



Highly dynamic: Firms are making models available for different tasks, from writing software to interpreting images. REUTERS

OpenAI made the geopolitical argument explicit when it released its open-weight models in August 2025. It said the models could help partner countries build AI infrastructure on what it called "U.S.-led rails", giving them an incentive to choose "democratic AI" over "autocratic AI". This is the company's stated position but it illustrates how the spread of AI technology is also viewed as a strategic contest.

Where is the money?

The answer depends on what the firm sells. Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg outlined his approach in a July 2024 essay, Open Source AI Is the Path Forward. Drawing a comparison with Linux, he argued releasing Llama's weights may encourage firms to develop tools, integration and hardware optimisation around the models, aiding a broader ecosystem.

Mr. Zuckerberg said selling access to AI models was not Meta's business model, which centred on building products and services. He argued releasing Llama would help Meta avoid dependence on competitors' proprietary technology while encouraging the development of a broader ecosystem of tools and services around its models.

For NVIDIA, the commercial interest is different. It sells computing hardware and related software. Wider adoption of AI applications could raise demand for computing power, potentially benefiting NVIDIA, although developers can run open models on competing hardware. Revenue gains from individual model releases are not guaranteed.

Model developers such as Mistral can offer paid hosting, enterprise support, customised models and private deployments. Alibaba's Qwen models sit alongside its cloud and AI services. A developer may download a model's weights at no cost but pay a provider to host and run it reliably at scale. Alternatively, the developer may run it independently and never pay its creator. The business bet is that wider adoption will generate enough revenue or strategic value elsewhere to justify the cost of developing and releasing the model.

Shaping AI ecosystem

The longer-term prize is influence. A widely-used model can attract developers who build applications and tools around it. These additions can make the model easier to deploy and use, potentially attracting more developers. This reinforcing cycle is known as a network effect.

Distribution matters too. Making model weights downloadable is only one way to encourage adoption. Offering access via APIs, model hubs and inference platforms can make models easier for developers to discover, test and integrate into applications.

Mr. Zuckerberg argued Meta wants Llama to turn into an industry standard. In a 2024 submission to the U.S. National Telecommunications and Information Administration, OpenAI identified brand recognition, recruitment and attracting developers as reasons firms release model weights. It also warned that widely distributing weights can make misuse harder to control, since users can modify models and remove safeguards.

The strategy is therefore not simply about giving technology away. It is about encouraging developers to build on a firm's models, potentially raising demand for its infrastructure, tools and services as AI applications evolve.

There are risks too

Not everyone believes more openness is always better. Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei argued open-weight models can be a public good but warned releasing models with dangerous capabilities can make harmful uses harder to prevent. Once weights are widely distributed, they cannot be withdrawn.

OpenAI has made a similar argument saying that access through an API allows a provider to monitor use and restrict access, while downloaded weights can be run independently, beyond the original developer's control. The trade-off is that open weights can widen access and encourage competition, but reduce the original developer's ability to intervene when a model is misused.

What it means for India

For Indian businesses, open-weight models offer an alternative to relying exclusively on foreign AI services.

Organisations can adapt models to Indian languages and local requirements and may choose to run them on their own infrastructure, depending on their computing resources and the model's licence.

India has its own efforts too. Sarvam AI has released models, including Sarvam 30B and Sarvam 105B while AI4Bharat at IIT Madras has made Indian-language models and tools available to developers.

BharatGen has also released models for Indian languages and domain-specific applications, including agriculture, law and Ayurveda. The objectives, however, vary. Commercial firms may seek revenue via applications and enterprise services while research initiatives may prioritise language access and domestic technical capability.

Open weights alone do not guarantee lower costs. Hardware, maintenance, performance and licensing still matter and organisations must assess if running a model themselves is more economical than using a hosted service.

INBRIEF

Newsprint makers seek PM's intervention over coal deficit

The Indian Newsprint Manufacturers' Association (INMA) has sought Prime Minister Narendra Modi's direct intervention to resolve persistent coal supply disruptions, warning that irregular dispatches and inadequate allocations are constraining domestic production and threatening supplies to the print media industry. In an urgent representation to the PM, the INMA, which represents makers supplying newsprint to leading publications, sought timely coal supplies under existing fuel supply agreements with Coal India Ltd. subsidiaries. Despite valid long-term pacts with the subsidiaries, including Northern Coalfields Ltd., Central Coalfields Ltd., South Eastern Coalfields Ltd. and Western Coalfields Ltd. (WCL), they were not getting allocated coal rakes as per agreed schedules. This forced mills to buy coal from the open market at exorbitant prices and rely on grid power at substantially higher costs to keep plants operational. PTI

India-New Zealand free trade agreement takes effect

The India-New Zealand Free Trade Agreement (FTA), signed on April 27, came into effect on Tuesday, providing duty-free access to a range of Indian goods, including products from labour-intensive sectors such as textiles and leather. It is the seventh trade pact to come into force in the last five years. The others are agreements with the UAE, Mauritius, the European Free Trade Association (EFTA) bloc, the U.K., Oman and Australia. Signed on April 27, the agreement follows negotiations launched in 2010, stalled in 2015 and revived in March 2025. The pact becomes India's 17th operational FTA. New Zealand Prime Minister Christopher Luxon said "As of today, our historic Free Trade Agreement with India is in effect. Working closely with Prime Minister @narendramodi, we've delivered a deal that will help grow both of our economies". He said from Tuesday, Kiwi businesses can reach over a billion more clients with significantly cut tariffs. New Zealand has committed $20 billion FDI in over 15 years. PTI

Amazon targets Nvidia's software edge with AI tool

Balasubramanyam C.P.
CHENNAI

U.S.-based Amazon unveiled an open-source software tool that allows developers to run AI code on its own AI chips with minimal changes, making it easier to switch hardware.

The initiative targets a software advantage that helped Nvidia maintain its position in AI computing.

In an announcement on its official news website, Amazon said cloud-computing arm, Amazon Web Services (AWS), developed TorchNeuron, a tool that allows developers to run AI workloads built using PyTorch on its Trainium2 and Trainium3 chips with minimal code changes.

PyTorch is an open-source machine-learning framework used to develop and train AI models. Amazon estimates 85% of AI researchers and developers use it. TorchNeuron is designed to let developers use familiar PyTorch code and tools on Trainium, potentially reducing engineering work involved in moving workloads to alternative hardware.

"[As much as] 85% of AI developers write code in PyTorch. Until now, trying a new chip meant rewriting work that took months to perfect. That's enormous tax on teams who must be building products not porting code," AWS CEO Matt Garman said.

"Today we're changing that. TorchNeuron runs existing PyTorch code natively on Trainium with a single config change. We're open sourcing it under Apache 2.0 and we're contributing the changes upstream to PyTorch itself, so the whole framework gets more hardware-agnostic for everyone.

The move permits developers to run AI workloads on its Trainium2 and Trainium3 chips.

The move addresses a key challenge for firms developing alternatives to Nvidia's graphics processing units (GPUs). NVIDIA's CUDA platform provides software tools and libraries that allow developers to run AI workloads on its GPUs. Its integration with frameworks such as PyTorch helped build a broad developer ecosystem.

Amazon says moving workloads to alternative chips can require substantial rewriting and revalidation, a barrier TorchNeuron is designed to reduce.

TorchNeuron is being released as a public beta. Amazon is also contributing changes to PyTorch to cut hardware-specific code in the framework to make it easier to run AI workloads on different chips.

The move drew support from Meta's PyTorch engineering team. Jana Van Greunen, director, PyTorch engineering, Meta, said native support for Trainium would give researchers and engineers more choice while allowing them to continue using familiar execution and distributed-computing tools.

ENTERPRISE CONNECT

A Business Initiative

Inauguration of Punjab National Bank's New Branch at Modern International School, Sector 19, Dwarka

The new branch of Punjab National Bank, located at Modern International School, Sector 19, Dwarka, was inaugurated today by the Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Shri Ashok Chandra. Present on the occasion were Executive Director Shri Amit Kumar Srivastava, Zonal Head-Delhi Shri Rajesh Bhowmick, Circle Head-West Delhi Shri Purushottam Vinit, Branch Head Shri Rajan Arora, and other dignitaries. The programme began with a floral tribute to Punjab Kesari Lala Lajpat Rai, the founder of Punjab National Bank and a great freedom fighter. On this occasion, Shri Ashok Chandra and Shri Amit Kumar Srivastava paid tribute to his incomparable contribution to the nation and his visionary role in establishing the Bank. Addressing esteemed customers present at the inauguration ceremony, Shri Ashok Chandra stated that Punjab National Bank is constantly striving to provide better, simpler, and easier banking services to its customers. He emphasised the Bank's commitment to providing an excellent banking experience through expanded banking services, customer-centric approach and modern digital banking facilities. He also encouraged customers to maximise the use of digital banking facilities and avail various services offered by the Bank.

UPES World Congress on Health Sciences and Technology 2026 Concludes with Commitment to Building a Future-Ready Healthcare and Research Ecosystem

The School of Health Sciences and Technology (SoHST), UPES concluded the World Congress on Health Sciences and Technology (WCHST) 2026. Organised by the School of Health Sciences and Technology (SOHST), UPES, under the leadership of Dr. Padma Venkat, Dean, SOHST, UPES and Dr. Nidhi Chauhan, Professor and Organising Secretary, SOHST, the three-day international Congress was held under the theme 'Transforming Health through Research and Innovation'. Following the inaugural day, the second and third day featured participation from a diverse cross-section of the healthcare and research ecosystem, including representatives from the Ministry of AYUSH, Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR), Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), CSIR, National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC), National Forensic Science Laboratory, CSIR-NPL, CSIR-IHBT and AIIMS, alongside industry and technology organisations such as Jubilant Biosys, Panacea Biotec, Forbes Tech Council and BITS Hyderabad, as well as academic and research institutions including Purdue University, Amity University, IISER Kolkata, IIT Gandhinagar, IIT Hyderabad, Manipal University Jaipur, University of Delhi, Plaksha University, and University of Otago, New Zealand, among others.

BIS Highlights Role of Standards in Achieving UN SDG 7, Affordable and Clean Energy, at World Standards Day 2026

Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS), Northern Regional Office, Chandigarh, celebrated World Standards Day 2026 at Hotel Shivalikview, Chandigarh on the theme 'Shared Vision for a Better World – SDG 7: Affordable and Clean Energy'. Every year, on 14th October, the World Standards Day is celebrated across the globe to recognize the important role that standards play in our daily lives and in global economic and social development, and to pay tribute to the thousands of experts worldwide who develop these standards through consensus and collaborative efforts. Hon'ble Minister of State, Food, Civil Supplies & Consumer Affairs and Printing & Stationery, Govt. of Haryana, Shri Rajesh Nagar ji graced the occasion as the Chief Guest. Other dignitaries present included, Shri Saurabh Joshi, Hon'ble Mayor of Chandigarh; Ms. Amneet P. Kumar, along with industry representatives, BIS licensees, consumer organisations, technical experts and other stakeholders.

RECPDCL Hands Over Nawada Durgapur Power Transmission Limited, a SPV of Inter State Transmission Project, to M/s Shivalaya Construction Limited

REC Power Development and Consultancy Limited handed over Nawada Durgapur Power Transmission Limited, the project-specific Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV), to the successful bidder, M/s Shivalaya Construction Limited, on 16th October, 2026. M/s Shivalaya Construction Limited emerged as the successful bidder through the Tariff-Based Competitive Bidding (TBCB) process conducted by RECPDCL, the Bid Process Coordinator, for development of inter-state transmission project "ERES-47: Nawada – Durgapur – Jeerat (New) 765kV corridor" on a Build, Own, Operate and Transfer (BOOT) basis. The SPV was handed over by Sh. Rajkumar Sonkar, HoD (CS), RECPDCL to Mr. Rajesh Kumar Singh, Head (Power and Transmission), Shivalaya Construction Limited, in the presence of senior officials from RECPDCL, Shivalaya Construction Limited and Central Transmission Utility of India Limited. The transmission project broadly envisages establishment of new 765/400/220 kV Substation at Nawada in Bihar and new 765 kV Switching station at Durgapur in West Bengal, 765 kV D/c Line from Nawada to Durgapur (~265 km) and Durgapur to Jeerut (~145 km) along with associated works. The project is scheduled for implementation by 31.03.2029.

From One Shrine to a Three Temple Journey, Vindhya Trikon Drives UP's Shakti Tourism Boom

Vindhyachal's tourism growth is spreading beyond Maa Vindhyavasini Temple to the complete sacred triangle, with Maa Vindhyavasini, Maa Kali Khoh and Maa Ashtabhuja temples together recording around 1.84 crore visits in 2025, up nearly 60 per cent from approximately 1.15 crore in 2023. The combined growth is bringing the centuries old Trikon Parikrama into sharper focus as Uttar Pradesh develops its Shakti Peeth Circuit. The traditional journey begins at Maa Vindhyavasini Temple, continues to Maa Kali Khoh and concludes at Maa Ashtabhuja Temple, connecting three forms of the Goddess within one pilgrimage. Tourism and Culture Minister Jaiveer Singh said the figures reflected the wider impact of development across Vindhyachal. "Under the leadership of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, Vindhyachal is being developed as a complete Shakti destination rather than a single point of darshan," Singh said "Vindhyachal will serve as an anchor of Uttar Pradesh's expanding Shakti Peeth Circuit and introduce devotees from India and abroad to the state's wider traditions of Shakti worship," he added. The wider development portfolio in Vindhyachal carries a listed value of approximately ₹208.09 crore. It covers Maa Ki Paidi, approach roads, the parikrama route, surrounding streets and facilities around the principal temple precinct, along with development around Vindhyavasini Swaroop Devi Temple and infrastructure in the Ashtabhuja and Kali Khoh areas.

TEHRAN

Iran Guards say mines halted three tankers crossing Strait of Hormuz

REUTERS

Iranian Revolutionary Guards said on Tuesday that their naval mines halted three tankers attempting to travel the Strait of Hormuz via routes considered illegal by Tehran. "Three violating oil tankers were set ablaze and halted due to the explosion of mines planted by the brave sailors of the IRGC Navy," the Guards said. AFP

BAMAKO

Islamic State-linked militants kill at least 48 civilians in eastern Mali

AFP

Islamic State-linked militants have killed at least 48 people in Mali in apparent retaliation for an attack on suspected informants by pro-government forces including members of Russia's Africa Corps. The attacks by fighters from Islamic State Sahel Province took place in at least five localities in Menaka. REUTERS

JUBA

Attack on a market in disputed African region kills at least 153

REUTERS

A drone strike on a market in Abyei, a border region disputed by Sudan and South Sudan, hit a nearby fuel depot, killing at least 153 people and igniting a fire that was still burning on Tuesday, a local official said. The Abyei administration's caretaker Information Minister blamed Sudan's military for the attack on Amiet market. AP

CAIRO

Israeli fire kills at least four people in separate incidents in Gaza Strip

AFP

Israeli strikes and gunfire killed at least four Palestinians, including a married couple and a 17-year-old, in separate incidents in the Gaza Strip on Tuesday, health officials said. Israel says the Hamas has been rearming and launching attacks. Hamas denies this claim and accuses Israel of undermining the Gaza peace deal. REUTERS

China pulls out of key investment in Sri Lanka port logistics venture

When China Merchants pledged the investment in 2023, it was touted as the 'first major Foreign Direct Investment' to enter Sri Lanka after the country defaulted on its foreign debt; this is also the second instance of a big investor exiting a project

Meera Srinivasan
COLOMBO

In a significant development concerning Chinese investment in Sri Lanka, state-owned China Merchants Port Holdings has withdrawn from a $392 million joint venture for a logistics hub at the Colombo port.

In 2023, China Merchants Group announced its decision to invest in the proposed South Asia Commercial and Logistics Hub (SACLH) at the Colombo port, taking its cumulative investment in the island nation to $2 billion. According to the joint venture agreed upon then, China Merchants was to hold 70% stakes, while the Sri Lanka Ports Authority (SLPA) and a Sri Lankan private construction company were to hold 15% each.

In 2023, China Merchants Group announced its decision to invest in the South Asia Commercial and Logistics Hub at Colombo port. AFP

"However, following an assessment of the prevailing external circumstances, commercial considerations and the interests of the respective shareholders, a decision was reached not to proceed with the proposed joint venture," the SLPA said on Monday. Further, the SLPA statement said it would pursue "an alternative development strategy" through the establishment of a "new logistics hub" under a Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model, through a competitive bidding process.

When China Merchants pledged the investment in 2023, it was touted as the "first major Foreign Direct Investment" to enter Sri Lanka after the country defaulted on its foreign debt the previous year amid a crushing economic crisis. The firm pulling out now is the second instance of a big investor exiting a project previously agreed upon in Sri Lanka. In February 2025, Adani Green withdrew from a controversial $442-million renewable energy project in northern Sri Lanka, after the ruling government sought to renegotiate the power-purchasing tariff.

On its reasons for the recent decision, China Merchants said: "In view of changes in external circumstances, the Company has reassessed the SACLH Project and concluded that terminating the project would be in the best interests of the parties."

Death roll rises to 73 in Houthi hit on Yemen camp

Associated Press
CAIRO

The death toll from a Houthi (Ansar Allah) missile strike on a government military camp in southern Yemen rose to 73 people, all new recruits, making it the deadliest strike since fighting in the country began escalating three months ago, a senior Yemeni government official said on Tuesday.

The recruits were all aged between 18 and 20, and some were still missing a day after the rebels hit the al-Alam training camp in the southern province of Shabwa with ballistic missiles, local governor Awad Ibn al-Wazir said.

Britain announced on Tuesday that it is expanding its military support for Saudi Arabia against the Houthis to include "defensive" air patrols by Royal Air Force jets.

Residents walk on debris of their homes at Seina district in Taiz, Yemen, after a missile strike on Tuesday. AP

A Houthi missile hit a residential area in the besieged city of Taiz on Tuesday, killing two teenage girls and wounding six other people, local authorities said. Several buildings in the city's Seina area were also damaged, according to provincial authorities.

Saudi authorities issued an attack warning for the capital area late Tuesday morning. An explosion was then heard in northern Riyadh, where King Khalid International Airport is located. Repeated Houthi attacks have forced the airport to suspend operations.

Lula takes to the streets as Flavio leans on Big Tech in Brazil's runoff polls

NEWS ANALYSIS

Shobhan Saxena
SAO PAULO

For the past one week, the streets of Brazil – from the impoverished towns of the Northeast to the rich metropolises of the Southeast – have turned into a sea of red with millions of supporters of President Lula da Silva walking in his support ahead of the October 25 presidential runoff. In Sao Paulo, South America's financial capital, around a million people marched with the banners of Workers Party and placards last Sunday, demanding protection of public education, healthcare and transport. Similar rallies are taking place daily in other cities as Lula prepares to take on his far-right opponent, Flavio Bolsonaro.

The demonstrators, mostly young students and workers, are rallying around issues that directly affect their lives. Rio-based commentator Miguel do Rosario sees the scale of the mobilisation as a desire for a different future. "The streets have sent a clear message: young Brazilians want to dream, and they are proposing an alliance with the future to the President," Mr. Rosario said.

Concrete policies

Amid a tough contest, Lula is trying to turn his street power into concrete policy changes. On Thursday, the Brazilian Senate approved a Bill that ended the six-day work schedule, reduced the maximum working week to 40 hours and guaranteed two days of paid rest each week. "Ending the six-day schedule means more time to rest, spend time with family, watch children grow up, take care of oneself and enjoy life. Those who work so hard to build Brazil also deserve time to live. This is a victory for workers," Lula said after the Senate approved his pet project.

While Lula is campaigning on expanding workers' rights and social protections, Mr. Bolsonaro is proposing a sweeping constitutional overhaul that could reshape Brazil's institutions. He has said he would use the conservative Congress elected on October 4 to change the Constitution and "redemocratise" the country. But critics see it as a euphemism for doing away with existing checks and balances.

Ana Laura Barbosa, a law professor in Sao Paulo, questioned his motive. "I do not see the need for constitutional changes of this kind at the present time. Changing the Constitution is something drastic, something that needs to be thought through, discussed and carefully considered," said Prof Barbosa, challenging Mr. Bolsonaro's claim that Brazil needed to be "redemocratised".

Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva greets supporters during a campaign rally in Porto Alegre, Rio Grande do Sul state, Brazil, on Monday. AFP

Meanwhile, Lula's rallies have helped tighten a race that, after the first round, seemed to be tilting towards Mr. Bolsonaro. The senator finished more than two percentage points ahead of the President, while earlier opinion polls had shown him leading by around four points. That advantage has now evaporated, with the latest polls suggesting that the two candidates are in a technical tie. Lula's strategy of warning the voters about how a return to Bolsonaro-era politics would threaten their rights and benefits seems to be working. "The [Lula] campaign is trying to persuade voters that if Flavio wins, social rights and benefits will be curtailed," said Leonardo Sakamoto, a social commentator. "Lula's strategy is also aimed at the millions who abstained in the first round or cast blank or invalid ballots. The challenge for both campaigns is to reach these voters, whose choices could prove decisive."

With these voters in mind, the campaign for the runoff has become a contest between two sharply different visions for Brazil. They are also applying different strategies: while Lula is relying on street mobilisation, Mr. Bolsonaro is focusing on the digital battlefield where he appears to enjoy an unfair advantage. A report by Brazil's top newspaper Folha de S.Paulo, based on internal Meta messages, revealed on Friday that "technical restrictions" on Instagram prevented Lula's campaign from promoting posts for almost 24 hours on October 9-10. The report also exposed how Mr. Bolsonaro's profile appeared in automatic recommendations on Instagram and WhatsApp, despite electoral rules restricting such recommendations. Though Meta has attributed the problem to a technical glitch, Lula's campaign has officially complained about the platform's "clear bias".

Digital campaign

If that was not enough to give Mr. Bolsonaro an advantage in the digital sphere, another investigation by The Intercept Brasil reported on Friday that Mr. Bolsonaro's campaign and his Liberal Party paid huge amounts of money to the Brazilian cybersecurity firm Elytron to promote an artificial intelligence-based system to analyse large volumes of data, identify voter groups and target them with tailored political messaging. The documents cited by The Intercept describe capabilities far beyond conventional campaign marketing, including fake social-media accounts, the targeted spread of rumours and disinformation and efforts to discredit political opponents. While Mr. Bolsonaro's campaign has denied hiring any service that violated electoral law, Lula's campaign has accused Big Tech of promoting Mr. Bolsonaro's campaign in the digital arena.

Whatever the outcome on October 25, Lula is seeking to leave a lasting legacy through measures aimed at improving the daily lives of ordinary Brazilians.

As Lula's campaign focuses on workers' rights, household finances and access to public services, Lula may still make history next Sunday as more than 160 million people will choose between two starkly contrasting visions for their country.

Russia and Iran have 'never' worked so closely, says Araghchi

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said on Tuesday that Russia and Iran have "never" worked so closely, as Moscow seeks to play a mediating role in the West Asia war.

Mr. Araghchi hosted his Russian counterpart Sergey Lavrov in Iran on Monday, in his first visit since the outbreak of the conflict.

"We covered everything from Europe to West Asia, including Lebanon, Palestine, Ukraine and Yemen. Also focused on expansion of economic and nuclear cooperation," Mr. Araghchi wrote on X.

"Never in our history have Iran and Russia worked as closely as now."

Meanwhile, Iran's security chief Mohsen Rezaei told the visiting Pakistani Army chief Asim Munir that Tehran would not allow nuclear material to leave the country.

"Not even a tiny bit of enriched nuclear material will leave Iran; such materials constitute a major asset and national wealth for Iranian people," he said.

Silent dissent

Tents pitched during an encampment set up in protest against housing shortage, soaring rents and low wages, at Rossio square in central Lisbon, Portgual late on Monday. Protesters demand action to stem housing and living costs in Portugal. AFP

Russian strikes kill nine

Associated Press
KYIV

Russia unleashed another missile and drone blitz in Ukraine, killing at least nine people, officials said on Tuesday, as Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy scrambled to ensure more American and European help during his visit to Norway. "We are maintaining all contacts that can help bring peace," Mr. Zelenskyy said.

India Tourism Development Corporation Ltd.
(A Government of India Undertaking)

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STELLAR KNOCK

Bavuma leads Proteas' sensational fightback against the Aussies

AP

Temba Bavuma hit a career-best 179 to lead a dramatic South African fightback on the third day of the second Test against Australia at St. George's Park on Tuesday.
The scores: South Africa 425/9 decl. in 127.1 overs (Bavuma 179, Jansen 85, Harmer 82, Boland 5/81) vs. Australia 3/1 in 4 overs.

MEMORABLE OUTING

Arafat's all-round show sets up Pakistan's thumping win

AP

Arafat Minhas scored a fifty and followed it up with a six-wicket haul as Pakistan outplayed England by 87 runs in the ODI tri-series at Rawalpindi on Tuesday. **The scores:** Pakistan 302/9 in 50 overs (Hasan Nawaz 79, Arafat 59) bt England 215 in 38.4 overs (Banton 57, Duckett 45, Arafat 6/40). **Toss:** England; **PoM:** Arafat.

SAILING THROUGH

Asmita and Tanvi reach round of 16 in French Open badminton

FILE PHOTO

Asmita Chaliha beat China's Hang Qian Xi 21-18, 24-22 and Tanvi Sharma, *in pic*, defeated Isharani 21-12, 21-12, but the women's doubles pair of Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand lost 17-21, 18-21 to Taiwan's Lin Chih-Chun and Yang Chu Yun in the round of 32 of the French Open badminton tournament in Paris on Tuesday.

PULLED UP

Ronaldo handed 30-day suspension: Portuguese federation

AFP

Cristiano Ronaldo has been handed a 30-day suspension for leaving the Portuguese national team camp during the UEFA Nations League, the country's football federation (FPF) announced on Monday. He will also have to pay a fine of $286. Ronaldo's suspension takes effect from the day of the Denmark match.

Making merry: Harmanpreet and Shafali feasted on the Zimbabwean bowling. X@BCCI WOMEN

Harmanpreet, Shafali sizzle; India wins 3-0

The Women in Blue amass 216 for seven after opting to bat; Zimbabwe falls woefully short in the chase despite Mayers' 60; Nandani scalps three

ZIMBABWE IN INDIA

Press Trust of India
RAIPUR

Shafali Verma made an entertaining 69 (37b, 6x4, 5x6) while former captain Harmanpreet Kaur returned to her destructive best with an unbeaten 91 (41b, 10x4, 5x6) as India hammered Zimbabwe by 92 runs in the third T20I to sweep the series 3-0 here on Tuesday.

Chasing a daunting target of 217, the visiting side could manage only 124 for seven. Opener Sharne Mayers top-scored with 60 (49b, 4x4, 4x6) while Beloved Biza hit 44 (50b, 5x4). Nandani Sharma claimed three for 18.

Earlier, Smriti Mandhana opted to take first strike in order to give more batters time in the middle. The skipper also made way for Anushka Sharma to open the batting alongside Shafali, who scored a second consecutive half-century to lead India's charge.

Anushka (28, 20b, 4x4, 1x6) and Shafali shared a 54-run stand off 32 balls to set the tone. After Shafali's departure, Harmanpreet continued India's six-hitting spree. It was a good surface to bat on, ideal for Harmanpreet to return to her explosive ways.

"It felt great to spend some time in the middle. I just wanted to bat as long as possible," said the 37-year-old. The Women in Blue smashed 62 runs in the last five overs.

The scores: India 216/7 in 20 overs (Shafali Verma 69, Harmanpreet Kaur 91 n.o., Beloved Biza 3/50) bt Zimbabwe 124/7 in 20 overs (Sharne Mayers 60, Beloved Biza 44, Nandani Sharma 3/18). **Toss:** India.
PoM: Harmanpreet; **PoS:** Shafali.
Next match: First ODI: October 23, Vadodara, 2 p.m.

Athletics powers India's show, takes medal tally to 35

ASIAN PARA GAMES

Press Trust of India
NAGOYA

Podium finishers: Women's 200m T12 winner Simran, centre, with her guide runner Shivam and bronze medallist Tejalben. PTI

Nishad Kumar and Deepthi Jeevanji spearheaded India's charge at the Asian Para Games as athletics delivered five gold medals on Tuesday. Nishad followed his T47 long jump triumph with high jump gold, with a Games record 2.04m, while Deepthi retained her 400m T20 title with a record time of 56.36s.

Simran (200m T12) and Pranav Soorma (discus F51/52/53) also struck gold, while Devender's 49.71m in discus F44/64 led an Indian sweep with Rakesh taking silver and Pardeep Kumar bronze. Tejalben Damor bagged a bronze in Simran's event.

In other disciplines, Manish Narwal (men's 10m air pistol SH1) and powerlifter Ashok Kumar Malik (men's 65kg) won silver while shooter Shrishti Arora (women's 10m air pistol SH1), swimmers Himanshu Nandal (men's 400m freestyle S11) and Niranjan Mukundan (men's 200m IM SM7), and Bhavina Patel, Sonalben Patel, Prachi Pandey and Ravi Baby Sahana claimed bronze in table tennis.

Meanwhile on Monday, India opened its campaign with four gold medals across shooting and athletics, led by Mona Agarwal and Nishad Kumar.

Mona won the women's 10m air rifle SH1 gold with a Games record 250.0, edging two-time Paralympic champion Avani Lekhara. Nishad marked his international long jump debut with a 7.11m effort, while Soumya claimed the women's 1500m T12/T13 title ahead of compatriot Venkatesh Radha. Rinku won F46 javelin gold with a 65.11m throw and Ajeet Singh took silver (65.02m).

Judoka Kokila (women's J2/52kg) and swimmer Ravi Karthik Budigina (men's 100m freestyle S13) added silvers, while judoka Kapil Parmar (men's J1/70kg) and middle-distance runner Ravanni Valasanaini (women's 1500m T11) secured bronze medals.

At the end of Tuesday's events, India stood sixth in the standings with a total of 35 medals including nine gold and 11 silver.

Gavaskar wants India players to focus on Ranji

S. Prasanna Venkatesan

Gavaskar. FILE PHOTO

Indian cricket legend Sunil Gavaskar called for greater emphasis on domestic cricket, arguing that the absence of several international players from the Ranji Trophy makes it difficult to assess the "true capability" of emerging cricketers.

"Indian cricket team is not Indian cricket. The Indian cricket team is a by-product of Indian cricket. So, for the by-product of Indian cricket to be good, Indian cricket has to be strong. "When it is the Ranji Trophy season, your contracted players – the 14-15 players you have for Tests and ODIs – need not play. But all the others should be available," he said during a virtual interaction.

Gavaskar also expressed concern over India's demanding schedule, suggesting that the three-match ODI series against Zimbabwe in January "could have been avoided" to give the players more time to rest and prepare for the five-Test series against Australia, starting later that month.

"I know the Indian team has got plenty of talent, and we can say that we'll give the seniors a rest and have the others playing. But that is not what you want. "You do not want to give away Test caps because you want to rest a senior. If there is an injury, that's another matter. But in the last season and maybe the previous season, too many caps have been given. As a former cricketer, I just find that a little bit hard to accept."

The former India captain said he believes "a minimum of three Tests" in a series is "what is needed for Test cricket".

Gavaskar, who expected the in-form Devdutt Padikkal to retain the No. 3 spot ahead of Sai Sudharsan, advised India's Test batters to counter the seam movement in New Zealand by playing late.

"The later you play, the better your chances of scoring runs as well as defending a good ball. Don't push at the ball. Play with soft hands when you are defending."

(Watch India tour of New Zealand live and exclusive on Sony Sports Network and Sony LIV starting October 22).

Dominant Iris hurtle past Railways

BASKETBALL

K. Keerthivasan
BENGALURU

Indian Railways promised a fight but delivered a no-show, crumbling like a sapling would before a tornado, against Denso Iris (Japan) 119-35 in a woefully one-sided Group-B clash in the FIBA Women's Basketball League Asia (WBLA) at the Sree Kanteerava Indoor Stadium here on Tuesday.

Inside the arc, from beyond it or from the free-throw line, Railways, the 41-time National champion, was no match for the Japanese side.

By half-time, Iris had piled up a 58-18 lead, leaving Railways staring at an improbable comeback. Nearly every turnover compounded Railways' misery, as Iris ruthlessly converted it into fast-break points.

The gulf was particularly glaring from beyond the arc. Iris converted five three-pointers in the first quarter and 10 in the second, exposing Railways' inability to contain its perimeter attack. Railways struggled with wayward passes, erratic shooting and a defence that offered little resistance. The Indian champion was outplayed in virtually every department, with the contest threatening to become a rout well before the break.

The results: Group-A: Sichuan Yuanda Meile 92 (Sara Blicavs 27, Chennedy Carter 22, Song Gao 11) bt Cathay Life Tigers 70 (Chu Chu 16, Hui-Ju Liu 14).
B: Denso Iris 119 (Haruna Kasagi 23, Mnami Yabu 16, Mo Shiraishi 16, Sokhna Sylla 12, Hanami Shinohara 11, Mai Kawal 10) bt Indian Railways 35.

In control: Kasagi top-scored for Iris with 23 points. K. MURALI KUMAR

Powar replaces Agarkar, Ojha the new chairman

Amol Karhadkar
MUMBAI

Ramesh Powar has formally replaced Ajit Agarkar in the men's senior national selection committee, with Pragyan Ojha taking over as chairman by virtue of having played the most Tests among the members of the reconstituted panel.

The new line-up combines former India players with experience in different facets of the game, with Powar's coaching background likely to add another perspective to the selection process.

Shiv Sunder Das will complete four years – maximum permissible tenure for a selector – at the end of December.

The Cricket Advisory Committee, comprising Ashok Malhotra and Jatin Paranjape, unanimously recommended Powar's appointment after screening and interviewing applicants at the BCCI headquarters.

The Board secretary Devajit Saikia announced the decision on Monday.

The committee:
Pragyan Ojha (chairman), Shiv Sunder Das, R.P. Singh, Ajay Ratra and Ramesh Powar.

Powar. FILE PHOTO

Guiding hand: Krishnan was a genial presence at the *Sportstar* desk for more than three decades. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Veteran sports scribe P. Krishnan passes away

OBITUARY

Sports Bureau

P. Krishnan, former Senior Deputy Editor of *Sportstar*, passed away in Chennai on Tuesday.

He was 69 and is survived by a daughter.

To a generation of reporters and sub-editors, 'PK sir', as he was affectionately known, was perhaps the most patient teacher any journalist could have asked for.

He belonged to the old school of journalism, where editing was never merely about correcting a sentence or tightening a paragraph. He took his time with a story, searching for a better turn of phrase, improving its rhythm and often prising out nuggets from a reporter's memory that the reporter had not thought worth including.

He was also a master of the headline. Some of *Sportstar*'s most iconic cover lines, until his retirement in 2020, came from his inventive mind, which at times had a devilish sense of humour!

Krishnan joined *The Hindu* in August 1980 before moving to *Sportstar*, where he became the backbone of the editorial desk for more than 30 years.

A thorough professional and a gentleman at heart, he never made a young reporter feel inadequate for getting something wrong. Instead, he showed them how it could be made better.

His contribution went well beyond the pages of the magazine. He was the person colleagues turned to for almost everything – a contact, a clarification on an obscure sporting rule, a second reading of a difficult story or simply some sound advice. He rarely, if ever, said no.

For all his editorial skills, Krishnan never sought the spotlight. His warmth, humour and generosity helped make the *Sportstar* desk more than a workplace.

For many, it was a family, and he was one of its most reassuring presences.

Molineux and Dunkley set base price of ₹50 lakh

WPL AUCTION

Sports Bureau

Dunkley and Molineux. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT& FILE PHOTO: R.V. MOORTHY

Australia captain Sophie Molineux and English opener Sophia Dunkley are the only players who have put themselves at the maximum base price of ₹50 lakh for the WPL's mini auction to be held at Kochi on October 28.

146 players
As many as 146 players are in the list released by the BCCI. Only 27 slots are available, though, across the five franchises. Among them, UP Warriorz has the biggest purse – ₹3.75 crore.

Gujarat Giants is left with ₹1.25 crore, while the defending champion Royal Challengers Bengaluru could spend ₹1.15 crore at the auction. Delhi Capitals has a purse of ₹1.1 crore and Mumbai Indians ₹90 lakh.

After Molineux and Dunkley, the players with the highest price tags are G. Kamalini, Kiran Navgire and the Australian duo of Heather Graham and Jess Jonassen, at ₹40 lakh.

Available at the base price of ₹30 lakh are some big names, including Chamari Athapaththu, Grace Harris, Chloe Tryon, Nonkululeko Mlaba and Sneh Rana.

Of the players going under the hammer are 27 from overseas, including six from associate nations. Of the 119 Indians, 22 are capped.

Twenty slots are reserved for Indian players. Ahead of the auction, Mumbai Indians had traded the American left-arm seamer Tara Norris from UP Warriorz for ₹10 lakh. That leaves UP Warriorz with eight slots to fill at the mini auction. MI could add six more players, while RCB and Delhi Capitals could bid for five each and Gujarat Giants three.

INBRIEF

Maddison sparkles as Spurs' win drought ends

James Maddison made a sensational return to Tottenham's starting line-up after 17 months away on Monday as Spurs beat Coventry 3-1 to claim its long-awaited first Premier League win of the season. Lazio scored a statement win on Sunday, brushing aside Juventus 3-0 in Turin to move level on points with Inter Milan at the top of Serie A. Kylian Mbappe scored twice including one brilliant individual goal as Real Madrid thrashed Sevilla 4-1 in LaLiga on Sunday.

Important results: Premier League: Tottenham 3 (Maddison 14, Marmoush 58, Davies 90+6) bt Coventry 1 (Rudoni 49).
LaLiga: Celta Vigo 2 (Jutlga 53, Rodriguez 71) bt Alaves 1 (Novoa 87); Malaga 2 (Nino 54, Martinez 66) lost to Real Sociedad 5 (Kubo 3, Oskarsson 26, Oyarzabal 59, 67, Guedes 73); Real Madrid 4 (Guler 30, Mbappe 37, 63-pen, Diomande 82) bt Sevilla 1 (Bueno 80).
Serie A: Fiorentina 1 (Pongracic 42) lost to Como 3 (Liberali 32, Paz 36, Douvikas 56); AC Milan 3 (Ramos 24-pen, Rabiot 43, Gila 57) bt Atalanta 2 (Gaetano 66, Krstovic 81); Juventus 0 lost to Lazio 3 (Provstgaard 37, Isaksen 66, Dele-Bashiru 89).

LIVE TELECAST

Ranji Trophy: Day 4, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.
South Africa vs. Australia: Second Test, Day 4, Eurosport & FanCode, 1.30 p.m.
ODI tri-series: Afghanistan vs. Bangladesh, FanCode, 5 p.m.
Champions League: Sony Sports Ten 1, 2, 3, 5 & LIV, 10.15 p.m. & 12.30 a.m. (Thursday)

Hingrajia leads Gujarat's sturdy reply after Badoni's double propels Delhi

The visitor reaches 363 for five at stumps, thanks to the southpaw's unbeaten ton; the host bowlers, with 285 runs still in the bag, have a task at hand

RANJI TROPHY

Vivek Krishnan
NEW DELHI

If Priyansh Arya's 199 and Ayush Badoni's 217 for Delhi were studded with modern-day flamboyance, Manan Hingrajia's unbeaten 108 (274b, 12x4, 1x6) for Gujarat at the Palam 'B' ground here on Tuesday was a throwback to old-school solidity. The 28-year-old may possibly have more attacking shots in his armoury, but the left-hand batter was intent on displaying admirable restraint on day three of the Ranji Trophy Group-C clash in the national capital. From his overnight score of 12, he carried on through the entire day to take Gujarat's first-innings total to 363 for five at the close.

The visitors still stare at a deficit of 285 runs, but they should fancy their chances of grinding down Delhi's bowlers further on a slow deck. Giving Hingrajia company at stumps was skipper Chintan Gaja (41 batting, 105b, 3x4). On a surface where wickets are ever so hard to come by, Delhi may come to rue Gaja's reprieve on five by Money Grewal at fine-leg off Navdeep Saini. All-rounder Jaymeet Patel also played a solid hand (72, 119b, 9x4), sharing a 124-run fifth-wicket stand with Hingrajia.

In focus: Hingrajia, right, will hope to emulate Badoni and extend his stay at the crease further. FILE PHOTO: J. ALLEN EGENUSE & R.V. MOORTHY

Hingrajia's approach – he scored just 96 runs in the whole day – was apt for the situation. Gujarat had fared reasonably to get to 98 for two at the end of the second day in response to the host's 648 for six declared. But in Tuesday's opening session, the loss of two more wickets was an undeniable dent. Vedant Trivedi departed in the seventh over of the day when he was strangled down the leg side off Divij Mehra. Wicketkeeper Anuj Rawat, who was standing up to the stumps to the medium-pacer, showed ample skill and agility to grab a difficult catch.

Urvil Patel's impetuosity to attack meant his contribution was confined to a 28-ball 23. With off-spinner Hrithik Shokeen turning the ball into his hitting arc, Urvil couldn't resist a slog across the line, only to find Ayush Badoni snaffling a sharp catch at slip.

The scores: Delhi — 1st innings: Priyansh Arya b Hingrajia 199, Sanat Sangwan c Urvil b Harshal 8, Yash Dhull c Trivedi b Harshal 10, Ayush Doseja (run out) 29, Ayush Badoni c Urvil b Jaymeet 217, Sumit Mathur c Abhishek b Hingrajia 92, Anuj Rawat (not out) 61; Extras (b-12, lb-13, w-7): 32; Total (for six wkts. decl. in 136.4 overs): 648.
Fall of wickets: 1-67, 2-87, 3-142, 4-376, 5-543, 6-648.
Gujarat bowling: Gaja 24-4-91-0, Nagwaswalla 24-1-91-0, Harshal 18-0-97-2, Jaymeet 18-6-66-1, Siddharth 26-2-127-0, Hingrajia 14.4-1-72-2, Jayswal 11-0-76-0, Aarya 1-0-3-0.
Gujarat — 1st innings: Abhishek Desai c Doseja b Shokeen 34, Aarya Desai c Dhull b Shokeen 11, Vedant Trivedi c Rawat b Divij 38, Manan Hingrajia (batting) 108, Urvil Patel c Badoni b Shokeen 23, Jaymeet Patel c Sanat b Saini 72, Chintan Gaja (batting) 41; Extras (b-25, lb-7, w-1, nb-3): 36; Total (for five wkts. in 120 overs): 363.
Fall of wickets: 1-25, 2-79, 3-118, 4-153, 5-277.
Delhi bowling: Divij 13-2-34-1, Saini 20-4-46-1, Shokeen 31-3-94-3, Grewal 14-2-40-0, Badoni 17-3-53-0, Mathur 13-1-39-0, Priyansh 7-1-13-0, Doseja 5-0-12-0.

Australian umpire Treloar on duty in Delhi-Gujarat Ranji Trophy tie

Vivek Krishnan
NEW DELHI

Treloar and Parashar Joshi are involved in this umpire exchange programme with the Indian scheduled to officiate in Australia.

Australia's Ben Treloar is one of the two on-field umpires in the ongoing Ranji Trophy fixture between Delhi and Gujarat at the Palam 'B' ground here.

The 44-year-old is in Delhi as part of an exchange programme between Cricket Australia (CA) and the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI).

Experience
Treloar has considerable experience in his locker, having officiated in 30 First Class, 20 List-A and 39 Big Bash League games.

He has also stood in two Women's One-Day Internationals (ODIs) and four Women's T20Is.

Away from the field, Treloar works as Cricket New South Wales' Umpire Education Officer, where he grooms the next generation of umpires.

Treloar will officiate two Ranji games, with his next assignment being Mumbai against Haryana in Mumbai from October 26 to 29.

The exchange will see Indian umpire Parashar Joshi travel to Australia to stand in two Sheffield Shield matches and a One-Day Cup fixture.

Joshi, who hails from Maharashtra, has been part of the Indian domestic system for some time.

His credentials include 19 First Class appearances in the Ranji Trophy and Duleep Trophy, 32 List-A matches and 40 T20s.

He has also umpired games in the Indian Premier League (IPL).

RANJI TROPHY SCORES - ROUND 2, DAY TWO AND THREE

Mizoram's Chinmay Sutar (400 not out, 517b, 46x4, 7x6) became the second Indian batter to score 400 in an innings in First Class cricket, achieving the rare feat on the second day of the Ranji Trophy Plate Group match against Nagaland in Sovima on Monday.
The first Indian was B.B. Nimbalkar (443 n.o., Maharashtra vs. Kathiawar, 1948).

Special one: Chinmay Sutar is the latest entrant to the 400-club.

The scores:
Elite: Group A: At Vadodara: Bihar 166 & 251 in 76.2 overs (Mangal Mahrour 138, Ayush Loharuka 49, Bhargav Bhatt 6/53) lost to Baroda 416 in 114.1 overs (Priyanshu Moliya 132, Mahesh Pithiya 61, Deepak Hooda 70, Raj Limbani 44, Amod Yadav 5/139) & 4/0 in 1.1 overs; **Points: Baroda 7(14), Bihar 0(0).**
At Puducherry: Pondicherry 177 & 98/1 in 38 overs (Ritesh Gudge 47 batting) vs. Madhya Pradesh 345 in 111.2 overs (Chanchal Rathore 78, Shubham Sharma 58, Rajat Patidar 122, Atharva Mahajan 43, Sagar Trivedi 4/44).
At Srinagar: Jammu & Kashmir 260 & 123 in 39.2 overs (Nachiket Bhute 5/48) lost to Vidarbha 305 in 73 overs (R. Samarth 143, Rajneesh Gurbani 64 n.o., Umar Nazir Mir 4/56, Sunil Kumar 4/73) & 81/7 in 22.5 overs (Sunil Kumar 4/30); **Vidarbha 6(12), J&K 0(1).**
At Kanpur: Uttar Pradesh 202 & 197 in 58.4 overs (Aryan Juyal 74, Yash Kasvankar 5/69) bt Goa 164 in 61.3 overs (Shivendra Bhujbal 44, Zeeshan Ansari 5/45) & 167 in 46 overs (Suyash Prabhudessai 72, Kartik Yadav 5/37); **UP 6(13), Goa 0(0).**
Group B: At Guwahati: Assam 334 in 111.1 overs (Sibsankar Roy 54, Sumit Ghadigaonkar 49, Swarupam Purkayastha 69, Sandip Sarkar 4/76) & 36/1 in 13.2 overs bt Tripura 62 in 22.1 overs & 307 in 67.4 overs (Sentu Sarkar 59, Manisankar Murasingh 161, Mohit Thakur 5/101); **Assam 6(7), Tripura 0(0).**
At Vijayawada: Hyderabad 275 & 306/7 decl. in 95.3 overs (Tanmay Agarwal 49, Kodimela Himateja 123 n.o., Tanay Thyagarajann 53 n.o., Kavuri Saiteja 4/40) vs. Andhra 184 in 63 overs (Shaik Rasheed 61, Tanay Thyagarajann 5/63) & 7/2 in four overs.
At Bengaluru: Karnataka 342 in 111.3 overs (Mayank Agarwal 42, K.V. Aneesh 59, Karun Nair 46, Manvanth Kumar 135, Parth Bhut 5/89) & 99/2 in 26 overs vs. Saurashtra 349 in 108.3 overs (Hetvik Kotak 46, Harvik Desai 77, Arpit Vasavada 65, Sammar Gajjar 79, Vidwath Kaverappa 4/57).
At New Chandigarh: Punjab 456 in 152.5 overs (Vihaan Malhotra 40, Uday Saharan 161, Prabhsimran Singh 62, Salil Arora 107, Dharmendrasinh Jadeja 7/173) vs. Chhattisgarh 206 in 64.5 overs (Amandeep Khare 91, Vikalp Tiwari 47, Harpreet Brar 7/56) & 123/3 in 54 overs (Ayush Pandey 59 batting).
Group C: At Pune: Jharkhand 169 & 130/1 in 47 overs (Shikhar Mohan 74 batting, Utkarsh Singh 45 batting) vs. Maharashtra 527/5 decl. in 150 overs (Sachin Dhas 58, Digvijay Patil 148, Ankit Bawne 169 n.o., Ruturaj Gaikwad 101 n.o.).
At New Delhi: Delhi 648/6 decl. in 136.4 overs (Priyansh Arya 199, Ayush Badoni 217, Sumit Mathur 92, Anuj Rawat 61 batting) vs. Gujarat 363/5 in 120 overs (Manan Hingrajia 108 batting, Jaymeet Patel 72, Chintan Gaja 41 batting).
At New Delhi: Bengal 184 & 146 in 52.5 overs (Rahul Singh 5/43) bt Services 122 in 62.2 overs (Rajat Paliwal 48 n.o., Shahbaz Ahmed 4/35, Aamir Gani 4/31) & 148 in 68.5 overs (Nitin Tanwar 49, Pradipta Pramanik 4/48); **Bengal 6(12), Services 0(0).**
At Thiruvananthapuram: Kerala 404 in 129.3 overs (Sachin Baby 112, Mohammed Azharuddeen 139 n.o., Aditya Sarvate 53) vs. Odisha 225 in 84.1 overs (Gourav Choudhary 50, Subhranshu Senapati 50, Vaisakh Chandran 4/40) & 102/4 in 35 overs (Gourav Choudhary 53).
Group D: At Rohtak: Chandigarh 103 & 118 in 47 overs (Manan Vohra 47, Nishant Sindhu 6/27) lost to Haryana 245 in 77.1 overs (Nishant Sindhu 92, Yashvardhan Dalal 95, Nishunk Birla 5/63); Haryana 7(13), Chandigarh 0(0).
At Bilaspur: Himachal Pradesh 140 & 144/3 in 56 overs vs. Mumbai 528/8 decl. in 151 overs (Musheer Khan 57, Siddhesh Lad 87, Sarfaraz Khan 154, Akash Anand 117 n.o., Jitender Rana 4/108).
At Chennai: Uttarakhand 134 & 113 in 45.4 overs (Sai Kishore 6/34, Ajith Ram 4/33) lost to Tamil Nadu 313 in 109 overs (Pradosh Ranjan Paul 136, B. Indrajith 77, Mayank Mishra 5/118, Avneesh Sudha 4/34); **TN 7(8), Uttarakhand 0(3).**
At Jaipur: Rajasthan 497 in 136 overs (Sachin Yadav 194, Karan Lamba 194) vs. Railways 305/6 in 112 overs (Eshaan Goyal 64, Bhargav Merai 73, Ravi Singh 53).
Plate: At Nadiad: Arunachal Pradesh 121 & 123 in 54 overs (Satyajeet Bachhav 5/27) lost to Sikkim 572/5 decl. in 142 overs (Nilesh Lamichaney 134, Ashish Thapa 70, Parth Palawat 151, Gurinder Singh 146); **Sikkim 7(8), Arunachal 0(0).**
At Shillong: Meghalaya 380 in 101 overs (Kevin Christopher 110, Arpit Bhatewara 54, Swastic Chettri 84, Pheiroijam Jotin 5/79) & 172 in 51.5 overs (Pheiroijam Jotin 4/21) vs. Manipur 277 in 92 overs (Karnajit Yumnam 100, Rex Rajkumar 43, Abhishek Kumar 4/60) & 11/0 in three overs.
At Sovima: Mizoram 581/9 decl. in 154.1 overs (Chinmay Sutar 400 n.o., Jehu Anderson 69) vs. Nagaland 324/3 in 101 overs (Joshua Ozukum 48, Sedezhalie Rupero 108 batting, Yugandhar Singh 98).

Veteran Shami not giving up hope

Vivek Krishnan
NEW DELHI

A day after India's Test and ODI squads for the tour of New Zealand were announced, Bengal trained in preparation for its Ranji Trophy game against Services at Palam. Mohammed Shami was very much a part of the practice session, but when the game began the following morning, the veteran pacer was absent from the playing XI.

Clarification
It could have been perceived to be a vexed reaction to his continued absence from India's plans over the last 18 months and certainly prompted more theories surrounding Shami's fitness, but the 36-year-old set the record straight on Tuesday.

"You could see the condition of the pitch, right? There was no point in playing on this wicket and bowling two to four overs. It was better that the youngsters got a run," he said. "The more they play, the more experience they will get."

Shami's reference was to the spin-friendly surface on view.

Shami's last international outing was the Champions Trophy final in March 2025.

At his age, Shami's chances of an India recall seem remote. However, he won't stop hoping. "Why should I give up hope? The hope should always be there. In any profession, you should always have a goal. I don't deny I have that goal".

Arrived obliges in Golconda St. Leger, but dies shortly afterwards in a tragic turn of events

HYDERABAD: Trainer Adhirajsingh Jodha's colt Arrived, ridden by P. Trevor, won the Golconda St. Leger (Gr. 2), pillar to post, the main attraction of Monday's (Oct. 19) races. Arrived gave his owners a classic victory to cherish, but the joy soon turned to sorrow as he suffered a heart attack and died shortly after passing the winning post.
He was owned by M/s. Gautam Lala rep. Gainsville Stud & Agl. Farm Pvt. Ltd., Vikram Bachhawat rep. Bachhawat Farms Pvt. Ltd., Haider Soomar, Kishore P. Rungta, Atul N. Amersey rep. So Blest Trading Co. Pvt. Ltd., Mukul Sonawala, Saleem Fazelbhoy, Roopesh M. Kaul rep. Phantom Racing LLP, Ms. Ameeta Mehra & Mr. Ajay K. Arora.
THE RESULTS:
1. NIJINKSY PLATE (DIV. I) (1,200M): RAJENDRA (H.M. Akshay) 1, Wildstar (Mukesh K) 2, Costa Mesa (Akshay K) 3 and Starlight Dancer (Rajpratap) 4. 2, Neck and 3/4. Im, 14.62s. ₹75 (w), 12, 14 and 10 (p). SHP: 24, THP: 93, FP: 785, Q: 126, Tanala: 924. Favourite: Costa Mesa. Owner: Mr. Meka Nitish Reddy. Trainer: S. Sreekant. **NOTE:** *Cee Bees (Kuldeep Sr. up) dislodged the rider soon after the start. Kuldeep escaped unhurt.*
2. SANDOWN PARK PLATE (1,400M): N R I TRIPLE POWER (Akshay Kumar) 1, Black Onyx (D.S. Deora) 2, Decoy (Afroz K) 3 and Sugar (B.R. Kumar) 4. 6-3/4, 1-1/4 and 1-1/2. Im, 25.88s. ₹14 (w), 10, 13 and 15 (p). SHP: 23, THP: 49, FP: 30, Q: 20, Tanala: 170. Favourite: N R I Triple Power. Owner: Mr. Ravinder Reddy Male. Trainer: D. Netto.
3. S.S. CARDMASTER MEMORIAL TROPHY (1,400M): EMPERORS CHARM (P. Trevor) 1, December Rain (Mohit S) 2, Una Paloma Blanca (Surya Prakash) 3 and Great Giver (Mukesh K) 4. 3/4, 1 and 2. Im, 28.30s. ₹20 (w), 14, 10 and 23 (p). SHP: 30, THP: 49, FP: 53, Q: 28, Tanala: 338. Favourite: Emperors Charm. Owner: Mr. Hothur Sajjad Wahab. Trainer: A. Imran Khan.
4. KINNERASANI TROPHY (1,200M): OJAS MAXIMUS (Akshay Kumar) 1, Dubai Touch (Bhawani S) 2, Sharanga (Trevor) 3 and Miss Smiley Angel (Mukesh K) 4. 2-1/4, 3 and Neck. Im 13.60s. ₹17 (w), 14, 12 and 10 (p). SHP: 37, THP: 24, FP: 67, Q: 47, Tanala: 77. Favourite: Ojas Maximus. Owner: Mr. Vijay Anand Jangiti. Trainer: S. Sreekant.
5. GOLCONDA ST. LEGER (GR. II) (2,800M): ARRIVED (P. TREVOR) 1, Gold Empire (Suraj Narredu) 2, Superstar (Ashad Asbar) 3 and High Command (P. Ajeeth K) 4. 3/4, 3 and 9. 2m, 58.55s. ₹15 (w), 10, 13 and 13 (p). SHP: 31, FP: 30, Q: 19, Tanala: 79. Favourite: Arrived. Owners: M/s. Gautam Lala rep. Gainsville Stud & Agl. Farm Pvt. Ltd., Vikram Bachhawat rep. Bachhawat Farms Pvt. Ltd., Haider Soomar, Kishore P. Rungta, Atul N. Amersey rep. So Blest Trading Co. Pvt. Ltd., Mukul Sonawala, Saleem Fazelbhoy, Roopesh M. Kaul rep. Phantom Racing LLP, Ms. Ameeta Mehra & Mr. Ajay K. Arora. Trainer: Adhirajsingh Jodha.
6. NIJINSKY PLATE (DIV. II) (1,200M): FARSIRIS (Sonu Kumar) 1, Night Whisper (H.M. Akshay) 2, Miri (Mohit S) 3 and Bodhi (P. Ajeeth K) 4. 2-3/4, 3-1/4 and 1-1/2. Im, 14.98s. ₹34 (w), 15, 10 and 31 (p). SHP: 53, THP: 70, FP: 171, Q: 96, Tanala: 2, 309. Favourite: Konaseema. Owners: M/s. Sardar Jivtesh Singh, S. Daljeet Singh & Chukkala Ashok. Trainer: M.F. Ali Khan.
NOTE: *First favourite Konaseema (Vikram Singh astride) dropped the rider near 900m.*
Jackpot: 70%: ₹710 (505 tkts.) & 30%: 44 (3,494 tkts.).
Mini Jackpot: 447 (143 tkts.).
Treble: (i) 836 (35 tkts.), (ii) 184 (176 tkts.).

Joy to sorrow: P. Trevor guiding Arrived past the finish line in the Golconda St. Leger in Hyderabad on Monday. The colt, however, died due to a heart failure. SIDDHANT THAKUR

Punjab salvages a point against Mumbai City

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

Substitute Gurkirat Singh's 90th-minute equaliser helped Punjab FC come from behind to secure a 1-1 draw against Mumbai City FC in the Indian Super League fixture on Monday.

Uruguay's Leandro Otormin had given the western outfit the lead from the penalty spot in the 65th minute. In the dying stages, the host's Gurkirat headed a cross from Sanathoi Meetei into the back of the net.

Following the draw, Punjab has four points from its opening two matches, having beaten Odisha at home last week.

Punjab's head coach Pavlos Dermitzakis made one change to the starting XI, handing young forward Vishal Yadav a start in place of the injured Alfred Planas Moya. After a goalless first half, the deadlock was broken when winger Noufal P.N. drove forward from the left.

Bijoy Varghese slipped while attempting to challenge him, and the referee immediately pointed to the spot. Otormin stepped up and converted confidently with a right-footed effort to put Mumbai City in front.

Punjab responded by committing more players forward in search of a goal. Goalkeeper Arshdeep Singh kept Punjab in the contest with a save from Akash Mishra's header in the 74th minute. Much to Punjab's relief, the final minute of regulation time saw Meetei's cross being directed into the goal by Gurkirat via a powerful header.

The result: Punjab FC 1 (Gurkirat Singh 90) drew with Mumbai City FC 1 (Leandro Otormin 65).

I'm normally a very good ball-striker, but I had to rely on my short game

The Spaniard is elated that he could overcome challenges on and off the course; he wants to be up there with his country's greats in the sport and speaks fondly about his love for India

INTERVIEW

Eugenio Chacarra

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

Coming into the DP World India Championship, the spotlight was firmly on Eugenio Chacarra, Rory McIlroy and Patrick Reed. The three golfers arrived in New Delhi with plenty at stake, locked in a battle for crucial points in the Race to Dubai, the season-long contest to crown the DP World Tour's leading player.

McIlroy, one of the modern greats of the game, drew the crowds to the Delhi Golf Club (DGC). Reed, the 2018 Masters champion, brought his own share of intrigue. But as the tournament unfolded, the narrative took a turn. The attention gradually shifted to Chacarra, the 26-year-old Spaniard who turned a demanding week into a statement of intent.

By the time the final putt dropped, there was little doubt about who had been the player of the tournament.

Chacarra was a class apart, negotiating the DGC's unforgiving layout with remarkable composure. The tight fairways and thick, overgrown rough offered little margin for error, testing both precision and patience. Yet the Spaniard seemed to find a way through, combining sound course management with the resilience required to survive a punishing week.

The challenge extended well beyond the course itself. Heavy rain disrupted the opening round, leaving the field scrambling to make up lost ground. The result was a gruelling schedule that demanded long hours and sustained concentration, with players often required to complete 25 to 30 holes in a day.

Chacarra faced that relentless workload with a broken toe adding to his discomfort. It was a test of endurance as much as golfing ability, but he refused to let the physical strain derail his campaign.

Having established a clear lead by the end of the third round, Chacarra approached the final day with the composure of an experienced pro. There were no unnecessary risks, no dramatic swings in momentum. A steady two-under-par 70 on Sunday was enough to seal his fourth DP World Tour title.

The victory carried significance beyond the trophy. It propelled Chacarra to the top of the Race to Dubai standings, placing him firmly in contention with only three tournaments remaining.

For McIlroy, meanwhile, the week ended in disappointment. The Northern Irishman's performances over the final two rounds failed to match the anticipation surrounding his appearance. Rounds of 72 and 74 saw him slide down the leaderboard to a tied-42 – a costly result. Reed's campaign followed a different trajectory. A three-over 75 in the opening round left the American with considerable ground to recover. He responded admirably, however, producing rounds of 69, 67 and 69 to climb back into contention, eventually finishing tied-23.

It was a creditable recovery, though not enough to make a decisive impact on the Race to Dubai standings. Reed and McIlroy, second and third respectively, still have time to mount a challenge, but the momentum now belongs to Chacarra. After the triumph, an exhausted, emotional Chacarra spoke on the significance of this victory and more.. Excerpts:

You are the winner of the DP World India Championship. How good does that sound?

It's great. All the hard work.. I wanted to win to get up in the rankings. The last round was tough. It was really tiring waking up three days in a row at 4 a.m. My body wasn't there. I didn't feel good. It is hard to go in with a big lead. You don't really want to push, but with guys making birdies, you have to. It was a new experience, and I am really proud of my short game, the grind and how I stayed patient.

In a world-class field which had Ryder Cup stars, former World No. 1s and Major champions, you finished on top...

Yeah, I told (2027 Ryder Cup captain) Luke (Donald) back in the day I want to be on that (Ryder Cup) team. Not just any pick; I want one of the six spots. That's one of the goals. We are still a year away, but I know what I'm capable of. I know I'm a good player. I have a lot of charisma, and I want to keep getting better and keep winning.

You're on top in the Race to Dubai rankings. How special would it be to add your name to the list of Spanish winners, Seve Ballesteros and Jon Rahm?

It would mean the world to me. Those two guys are heroes for me as a Spanish golfer. Seve did everything for European and Spanish golf, and Jon is someone I've looked up to since he went to college. Hopefully, I can put my name on that trophy too.

You lifted the Hero Indian Open trophy last year, and now you're a two-time winner in India.

It feels great to be here. India has been awesome to me. This country changed my life last year when I won at the Hero Indian Open, and it has happened again here. I'm so proud of this win. I always love coming to India. I love the people, the food, the greens, the golf courses... I'm excited to come back next year.

You had to scramble on the back-nine in the final round. Was it tough?

Yes, it was terrible. I woke up the last three days at 3.45 a.m. They've been long days. It's hot and humid. I've been fighting myself today, and that's not normal. I'm normally a very good ball-striker, but I had to fight and rely on my short game. It's nice to see that you can win when you are not having the best time of it. We had Rory, defending champion Tommy Fleetwood, Reed, Shane Lowry – probably the best field of the year. To beat all these guys without even having my 'A' game is something that gives me a lot of motivation.

Did the broken toe trouble you?

I broke my toe 15 days ago back home. I woke up to get some water in the middle of the night, and didn't see the corner of the sofa and broke it. Last week was really tough, with all the ice and medications. Playing 25-30 holes in a day is not easy with this toe. Also, my neck was in a bad position when I slept. It got really tense and I didn't know if I was going to be able to tee off. My physio did a great job to help me recover. I was not at a 100%, but we figured out a way to compete.

PHOTO: R V MOORTHY

What helped you stay consistent at the Delhi Golf Club this week?

We had a great game plan. We did a good job on the practice rounds, and we stuck to it. I was really good on the greens, and with my wedge approach. Today's run (third and fourth round) was just priceless. I didn't really miss a shot. I putted and chipped well. That helped me get a big lead after the third round. This course suited me. You need to hit it on the fairway. I like these type of courses.

You had mentioned your grandfather, who passed away recently. Could you share the impact he had on your life and career.

His demise was unexpected, but he had a great life. He helped me a lot, and he was very impactful for me. My parents worked, so he would pick us up from school and take us to golf practice. I dedicate this trophy to him.

At a very young age, you took the decision to go to LIV Golf. But then you took an even bigger decision to leave LIV Golf and rebuild your career..

When I left LIV, I wanted to play in the Majors, Ryder Cups, win tournaments on the DP World Tour, and be on the PGA Tour. That's what I dreamt of since I was little. When LIV came up, as one of the best amateurs in the world, they offered me something that I couldn't say no to. I'm very thankful for that. My time there was great. It helped my career. I have a great team around me, thanks to LIV. I can travel a little better. I can go to nicer hotels. I can give my family and my future family a great life. So I'm always grateful to LIV. I have nothing bad to say about LIV, but my time there was done. Hopefully, this win will help me move up the rankings and I can play all four Majors next year.

You have a very disciplined but very short pre-shot routine. Is it something you have worked on?

I just don't understand people who take too long to hit their shots. You get the distance, and then try to execute. I love playing the way I do. We talk about a shot, we know the shot, and then I try to do it. I don't believe that taking more time is going to help you make a better swing. I have never done it. I'm a fast player from tee to green, but a little slower on the greens.

What do you find common between Indian and Spanish culture?

The people in India are super nice, like in Spain. Everyone welcomes you, and are always wanting to help. I also love Indian food. I'm a big chicken butter with *naan* fan. I think I've had it seven times this week. That tells you how much I love it. Every time I get a chance to come back to India, I will be here.

Scientists unearth new instance of 'contagious cancer' in animals

Researchers studied melanoma in the brown bullhead catfish, a resident of Lake Memphremagog, between Quebec in Canada and Vermont in the U.S.; the finding is interesting because it could reveal clues to keeping a human's body from rejecting a transplanted organ

D.P. Kasbekar

Ordinarily, cancers are not regarded as contagious – whereas AIDS, COVID-19, tuberculosis, and malaria are. Contagious diseases spread from one person to another through direct contact, airborne droplets or through insect vectors (like mosquitoes). On the other hand, cancers originate from one of the patient's own cells.

However, so far, scientists have documented three instances in which naturally occurring cancers in animals became contagious. That is, the cancer cells originated in one individual, then moved into another, formed tumours in its new host, and then moved on in search of still other hosts.

In 2006, scientists who reported a transmissible venereal tumour that spreads between dogs wrote that "the concept of a contagious cancer cell has tended to be greeted with scepticism by many oncologists and immunologists".

Melanoma mystery: A new study suggests that catfish cancer cells might be transmitted indirectly through the aquatic environment, and may have become grafted to new hosts through their gills, skin or mouth. WILL TURNER/UNSPLASH

Interest among scientists

But recently, researchers from the University of Vermont in the U.S. reported the fourth instance. They studied melanoma in the brown bullhead catfish (*Ameiurus nebulosus*), a found in of Lake Memphremagog, a 51-km-long lake straddling the border between Quebec in Canada and Vermont in the U.S.

Melanomas are aggressive cancers that originate from skin cells called melanocytes. Melanocytes make the pigment melanin, which gives skin its colour. About 30% of catfish collected from across the lake since 2013 were found to be afflicted with melanoma.

The team's findings were published in *Nature*.

Scientists are also interested because the work could reveal clues to keeping a person's body from rejecting a transplanted organ. This is because the affected catfish's immune system does not reject the cancer cells despite the latter being obviously non-self.

Mitochondrial DNA

The genome of cancer cells is often unstable. The DNA accumulates many changes in its sequence, allowing cells to grow aggressively and evade the body's immune surveillance.

The Vermont researchers compared the genomes of the melanomas in the catfish with that of the normal cells from individual affected fish. They were surprised to find evidence that the melanomas had originated in a distantly related fish and then had invaded, parasitised, and formed tumours in new hosts. The researchers compared the mitochondrial DNA (mtDNA) from melanomas with the mtDNA from non-cancerous cells. Mitochondria, the cells' powerhouses, are the descendants of a bacterium that an ancient single-celled organism engulfed, and evolved over billions of years to give rise to animal and plant life.

Over these aeons, many of the bacterium's genes were transferred to the host cell's nucleus, leaving behind only a small rump of mtDNA. In humans, the mtDNA content is five-million-times smaller than the DNA in the cell's nucleus.

Tumour cells

The researchers found that the mtDNA in the cancer cells contained almost an order of magnitude more changes compared to the mtDNA in normal cells – a difference that natural variations can not explain. More analysis of the mutations indicated that the affected catfish had acquired their cancer cells from 'outside', which then formed tumours in their new host.

The team also found that the cancer cells had originated from beyond Lake Memphremagog.

Reproduction likely played a role in infection. During spawning, the fish come together in relatively small areas, and physical interactions amongst them could have given cancer cells the chance to move between individuals.

An alternative explanation for the high frequency of melanomas is a cancer-causing virus or microbe. The researchers screened all the tumour and normal tissues for viruses and other microbial agents but did not find any unique to affected fish.

Based on this they wrote: "although we cannot rule out a role for conventional pathogens in the original emergence or ecological transmission of this disease, the genomic evidence presented here overwhelmingly supports a transmissible cancer in which the tumour cells themselves act as the infectious entity".

Other examples

Of the three previously documented instances of transmissible cancer, the one in dogs involved sex. In the 2006 paper, scientists found that the DNA from cancer cells of 40 affected dogs from across the world had mostly the same sequences, suggesting that the 'infection' had originated in one dog around 11,000 years ago.

The oral-facial cancer in Tasmanian devils, an endangered Australian marsupial, obstructed the animal's ability to feed, thus leading to these animals' population in the wild crashing by 90% and threatening to render them extinct. In all the affected Tasmanian devils, the tumour cells contained the same complex rearrangement of chromosomes, once again indicating a common origin, from a single cell, which then multiplied and spread across individuals, probably as they bit one another. Scientists have also found transmissible cancers in several bivalve molluscs, including clams, mussels, and cockles. Their cancer cells were probably transmitted passively from one individual to another via the seawater. In one clam species, scientists found the cancer had originated in a different species and then had jumped to this one, which is more unusual.

In fact, the authors of the latest study have speculated that the catfish cancer cells, like those of the bivalves, might be transmitted indirectly through the aquatic environment, and have become grafted to a host through its gills, skin or mouth.

'Cooperation breakdown'

While the discovery of this fourth instance of a cancer that can move between bodies is not surprising, it also extends an unconventional understanding of the 'disease'. In a complex biological organism, billions of cells cooperate to keep the organism alive and kicking.

Cancer arises when some cells refuse to cooperate, and proliferate at the expense of other cells. A transmissible cancer, however, implies that the cells break the rules in their original body as well as can exploit entirely different organisms.

In a 2015 paper, scientists wrote that the possibility lends weight to the idea that cancer is not just the product of specific mutations but "a breakdown of multicellular cooperation".

(D.P. Kasbekar is a retired scientist. kasbekardp@yahoo.co.in)

THE GIST

- Researchers studying brown bullhead catfish in Lake Memphremagog found that about 30% carried melanoma, a skin cancer that appears to spread between fish as living cancer cells rather than arising independently in each animal
- The team found that tumour cells had far more mitochondrial DNA mutations than normal cells, indicating the cancer cells were acquired from other fish and later formed tumours in new hosts; evidence suggests the cancer originated beyond Lake Memphremagog
- Scientists believe the transmissible cancer could help explain how foreign cells evade immune rejection; the affected catfish do not reject the non-self cancer cells, a phenomenon that may offer insights relevant to organ transplantation and immune response

BIG SHOT

Journalists film the exploration and return modules of the Martian Moons eXploration (MMX) spacecraft at the Tanegashima Space Center in Japan in August. Japan launched the MMX on October 20, en route to potentially becoming the first mission to retrieve samples from one of Mars's moons. AFP

WHAT IS IT?

Heat storms: giant heat waves

Reuters

Heat waves have evolved from sporadic, isolated episodes to massive, cascading weather events that can blanket vast swaths of the planet for months or even years at a time.

To continue calling such sprawling phenomena 'heat waves' would be like calling a monsoon a 'rain shower'. To understand the new reality of these immense expanses of heat, a consultation with two dozen climate researchers and an analysis of temperatures worldwide for for every hour since 1960 has yielded a new concept: heat storm.

Scientists and researchers often discuss global warming in the context of risks that will arise if the planet's average global temperature rises more than 2 degree celsius above pre-industrial levels. An ordinary person can't make much of that. However, heat waves are the connective tissue between the science of global warming and our everyday experience. And today supersized heat waves regularly swarm the planet.

Experts have also identified a 'heat cascade' as heat storms that run one after the other, simultaneously or both. Their duration has also swelled from around two months in the 1960s to nine months in the early 2000s.

Naming events is "a powerful way for people to understand that something is happening," Anthony Leiserowitz, director of the Yale Program on Climate Change Communication, said. Yet "we don't do that with heat waves," he said, even though heat has been estimated to kill almost half a million people a year.

People sit in the shade on the Spanish Steps during a heatwave in Rome, Italy. REUTERS

The largest heat storm on record, named 'Vera', lasted for 367 days over 2023-2024 and swept over nearly 85% of the globe. The world is now in the grip of a heat storm named Raimundo: it broiled Europe and stoked massive wildfires in Spain and France this summer. Since its inception on February 28, 2026, Raimundo has touched almost three-quarters of the planet's surface.

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